# Pokémon Platinum

## The Ultimate Completionist's Strategy Guide

# About This Guide

## About This Guide

Welcome to The Ultimate Pokémon Platinum Completionist's Guide—a full walkthrough and companion for Trainers who want to experience everything that Sinnoh has to offer. This isn't just a step-by-step playthrough—it's a celebration of one of Pokémon's most beloved adventures, written for players who refuse to settle for anything less than 100%.

Inside these pages, you'll find:

- A complete main story walkthrough, covering every route, town, and major event in detail.
- Comprehensive Pokédex completion assistance, including encounter rates, trade evolutions, and post-game locations.
- Tips for battling, training, and team building, from your first Gym Badge to the toughest Frontier Brain.
- Detailed coverage of side quests, hidden items, events, and optional encounters, ensuring no stone is left unturned.
- Post-game content including the Battle Frontier, legendary Pokémon events, and advanced mechanics like IVs, EVs, and breeding.

Written with a mix of humor, strategy, and a deep love for Pokémon Platinum, this guide is designed to feel like a trusted companion on your journey. Whether you're exploring Sinnoh for the first time or returning to polish off your Pokédex after years away, you'll find everything you need to become a true Master here.

So grab your Pokétch, stock up on Ultra Balls, and step into the tall grass once more. Adventure—and perfection—await.

## Note from author

This guide has been mostly generated with ChatGPT 5 and it's images have been either generated or edited with Bytedance Seedream 4.0.

All factual information has been fact-checked manually by myself, mostly using Bulbapedia and Serebii. Both of them are very reliable sources trusted by the Pokémon community.

# Introduction

## The Ultimate Completionist's Strategy Guide

### Welcome, budding Pokémon trainers!

Welcome to the chilly, mysterious, and adventure-packed region of Sinnoh! Pokémon Platinum is the enhanced version of Pokémon Diamond and Pearl, first released for the Nintendo DS back in 2008. It takes everything we loved about the original Sinnoh adventures and cranks it up with a cooler story, some wicked battles, and new Pokémon to catch (hello, Rotom forms and the menacing Distortion World).

In this guide, we're going all-in on the completionist dream. That means:

- Catching 'em all (or at least everything the Sinnoh Regional Pokédex can hold before we go national)
- Tackling every side quest—from legendary Pokémon hunts to cool odd jobs like collecting rare items or helping NPCs in need
- Exploring every nook, cranny, cave, mountain, and creepy mansion Sinnoh has to offer
- Making sure you never miss a single thing. No hidden Pokémon, no one-time-only items, no stone left unturned

Pokémon Platinum is set in Sinnoh, a land inspired by Japan's northern island of Hokkaido, filled with snow-capped peaks, deep forests, ancient ruins, and modern cities humming with life. You'll meet quirky characters, challenge eight Gyms, square off against Team Galactic's bizarre schemes, and ultimately face the Pokémon League to become Champion. And because this is Platinum, you'll also confront Giratina, the mysterious Renegade Pokémon, in a twisted alternate dimension known as the Distortion World. But don't worry—you won't be alone on this journey. I'll be your trusty companion, keeping track of every new Pokémon, every route, and every hidden secret. Together, we'll squeeze every drop of content this game has to offer.

# Introduction

## The Ultimate Completionist's Strategy Guide

Whether you're brand new to Sinnoh or you're returning after years away, this guide will help you:

- Build a strong, diverse team
- Learn efficient routes to maximize encounters and item collection
- Enjoy the story without stressing about what you might be missing

Ready to embark on the most thorough Sinnoh adventure possible? Lace up those running shoes, make sure your Poké Balls are stocked, and let's head into the tall grass—because the world of Pokémon Platinum is just waiting to be completed.

### What Makes Pokémon Platinum Special?

Platinum isn't just a slight upgrade—it's a revamped Sinnoh adventure with loads of new goodies for trainers to enjoy. Here's a quick look at what sets it apart:

- A Fresh Story Twist – Team Galactic's plot is reworked, adding Giratina's Distortion World and upping the drama.
- Expanded Pokédex – More Pokémon are available earlier, including favorites from other generations (Houndour, Togepi, Swablu, and more). This means better team variety right from the start.
- New Forms & Features – Shaymin's Sky Forme, Rotom's appliance forms, and Giratina's Origin Forme bring fresh strategies to battles.
- Battle Frontier – Postgame gets supercharged with a full suite of challenging battle facilities for you to test your skills.
- Updated Trainers & Gyms – Gym Leaders and the Elite Four have updated rosters, making for a better challenge throughout.
- Faster Gameplay – Some small but handy tweaks make the adventure flow smoother than in Diamond and Pearl (like faster surfing and more balanced level curves).

All in all, Platinum is the definitive Sinnoh experience—and if you're aiming to see and do it all, you picked the perfect version.

# Chapter 1 - Twinleaf Town

The Beginning of Your Sinnoh Adventure

### Welcome to Twinleaf Town!

Twinleaf Town is a quiet, snowy little settlement where our story begins. This place may look sleepy, but it's about to become the launchpad for your rise to Champion — and beyond. Here's what's happening: you and your energetic rival (Barry by default — you can name him whatever you like, even "HotPants" if you're feeling spicy) are itching to meet Professor Rowan in Sandgem Town. But you can't go waltzing through tall grass without a Pokémon, so naturally, you both attempt to do just that anyway… and hilarity ensues.

Professor Rowan shows up, scolds you for your reckless enthusiasm, then gives you the best gift any 10-year-old could hope for: your very first Pokémon.

### Key events

• Your Journal – Mom gives you this to keep track of major events.

• Parcel – Barry's mom asks you to deliver it to him; part of the early errands.

• Running Shoes – You get these from your mom after starting the errand. From now on, no more slow walking!

### Starter Pokémon

You'll get to pick one of these three Sinnoh starters:

**Turtwig** - Grass type - Grotle → Torterra
Bulky physical attacker; strong vs. Rock, Ground, Water.

**Chimchar** - Fire type - Monferno → Infernape
Fast mixed attacker; Fire/Fighting covers many types.

**Piplup** - Water type - Prinplup → Empoleon
Balanced with Steel typing late-game; good vs. Rock, Ground, Fire.

# Starter Pokémon

The Beginning of Your Sinnoh Adventure

### Your first big Decision

Picking a starter is like picking your first Pokémon partner-in-crime — they're with you through thick and thin, they'll carry a lot of early fights, and they'll shape your team's coverage for a while. Here's the good, the bad, and the quirky for each one:

### Turtwig — Slow, Strong, Steadfast Tank

• Type Line: Grass → Grass/Ground (at Torterra)
• Stats Personality: High Attack and Defense, slow Speed.
• Notable Moves: Razor Leaf (early Grass STAB), Earthquake (amazing Ground STAB), Curse for setup.
• Strong against 4/8 gym leaders and weak against 1/8

### Chimchar — Fast, Fiery Glass Cannon

• Type Line: Fire → Fire/Fighting (at Monferno).
• Stats Personality: Speedy, strong mixed attacker — best balance of offense in the trio.
• Notable Moves: Mach Punch (priority), Close Combat (monster Fighting STAB), Flamethrower/Fire Blast.
• Strong against 4/8 gym leaders and weak against 2/8

### Piplup — Cool, Balanced Technician

• Type Line: Water → Water/Steel (at Empoleon).
• Stats Personality: Balanced bulk and Special Attack; a bit slower than average, but durable.
• Notable Moves: BubbleBeam → Surf (incredibly strong STAB), Ice Beam (later), Flash Cannon.
• Strong against only 1/8 gym leaders and weak against 2/8 but don't worry! You can build your team around these weaknesses!

### Completionists note

• All starters can be used to a great effect. Don't worry too much about gym matchups!
• If you are filling your pokédex, You need another console and game to receive the other starters through trading.

# Route 201

First route of your adventure

## Your First Steps into Sinnoh

Welcome to Route 201, the very first stretch of adventure awaiting every new Trainer in Pokémon Platinum! This peaceful, grassy route connects your quiet Twinleaf Town to the bustling Sandgem Town. There are a few patches of grass here, perfect for getting your very first wild encounter experience.

You'll only find a handful of species, but these early companions can help you build a solid foundation for the road ahead. It's also a good place to practice catching Pokémon once you receive your Poké Balls from Lucas or Dawn. Unlike most routes, there are no trainers to battle here but we will start battling very soon!

This route might be small, but it marks the start of something big — your quest to become Sinnoh's ultimate Trainer! Below you can see the encounter table for this area. Basically it shows which wild pokémon can be found in the grass and how common they are. When a pokémon has a bold name, it means that it is available for the first time in this guide so pay attention to those if you are trying to fill your pokédex! We will be using this same format for this whole guide.

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Starly** | normal/flying | 2-3 | 50% |
| **Bidoof** | normal | 2-3 | 40% |
| **Kricketot** | bug | 3 | 10% |

## Completionists note

- Kricketot can only be found during morning
- Bidoof learns a lot of hidden machine moves which will be useful later
- Starly is a popular pokémon that is often added to teams

# Sandgem Town and Route 202

## First Steps as an Official Pokémon Trainer

You've made it to Sandgem Town, and now things really open up. You'll meet Professor Rowan in his lab, officially receive your Pokédex, and get your first batch of Poké Balls — congratulations, you can finally start catching Pokémon!
Rowan will also introduce his assistant, Dawn (or Lucas, if you're playing as Dawn). This is your friendly counterpart, different from your rival Barry — they'll give you a few tutorials, and eventually the essential TM27 (Return), which powers up as your Pokémon's friendship grows.

### Sandgem Town highlights

• Pokédex & Poké Balls — Now you can actually start filling in those empty Dex slots.

• PC & Pokémon Center — Healing, storage, and trading become available.

• Poké Mart — Stock up on Poké Balls, Potions, and Antidotes. You'll need them for the next stretch.

• Tutorial Catch — Dawn/Lucas demonstrates how to catch Pokémon on Route 202. Nothing fancy, but counts as part of the early-game charm. Before you can do the tutorial, you have to go back to Twinleaf to visit your mom.

### Route 202 – First Trainer Battles, First Real Catches

This grassy route connects Sandgem Town to Jubilife City. It's home to your first real trainer battles (four youngsters with low-level Pokémon) and some decent wild Pokémon to fill out your team. Here's what you can find:

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Starly | normal/flying | 2-4 | 20% |
| Bidoof | normal | 2-3 | 40% |
| Kricketot | bug | 3 | 10% (morning/night) |
| **Shinx** | electric | 3-4 | 30% |

# Jubilife city

## From Quiet Towns to the Big City

Welcome to Jubilife City, the biggest metropolis in western Sinnoh and your first major stop after earning your Trainer status. Sitting proudly between Route 202, Route 203, and Route 218, Jubilife buzzes with life, technology, and opportunities — it's where the adventure truly starts to branch out. You won't find a Gym here, but you'll find just about everything else: education, gadgets, and side content galore.

### What to Do in Jubilife City

1. The Trainer's School
Just east of the Pokémon Center, this is a great spot to pick up a few early battle tips. You'll also meet your rival here and give him the parcel that contains a few handy Town Maps for your trouble. Two students inside are eager for friendly battles — they're optional, but a good warm-up

2. Pokétch Company Headquarters
On the north side of the city sits the Pokétch Company, makers of the Pokémon Watch. To get one, you'll need to win the Clown Coupon Hunt! Talk to the three clowns around town — they'll quiz you on basic Pokémon knowledge. Once you collect all three coupons, return to the company president to receive your Pokétch. It's more than just a watch; it can display maps, friendship levels, step counters, and much more.

### Completionists note

Before heading east towards route 203 there are some optional things to do while you are here:

• Daily lottery in the TV station

• Get the old rod from  a fisherman in the western exit of the city. This can be used to fish Magikarp almost anywhere where there is water.

- Receive quick claw from the building in the northeastern corner of the city.
- Visit Route 204 for some extra experience early. We will be going through that area a bit later in the guide.

# Route 203

## Rival Battle Ahead!

Here's your first true rival fight. Barry (your rival) will challenge you here before you can move on toward Oreburgh City. Barry will have the following pokémon:
Starly - Level 7 - Weak Flying-type - watch for Quick Attack spam.
Starter (depends on what your starter is) level 9 - Will have a STAB move and a basic coverage move; treat seriously.
They're still low-level, but if you're underleveled it might be tough. This fight sets the tone — Barry is fast, not cautious. It is recommended to have at least 2 team members at this point including your starter. Overall this fight should be very manageable by simply using your strongest moves.

After the battle, trainers dot the roadside, eager to challenge passing adventurers. It's a good place to test the strength of your growing team and prepare for what's to come. Wild Pokémon here are a little tougher than before and there is a handful of new ones to find.  At the far end of the route, the trail narrows into the dark mouth of Oreburgh Gate, a cave that marks the boundary of civilization.

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Starly | normal/flying | 4-7 | 25% |
| Bidoof | normal | 5-7 | 15% |
| Kricketot | bug | 5 | 10% (morning/night) |
| Shinx | electric | 4-5 | 25% |
| **abra** | psychic | 4-5 | 15% |
| **zubat** | poison/flying | 4 | 10% (night) |

- Abra can make for a powerful team member, but requires trading to evolve it into Alakazam
- Zubat is a common pokemon that can be found in most caves so it is not a mandatory catch

# Oreburgh Gate and City

Sinnoh's mining hub

Before you can reach Oreburgh city, you have to go through Oreburgh gate. Shortly after entering, you'll meet a friendly Hiker who gives you HM06 Rock Smash, one of your first Hidden Machines. Although you can't use it outside of battle yet, it's a clear signal that you'll soon need it — and that means a Gym Challenge is on the horizon. Within the cave, you'll find a few trainers testing their Pokémon's strength, along with items like Poké Balls and Potions tucked away in corners as well as the following wild pokémon:

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Geodude** | rock/ground | 5-7 | 15% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 5-8 | 50% |
| **Psyduck** | water | 5-7 | 35% |

### Oreburgh City

Oreburgh City is a rugged, dust-coated town where everything revolves around rocks, coal, and hardworking miners. It's home to Oreburgh Mine, a massive excavation site that provides the city's lifeblood — and the perfect training ground for Rock-type specialists.
At the northern edge stands the Oreburgh Gym, led by Roark, the first Gym Leader you'll face. He's a Rock-type expert and a miner himself, known for his sturdy defense and use of Fossil Pokémon. Before you can challenge him, however, you'll have to track him down in the Oreburgh Mine which will be your next main objective.

### Things to do in Oreburgh city

- Explore the city! You can get some items just by talking to people.
- In one of the northern buildings, you can find a trainer who will trade you an Abra in exchange for a Machop. Machop can be found on route 207.
- Visit route 207. There aren't any trainers but you can find a wild Ponyta and Machop. They could make for powerful team members.
- You can revive fossils in the mining museum. At this point you won't have any yet but keep this in mind when you eventually find one (we will be covering that in this guide later on).

# Oreburgh Mine & Route 205

## Training and Exploration

Before taking on Roark at the Oreburgh Gym, Oreburgh Mine is a crucial spot to explore and prepare. This mine isn't just a story checkpoint — it's a mini training ground and a place to pick up some early items.I nside, you'll see miners hard at work, rubble blocking certain paths, and wild Rock- and Ground-type Pokémon lurking in the shadows. You can battle a few trainers here who provide solid experience for your early team. At the end you will find Roark. Talk to him and he will be heading back to the Gym, so you can challenge him.

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Geodude | rock/ground | 6-9 | 65% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 6-8 | 25% |
| **Onix** | rock/ground | 7-9 | 10% |

### Route 207 - Optional Exploration and Team Building

Route 207 lies just north of Oreburgh City and provides a few useful opportunities before your first Gym battle. It's a quiet, slightly hilly route with a patch of grass and a few items tucked away, making it a good place to round out your team. Most of the route is currently unaccessible but we can still catch some pokémon. Route 207 isn't required to progress to the Gym, but it's a convenient spot to train, stock up, and catch a few new Pokémon to give you an edge against Rock-types. With Oreburgh Mine cleared and a few battles on Route 207 under your belt, your team should be ready to challenge Roark and earn your first badge!

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
|---|---|---|---|
| Geodude | rock/ground | 5-7 | 30% |
| **Machop** | fighting | 6-8 | 35% |
| **Ponyta** | fire | 5-7 | 25% |
| Kricketot | bug | 5 | 10% (morning/night) |

# Oreburgh Gym

## Roark's Rock-Solid Challenge

The Oreburgh Gym is the first real test for any Sinnoh Trainer.Located in the heart of Oreburgh City, it doubles as both a challenge and a tutorial for type advantages, strategy, and preparation. Roark, the Gym Leader, is a miner through and through, and his team is entirely Rock-type, meaning they have high Defense and are resistant to Normal-, Flying-, and Fire-type attacks. However, Grass- and Water-type moves hit them for super effective damage. Additionally they are also weak to ground, fighting and steel so if you have any of those attacks they will be extra powerful. Lets go over Roark's team:

| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
|---|---|---|---|
| Geodude | rock/ground | 12 | Stealth Rock<br>Rock Throw<br>Rock Polish<br>Mud Sport |
| Onix | rock/ground | 12 | Stealth Rock<br>Rock Throw<br>Screech<br>Bind |
| Cranidos | rock | 14 | Headbutt<br>Pursuit<br>Leer |

Roark can use 2 potions during the battle when his pokémon's HP drops to 25% or less. You should be able to easily defeat him with your stater. On the next page we will go through strategies for the battle.

# Oreburgh Gym strategies

## Roark's Rock-Solid Challenge

### Strategies

### Starter

Each starter should be able to win by using a stab move. Your level should be around 15 or 16 so chimchar should be evolved by now. This is important because it learnes Mach Punch. It is a fighting type move that hits all of Roark's pokémon super effectively. With Piplup/Prinplup use Bubblebeam and Turtwig should use Razor Leaf. If you get flinched by Cranidos' headbutt, use potions to keep yourself in the match.

### Other pokémon

If your starter goes down during the match or if you aren't using it in your team, there are other pokémon that are strong against rock types too.

- Budew - This baby pokémon can hit rock types super effectively with grass type moves like Absorb and Mega Drain
- Psyduck - Super effective with Water Gun
- Machop - Super effective with fighting type moves
- Defensive pokemon like Onix and Geodude who resist rock and normal moves

### After the battle

Congratulations, Trainer! You've just hammered through your first Gym battle and earned the Coal Badge — your very first step on the road to Sinnoh's Pokémon League! Roark might've looked intimidating with his mining gear and rock-solid lineup, but you've proven that your team can handle real competition. Let's go through what happens next and what you can do before leaving Oreburgh City:

- The Coal Badge — This allows you to use Rock Smash outside of battle, opening up a number of new areas to explore.
- TM76: Stealth Rock — A tactical Rock-type move that damages any Pokémon that switch into battle. It's a staple in competitive play, but not immediately vital for your adventure team

As you exit the Gym, you'll be reminded to report back to Jubilife City. There's some commotion there involving Team Galactic, and you'll need to intervene.

# Chapter 2

## Towards Eterna City

After defeating Roark, your next gym battle will be in Eterna City. In order to get there we must first return back to Jubilife city.
The path forward takes you west through Oreburgh Gate, the same cave you passed through on your way here. Now that you have the Coal Badge, you can use Rock Smash to break those cracked rocks blocking shortcuts and hidden passages. Along the way, keep an eye out for items such as:

- TM70 (Flash) – very useful for dark areas like caves later in the game.
- A few hidden Poké Balls and Potions scattered around the cave walls.

Once you emerge on the other side, you'll find yourself back on familiar ground near Route 203, and from there it's a straight shot west into Jubilife City.

### What's Happening in Jubilife

When you return, you'll quickly discover that things aren't quite the same as when you left. Team Galactic—that strange group you might've glimpsed earlier—has started causing problems near the Pokémon Trainer's School and the TV Station. You'll be teaming up with Professor Rowan and Lucas/Dawn to deal with them for the first time. It's your first real taste of the larger plot that's slowly unfolding across Sinnoh.

This battle is your first double battle where you fill fight alongside Dawn or Lucas. This fight is relatively easy but it's a nice preview of Galactic's staple Pokémon. Next up we will be heading north to Route 204 and towards Floarama Town but there are a few things you can do in Jubilife before that.

- Do the daily lottery in the TV station if the day has changed since you were last here
- Vistit th Global station. Even though the Wifi servers don't work anymore, there is still some banging music
- Visit the Pokétch company building to receive a new app

# Route 204

## Towards Eterna City

Earlier you had access to the lower half of Route 204, but with Rock Smash, you can now break through the Ravaged Path and reach the northern section that connects to Floaroma. In case you didn't already battle the trainers here, they will now be very easy to defeat due to their low levels.

| Route 204 (South) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Starly | normal/flying | 4-6 | 25% |
| Bidoof | normal | 4-6 | 25% |
| **Budew** | grass/poison | 3-5 | 25% |
| Shinx | electric | 4-5 | 15% |
| **Wurmple** | bug | 4 | 10% |

### Ravaged path

Now that you can use Rock Smash, you'll cross this short cave to reach the north half of Route 204. Make sure to pick TM Rock Tomb while you are here. After you exit the cave you reach the Northern side of Route 204. There are some trainers here and the wild pokemon are the same as the southern part but a bit higher level.

| Ravaged Path | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Psyduck | water | 4-6 | 35% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 3-6 | 65% |

# Floaroma Town

## Towards Eterna City

After Route 204 you will reach Floaroma Town, A cheerful, flower-filled town, but don't let its calm looks fool you — Galactic is up to trouble nearby. Team Galactic is blocking access to Floaroma meadow. In order to get there, you must head east towards Valley Windworks. But before that, there are some things you can do while you are here:

- Pick Berries: You'll find plenty of berry patches around here, so start growing your own.
- Flora Lady: NPC who gives you berries daily.

### Route 205 South and Valley Windworks

This section of Route 205 connects Floaroma Town to the Valley Windworks. It's a narrow path divided by a river, and for now, you can't cross to the northern half until you've handled the trouble ahead. Valley windworks has a handful of pokémon that we haven't seen yet. Some of them could be good additions to you team.

| Valley Windworks | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Shellos** | water | 9-12 | 45% |
| **Buizel** | water | 9-11 | 25% |
| Shinx | electric | 10 | 20% |
| **Pachirisu** | electric | 9-11 | 10% |

# Trouble at Valley Windworks

## Towards Eterna City

The main attraction of Valley Windworks — a power station surrounded by giant wind turbines. Unfortunately, a Team Galactic Grunt is stationed right outside, guarding the entrance.  The grunt uses a simple team (typically Glameow or Stunky, around Lv.13–14).After defeating him, he'll panic, run inside, and lock the door behind him — leaving you stuck outside. He smugly tells you that you'll need a Works Key to enter… which, of course, he doesn't give you.

### Back to Floaroma Town – The Fight for the Works Key

With no way into the Windworks, you'll need to return to Floaroma Town. Remember those two Galactic grunts blocking Floaroma Meadow earlier? Now's your chance to deal with them!
Head into the Meadow, where the pair is still harassing a man for his Honey. Challenge them to battle — they'll each use a few weak Pokémon (mostly Zubat, Glameow, or Stunky) around Lv.13. After defeating them both, they'll run off, leaving the Works Key behind! The grateful man you saved will reward you with a jar of Honey and open up the Meadow for you to explore, though there isn't much to do for now. However, there is a honey tree.

### Honey Trees

Honey Trees are special golden-colored trees found all across Sinnoh that can attract rare Pokémon when coated with Honey. You can get Honey from the man in Floaroma Meadow after saving him from Team Galactic, or buy it from him afterward for 100 Pokédollars per jar.
Here's how it works:

1. Find a Honey Tree — they stand out with their distinct golden bark.
2. Slather the tree with Honey.
3. Wait six real-time hours.
4. Return to the tree — if it's shaking, interact with it to encounter a Pokémon!

Each tree has its own hidden encounter table, meaning some Pokémon are rarer on certain trees.

### Possible Honey Tree Pokémon

- Common: Wurmple, Silcoon, Cascoon, Combee, Burmy
- Uncommon: Aipom, Cherubi, Heracross
- Rare: Munchlax (found on only a few specific trees in the whole region!)

# Team Galactic's Mars

## Towards Eterna City

### Return to Valley Windworks

With the Works Key in hand, go back to the Valley Windworks and unlock the door. Inside, you'll find several Team Galactic grunts patrolling the rooms though they should be a piece of cake to handle. Once all the grunts are defeated, you'll discover that someone even higher up in Team Galactic's ranks is leading the operation…

### Commander Mars

Mars is your **first real boss battle** in Platinum. Unlike the earlier pushovers, her team is fast, hits hard, and has coverage moves that can punish careless switches. Mars's team consists of a zubat (level 15) and Purugly (level 17). The purugly is no pushover. It has storng stats, it's holding an Oran Berry to heal HP and has access to Faint Attack, Scratch, and Fake Out.
Zubat should go down easily but Purugly is a different story. It's got a surprisingly high Attack stat for this stage of the game, and Fake Out will always flinch you on the first turn. Don't waste an item until after it hits — then heal strategically.

### Strategies

1. Use Fighting Moves - If you started with Chimchar and it evolved into Monferno (Lv.14), you have Mach Punch, which is perfect here. Priority + Fighting super effective damage knocks Purugly down to size. Machop is another powerful option or anything with Rock Smash.
2. Bulky Picks - Geodude/Onix resist Normal-type moves and can tank Purugly's hits better than most. Rock Throw can chip away safely.
3. Intimidate ability - If you have a Staravia or Luxio, they can weaken Purugly's Attack with Intimidate, making it much easier to handle.

# Route 205

Towards Eterna City

### Drifloon, The Balloon Pokémon

After clearing Mars from Valley Windworks, you'll be able to cross the bridge and explore Route 205. This stretch leads into Eterna Forest and eventually to Eterna City. However there is still one more thing to do at Valley Windworks. After clearing Team Galactic, a little girl tells you about a balloon pokemon that appears at the Windworks on certain days. That pokémon is Drifloon, and it only appears on Fridays as a fixed encounter in front of the building. This is a rare pokémon that you should catch whenever you get the change. If you don't feel like waiting, you can always just change the console's calendar.

### Route 205 – The Path to Eterna Forest

Finally the rest of Route 205 is open for exploration. This stretch of road winds alongside a river and is packed with Fishermen, Bug Catchers, and plenty of items to scoop up — plus a few Pokémon that'll make nice additions to your growing team if you didn't already get them in Valley Windworks. The encounters here are the same except you can't find Shinx in this area.

You'll cross a long wooden bridge and weave through grassy patches, trainer battles, and even a small cottage known as the Honey House, where an old man will offer you a rest. Don't be shy — it's one of the rare places in the game where you can heal for free outside of Pokémon Centers!

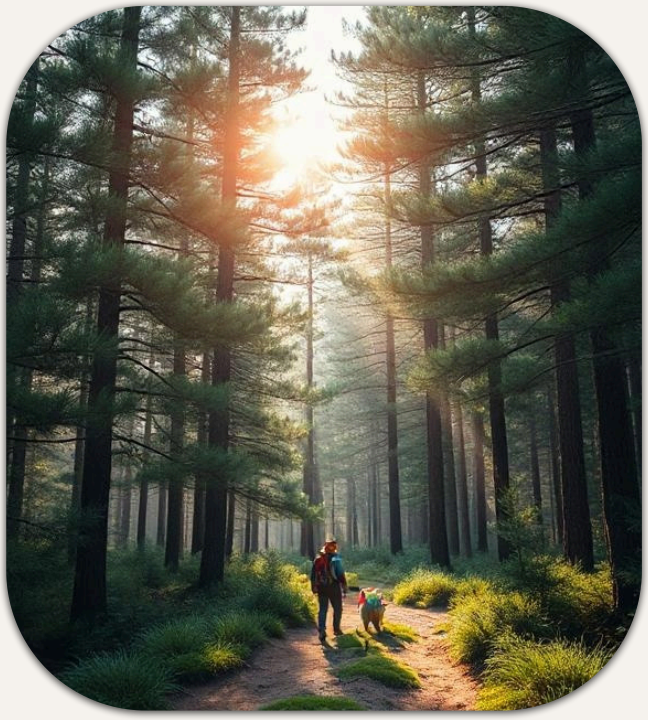
Just like Route 204, this one is also split into Northern and Southern Sections. This one is the Southern section and the other is right after Eterna Forest.

# Eterna Forest

## Towards Eterna City

Welcome to Eterna Forest, one of Sinnoh's most atmospheric locations — a dense, misty woodland filled with wild Pokémon, wandering Bug Catchers, and a surprising amount of mystery. This forest connects Route 205 to Eterna City, and it's one of the first areas in the game that really feels like an adventure. But don't worry — you're not going in alone! As soon as you enter the forest, you'll meet Cheryl, a kind trainer who's lost her way and asks to travel with you. She's an invaluable companion for a few reasons:

- She heals your Pokémon after every battle — no need to run back to a Pokémon Center!
- She'll assist in Double Battles, using her powerful Chansey to soak up hits (and sometimes accidentally knock out wild Pokémon — which can make catching tricky).



**Pro-tip**

If you want to catch Pokémon easily, you can actually knock out Chansey in battle. Don't worry — Cheryl won't be upset, and this way you can safely catch wild Pokémon without her interfering.

| Eterna Forest | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Budew | grass/poison | 10-12 | 40% |
| **Buneary** | normal | 11-13 | 24% |
| Wurmple | bug | 10 | 10% |
| Bidoof | normal | 12 | 10% |
| **Silcoon** | bug | 12 | 5% |
| **Cascoon** | bug/poison | 12 | 5% |
| **Gastly** | ghost/poison | 13 | 4% |
| **Beautifly** | flying/bug | 14 | 1% |
| **Dustox** | poison/bug | 14 | 1% |

# Eterna City

Eterna City and beyond!

Just before Eterna City you will reach Route 205 North. It's a straight forward Route with a few Fisherman to battle and the wild pokémon here are the same as in the southern section.

### Eterna City

Welcome to Eterna City, your next major hub! A lot opens up here both for story and for completionists.

- Explorer Kit: Given by the Underground Man here. This unlocks the Sinnoh Underground, a massive optional area where you can dig up Fossils, Evolution Stones, and TMs.
- Team Galactic HQ: You'll eventually storm it after Gardenia's Gym.
- Name Rater: You can rename your Pokémon here if you didn't nickname them before.

### The Underground – Sinnoh's Hidden World Beneath Your Feet

Now that you've received the explorer kit, it's time to unlock one of Pokémon Platinum's most beloved features — The Underground! This sprawling subterranean network is both a miner's paradise and a treasure hunter's dream. It's not part of the main story, but for completionists like us, it's absolutely essential.

### What You Can Do Underground

There's a lot to do here! Here are the highlights for completionists:

1. Mining for Treasure - Using your hammer and pickaxe, you can dig into the glittering walls to uncover all sorts of valuable finds.

Fossils: These are the main attraction for us completionists.

Armor Fossil → Revives into Shieldon (exclusive to Platinum if your Trainer ID is even).

Skull Fossil → Revives into Cranidos (exclusive to Platinum if your Trainer ID is odd).

Later on, with the National Dex, you can find older fossils like Claw, Root, Dome, and Helix Fossils, and even Old Amber for Aerodactyl! (This section continues to the next page)

# Underground Exploration!

Eterna City and beyond!

### What You Can Do Underground

2. besides fossils you can also find:

- Evolution Stones: Fire, Water, Leaf, Thunder, Dusk, Dawn, and Shiny Stones can all be found here.
- Spheres: Trade currency used for decorations and traps.
- Heart Scales: Used for relearning moves from the Move Reminder in Pastoria City.

**Pro tip**: Always dig carefully—your tools can break the wall if you're too reckless! Use the hammer for wide clearing and the pickaxe for precision work.

3. Secret Bases

You can make your very own underground hideout! Use a Digger Drill (traded for spheres) to carve out a secret base in a wall. You can decorate it with flags, statues, and furniture.

While this is mostly cosmetic, it's a charming side feature, especially for players who enjoy customizing their journey

4. Multiplayer Fun

If you're playing on an older DS system with friends, the Underground allows you to meet up, battle, trade, and play capture-the-flag mini-games. In single-player, you'll still encounter NPC diggers who sell items and offer challenges..

5. Collectibles and Statues

In Pokémon Platinum, you can dig up Shards (red, blue, green, and yellow), which can be traded for move tutor lessons later on. You'll also find statues used to decorate bases (though in Platinum, these are mostly decorative rather than functional).

Why It's Important for Completionists:

- If you want to fill your Pokédex, the Underground is essential with all the fossil you can find.
- Evolution Stones and Heart Scales found here help evolve and fine-tune your team.
- Later, after obtaining the National Dex, even more fossils become available — allowing you to complete the entire fossil Pokémon collection!

# Eterna Gym and Route 211

## Eterna City and beyond!

It's time to Challenge the gym! ...If you think you're up for it. If wou would like to do more training or catch more pokémon, you can head east from Eterna city to find Route 211, an optional Route containing some new wild Pokemon and trainers.
While you're here you can also enter the cave on this route for a couple of extra items. But this is no ordinary cave! This is Mount Coronet, a mountain that stretches through the region of Sinnoh splitting it in two. There isn't much to do here now but trust me, we will be coming back here a lot.

| Route 211 (West) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Meditite** | fighting/psychic | 13 | 20% |
| Bidoof | normal | 14 | 20% |
| Machop | fighting | 14-15 | 15% |
| **Chingling** | psychic | 14-16 | 15% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 14 | 10% |
| **Hoothoot** | normal/flying | 15 | 10% |
| **Bronzor** | steel/psychic | 16 | 10% |

### Eterna Gym

In Pokémon Platinum, the Eterna Gym features a massive flower clock. Each time you defeat one of the Gym trainers, the clock's petals rotate, creating a new walkway toward the gym leader, Gardenia. Once you've battled all the trainers and the petals line up, you'll reach her at the top platform. As you might have guessed, the typing of this gym is Grass. Grass has a lot of weaknesses which include fire, flying, ice, bug and poison. If you Chose Chimchar as your starter, this gym should go swimmingly!

# Gym Leader Gardenia

The Bloom of Battle!

| Gardenia's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Turtwig | Grass | 20 | Grass Knot<br>Razor Leaf<br>Sunny Day<br>Reflect |
| Cherrim | Grass | 20 | Grass Knot<br>Leech Seed<br>Magical Leaf<br>Safeguard |
| Roserade | Grass/Poison | 22 | Grass Knot<br>Magical Leaf<br>Poison Sting<br>Stun Spore |

Roserade is her ace and a serious threat — it's quick, has great Special Attack, and can cripple your team with Stun Spore. Grass Knot can deal heavy damage to heavier Pokémon, so don't underestimate it. The other two can also wear down your team so that Roserade can finish you off.

### Why Gardenia Can Be Tricky

- Reflect on Turtwig cuts your Physical sweepers' damage in half.
- Cherrim's Leech Seed can sap away your HP while you whittle it down.
- Roserade outspeeds most of your team and punishes you with paralysis and strong Grass attacks.

# Strategies against Gardenia

## The Bloom of Battle!

### Starter

Chimchar/Monferno - You're in luck! By now, your Chimchar should have evolved into Monferno at level 14 and learned Mach Punch — but more importantly, it should know Flame Wheel.

- Strategy: Lead with Monferno and use Flame Wheel or Ember on everything. Even Roserade goes down easily. Watch for: Stun Spore paralysis. Bring Parlyz Heals.

Piplup/Prinplup - Water and Grass don't mix well, so Piplup might struggle here.

- Strategy: Try to use other team members instead. If you absolutely must, you can also use peck in dire situations.

Turtwig/Grotle - Grass vs Grass isn't ideal, but Turtwig can hold its own with Tackle and Bite.

- Strategy: Use Bite to hit Roserade, and bring a Flying- or Fire-type ally to help with the rest.

### Other pokémon

There are some common flying and fire types that you might have in you team. Here are some good examples of pokémon that would do well against Gardenia:

- Staravia: Wing Attack wipes her entire team.
- Zubat/Golbat: Resistant to Grass and has Poison STAB moves.
- Ponyta: A classic Fire-type counter, fast and strong.
- Beautifly/Dustox: Not amazing, but can take some hits and strike back with Gust or Confusion.
- Bronzor: Steel resists grass and it can do decent damage with confusion especially against Roserade.

If you are struggling to win, consider adding some of the mentioned pokémon to your team and doing some training against wild pokémon or trainers that you have missed.

### After the battle

If you manages to win, Congratulations! You just earned the Forest Badge — it allows you to use Cut outside of battle! You can receive Cut from the Sinnoh Champion Cynthia if you haven't yet visited the other side of Eterna City. You also received TM86: Grass Knot —a great Grass-type move that deals more damage to heavier foes (good on Roserade, Grotle, or even Empoleon later).

Now it's time to take your newly earned badge and cut your way deeper into Team Galactic's schemes.

# Chapter 3 - Team Galactic Returns!

## Operation: Weeding Out Evil!

Now that Gardenia has been defeated and you can use Cut outside of battle, it's time to tackle the second Team Galactic hideout in Pokémon Platinum — the Eterna Galactic Building! This is where you'll finally get to confront their sinister leader, Commander Jupiter, and rescue a certain Pokémon in distress.

### Getting there

- From Eterna City's Pokémon Center, head east to the building surrounded by trees and shrubs.
- Use Cut to clear the small bushes blocking the path to the entrance.
- Step inside and prepare for a gauntlet of Galactic Grunts.

This building is the Galactic Eterna HQ, a multi-floor base filled with strange scientists, quirky dialogue, and a fair number of battles. Many more that at Valley Windworks.

### Layout and Exploration

The building has three floors. It's fairly linear, but there are a few items worth grabbing:

- X Speed – Ground floor, near the first grunt battle.
- TM46 – Thief – On the second floor, behind a grunt.
- Upgrade – On the top floor, after defeating Commander Jupiter. (Keep this safe! It's used to evolve Porygon into Porygon2 later.)

### Commander Jupiter

At the top floor, you'll finally meet Commander Jupiter, one of the three main Team Galactic executives alongside Mars.
She's as sharp-tongued as she is dangerous, and she's not about to let you meddle in her "research." Jupiter doesn't fully reveal what Team Galactic is up to yet, but she hints at their obsession with "harnessing cosmic energy" — and their experiments involving Pokémon energy and evolution.

Then, of course, she challenges you to a battle!

# Strategies against Jupiter

## Operation: Weeding Out Evil!

| Jupiter's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 21 | Giga Drain<br>Wing Attack<br>Bite<br>Confuse Ray |
| Skuntank | poison/dark | 23 | Night Slash<br>Poison Gas<br>Screech<br>Smokescreen |

### Strategy

Jupiter's Skuntank is one of the first real difficulty spikes in the game. It's tanky, it has great coverage, and its Night Slash can easily one-shot frailer Pokémon if it lands a critical hit.

- It's weak to Ground moves, so pokémon like Onix and Geodude can do well. They also have good defense against Skuntank's physical attacks.
- If you have Monferno, Mach Punch can chip it down safely.
- Staravia's Intimidate is excellent here to lower its Attack.
- Bide (from something like Kricketune) can work if you're patient — but it's risky.
- Bring a few Potions or Super Potions, because Skuntank's Night Slash crits can turn the fight around fast.

### After the battle

Once you defeat Jupiter, she'll admit defeat in that casually smug Galactic way and retreat, leaving behind their "research" and the Pokémon they were experimenting on.
It turns out the Pokémon you've rescued is a Buneary belonging to a small girl in Eterna City — who rushes in to thank you after the battle. You've saved the day!
With Team Galactic driven out, Eterna City returns to peace. Now several new things open up:

- Bike Shop: Visit the Bike Shop — the owner you saved will gift you a Bicycle, finally allowing you to travel south through Cycling Road!
- Pokémon egg: After leaving the Bike Shop, Cynthia will give you an egg witch will hatch into Togepi!
- Old Chateau: You can now freely explore the Old Chateau in Eterna Forest to catch a mysterious Ghost Pokémon…

# Old Chateau

## A Spooky Mansion Full of Secrets

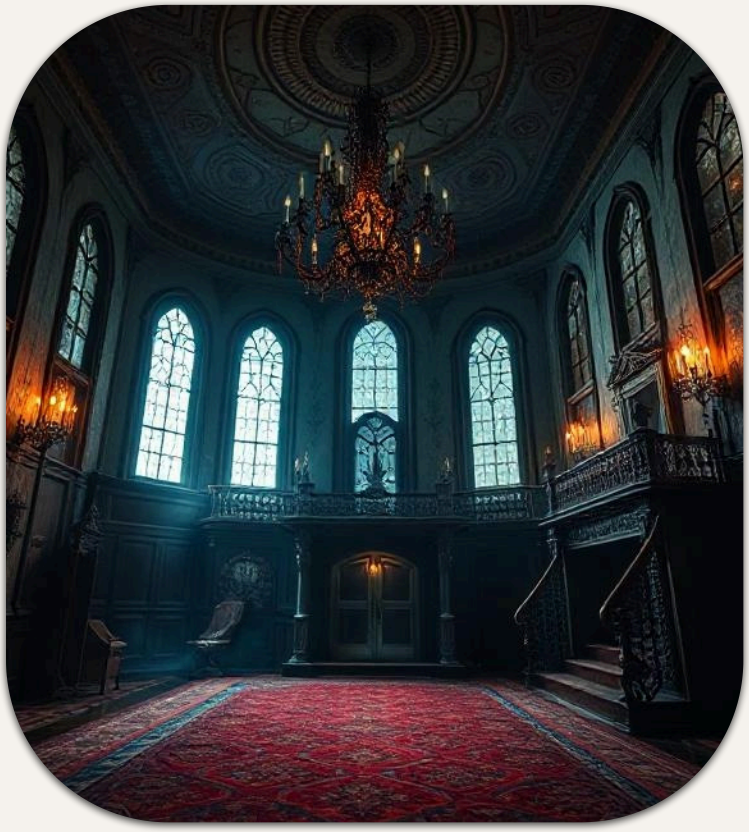
Now that Team Galactic has been kicked out of Eterna City, it's time for a short detour into one of Sinnoh's most eerie—and most fascinating—optional locations: the Old Chateau.
If you've got a love for mysteries, rare Ghost Pokémon, and maybe a few good scares, this place is a must-visit before you continue south.

### Finding the Old Chateau

From Eterna Forest's north entrance, simply head west from the gatehouse until you reach a clearing with an old, moss-covered mansion. It's impossible to miss once you see the crumbling walls and foreboding windows. Step inside, and you'll instantly feel the atmosphere change. The eerie music, the creaky floors, the flickering lights—this is Pokémon Platinum's haunted house moment.

### Layout and Wild Pokémon

The Old Chateau is small, but it has several rooms to explore across two floors.
Gastly is the only Pokémon that appears here as wild encounter.
The mansion is dimly lit and eerily quiet, with doors leading into empty dining rooms, bedrooms, and halls. While exploring, keep your eyes peeled—something feels off in this place…



### Special Encounter – Rotom

Now here's the real prize. In Platinum, the Old Chateau is home to a very special Ghost/Electric-type Pokémon: Rotom!

- Enter the Old Chateau at night (8 PM – 4 AM).
- Go to the top floor, middle room.
- Interact with the TV.
- A message will appear: "The TV has an odd sense of foreboding… Would you like to thump it?"
- Choose "Yes," and a battle with Rotom Lv.20 will begin!

Rotom is a unique Pokémon with multiple alternate forms so make sure to catch it!

# Cycling Road & Route 206

Pedal to the metal!

## Cycling Road

When you first step onto Cycling Road, you'll be on the upper level of Route 206, a long metal bridge that stretches southward from Eterna City all the way toward Oreburgh Gate. It's a straight shot downhill—and your first true biking experience!

- Requirements: Bicycle (you can't access this route without it)

As soon as you start pedaling, you'll automatically begin coasting downhill. You can still stop and talk to trainers, but beware—it's easy to accidentally zoom past them!

- Impornant! At the gate leading to the Cycling Road, talk to the scientist. He will give you the **exp. share**, a powerful item that gives the holder experience in battles even if it didn't participate!

## Trainers on Cycling Road

This place is crawling with Cyclists, eager to test your stamina and balance. Most use Electric or Flying-types, so Rock- and Ground-type Pokémon can handle them easily.
Common Pokémon among trainers include Ponyta, Staravia, Shinx and Starly
These battles are a great source of EXP for your mid-level team, especially if you're preparing for your next Gym in Hearthome City.

## Route 206 - Beneath the Bridge

Once you've flown down Cycling Road, it's time to backtrack a bit and explore the underpass of the bridge. This grassy area can be accessed by heading south from Eterna City and using Cut on the trees to the right of the Cycling Road gate.

| Route 206 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Geodude | rock/ground | 16-18 | 30% |
| Ponyta | fire | 16-17 | 30% |
| Machop | fighting | 17-19 | 20% |
| **Gligar** | ground/flying | 16-18 | 20% |

# Wayward Cave

## The secret of Wayward Cave

Beneath the Cycling Road's south end lies one of Sinnoh's most hidden gems—Wayward Cave. It's easy to miss because there are actually two entrances:

1. Visible entrance (east side): leads to a small cave with trainers and items.
2. Hidden entrance (west side, under the bridge): THIS is the one that leads to the secret chamber containing Gible, one of the strongest Dragon-types in the entire game!

### To find the hidden entrance

1. Stand directly under the bridge near the south end of Cycling Road.
2. Hug the left wall (the western side) and walk north.
3. You'll eventually enter the cave automatically—it's invisible from the outside.

### Inside the hidden Wayward Cave

This area has no trainers, but it's full of valuable items and, most importantly, Gible! Some notable items include:

- TM26 – Earthquake – Hidden in the far end of the secret Wayward Cave (one of the best TMs in the entire game!)
- TM32 – Double Team – Found in the visible section of Wayward Cave.
- Rare Candy – In the visible cave section.

| Route 206 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Bronzor | psychic/steel | 18-20 | 30% |
| Goedude | rock/ground | 18-20 | 25% |
| **Gible** | ground/dragon | 17-20 | 20% |
| Onix | rock/ground | 18-20 | 15% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 19 | 10% |

# Route 207 & Mt. Coronet

Headed towards Hearthome City!

### Fossil revival

Now that you've explored Cycling Road and Route 206, this is the perfect time to loop back to Oreburgh City since it's so close. there you can revive any Fossils you've collected from the Underground.

• Take the Fossil to the scientist at the Oreburgh Mining Museum, and he'll revive it instantly.

• Each Fossil gives you a unique Pokémon not otherwise found in the wild.

### Route 207 - North of Oreburgh

Route 207 connects Oreburgh City back up toward Mt. Coronet. You've been here once before, but now with your Bicycle you can finally climb the slopes and explore fully. There are plenty of trainers to battle here for some nice experience. Dawn/Lucas will also meet you here and give you the Vs Seeker! An item that allows you to rematch trainers, perfect for grinding some exp!

### Mt. Coronet

This central mountain will become a recurring location throughout your journey. Right now, you can only pass through a small connecting cave, but it still offers some encounters worth noting.

You'll meet Cyrus briefly here for the first time. He delivers a cryptic speech about space and time — he'll be important later, so pay attention!

### Wild Pokémon

Mt. Coronet has many different floors and caves with all sorts of pokémon to find. You might have already visited one part of the mountain near Eterna City. The wild pokémon here are mostly the same but with some new additions. You can find the encounter table on the next page.

# Route 208

Headed towards Hearthome City!

| Mt. Coronet (Route 207 entrance) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Geodude | rock/ground | 19 | 20% |
| Bronzor | steel/psychic | 18 | 20% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 19-20 | 15% |
| **Clefairy** | normal | 17 | 10% (night/morning) |
| Machop | fighting | 20 | 10% |
| Meditite | fighting/psychic | 20 | 10% |
| Chingling | psychic | 19 | 10% |
| **Nosepass** | rock | 18 | 5% |

### Route 208

Coming out of Mt. Coronet, you'll immediately find yourself on Route 208, a lush, hilly area that serves as the gateway to Hearthome. It's got both wild Pokémon and a solid group of trainers. Make sure to talk to a black belt trainer at the end of the route next to a honey tree. He will give you an **Odd Keystone** which will allow you to get Spiritomb later.

| Route 208 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Budew | grass/poison | 18-19 | 30% |
| Bidoof | normal | 18 | 20% |
| **Bibarel** | normal/water | 18-20 | 20% |
| **Ralts** | psychic | 17-18 | 15% |
| **Roselia** | grass/poison | 19-20 | 15% |

# Hearthome City

Headed towards the next gym battle!

Welcome to Hearthome City, the sparkling, friendly center of the Sinnoh region! It's a major milestone in your journey—home to contests, Amity Square, and one of the most memorable Gyms in the entire game. It's also the city of warmth and companionship, as both people and Pokémon thrive together here. There's a lot to do in Hearthome, so let's take a leisurely stroll through everything this city has to offer before we tackle its challenges. The very first to to do is go visit the house next to the Pokémon Center. This is Bebe's house and she will give an **Eevee**! This is a special pokémon that can evolve into many differrent forms and also a Fan favorite!

### Amity Square – Walk With Your Pokémon!

Located north of the Pokémon Center, this lovely park allows you to stroll with certain "cute" Pokémon (mostly starters and baby Pokémon). As you walk, your Pokémon might find Accessories for Contests or Berries. You can also find some hidden TMs here:

- TM43 – Secret Power (inside a ruin)
- TM45 – Attract (north section)

Tip: Bring your Pokémon in and out multiple times to collect all the hidden goodies.

### Pokémon Fan Club

Found in the northeast part of town, this cheerful building is filled with Trainers who adore their Pokémon. Talk to the Chairman—he'll give you a Poffin Case, which is essential for making Poffins for Pokémon Contests (we'll get to those soon!).

### Contest Hall

The shining centerpiece of Hearthome! Inside, you'll meet Fantina, the city's Gym Leader—though she won't battle you just yet. It is required to visit her here before you can enter the gym. You'll also meet your mom, who'll give you a Tuxedo (male) or Dress (female) for entering Pokémon Contests.

# Hearthome City Gym

## The Flashlight Phantasm

After a long wait, Fantina, the dazzling Ghost-type Gym Leader, is finally ready to face you! This battle marks a shift in difficulty—her team can hit surprisingly hard and use tricky status moves. The gym itself is also one of the most memorable in Pokémon Platinum, featuring an eerie flashlight maze.

### Gym Puzzle: The Maze of Light and Shadow

When you first enter the Hearthome Gym, the lights are completely off. You'll receive a Flashlight, which illuminates a small circle around your character. Your goal is to navigate the maze while looking for a symbol on the ground. once you find the symbol you have to find a door with the same symbol and go through it. There are three rooms in total and they are all full of trainers trying to battle you. They all use ghost type pokémon, who are weak to dark and ghost type moves. It is likely that at least one of your team members knows the move bite. It is a dark type move so use it to your advantage!

| Gym Leader Fantina's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Duskull | ghost | 24 | Will-o-wisp<br>Pursuit<br>Shadow Sneak<br>Future Sight |
| haunter | ghost/poison | 24 | Shadow Claw<br>Sucker Punch<br>Hypnosis<br>Confuse Ray |
| Mismagius | ghost | 26 | Shadow Ball<br>Psybeam<br>Magical Leaf<br>Confuse Ray |

# Strategies against Fantina

The Bloom of Battle!

### Why she's difficult

Fantina fights with style and disruption—expect lots of Confuse Ray and status effects. Her Pokémon are fast and evasive, and Mismagius in particular can sweep unprepared teams. Shadow Ball is a strong move that will surely deal with any unprepared trainer.

### Starter

- Chimchar/Monferno - Rely on Flame Wheel to deal with Duskull and Haunter, but be careful of Mismagius's Psybeam.
- Prinplup is slow but durable. Use BubbleBeam to clear Duskull and Haunter, but Mismagius will require patience—lower her health, then finish with Metal Claw if you have nothing super effective.
- Grotle - Grotle's Bite is your MVP move. Duskull's Will-O-Wisp can halve your Attack, so use antiburn items if needed. Against Mismagius, Bite 2HKOs if you're around Lv. 29, and Grotle's bulk lets it tank Magical Leaf comfortably.

### Other strategies

- Dark- and Ghost-type moves are super effective against her team. Pokemon that learn bite include pokémon such as Grotle, Luxio and Eevee.
- Normal-types like Bibarel or Staravia are immune to Ghost moves, but be careful of coverage like Magical Leaf.
- Confuse Ray is used by all her Pokémon, so Persim Berries or Full Heals are helpful.
- Mismagius has high special defense so you should prioritize physical attacks.

If you can't beat her, it might be a good idea to grind some levels. You should get your pokémon to at least level 26 to match her's. You can use the Vs Seeker and exp. share to your advantage.

### After the battle

Congratulations, trainer! You've just bested Fantina, the dazzling and ghostly master of Hearthome City!  As proof of your triumph, Fantina awards you the Relic Badge, a gleaming emblem that marks your growing status as a serious contender in the Sinnoh League. With this badge in hand, Pokémon up to Level 50 will now obey you without question. You'll also receive TM65 – Shadow Claw, a fast, high-critical-hit move that's perfect for slicing through Psychic- and Ghost-types (and a stylish addition to any moveset).

# Chapter 4 - Contest Hall

It's Show Time!

## A Beginner's Guide to Pokémon Contests

After all that battling and adventuring, it's time to give your Pokémon a chance to shine—literally! Welcome to the Hearthome City Contest Hall, the beating heart of Sinnoh's performance scene. This is where Trainers swap their Poké Balls for Poffins and show off their partners' beauty, cleverness, and style instead of brute strength. If you've ever dreamed of dazzling crowds instead of crushing foes, Contests are the perfect diversion!

## The Basics of Pokémon Contests

Contests in Pokémon Platinum are divided into five categories: Cool, Beauty, cute, Smart and Tough. Each category also has four ranks: Normal, Great, Ultra, and Master, which get progressively harder (and flashier). You'll need to win each rank in order before advancing to the next—so start small and work your way up to true stardom!
You'll also choose a Contest Style (Dress-Up theme) and perform a Dance and Acting performance, making each contest feel unique.

## The Contest Itself

Each Contest has three stages:

1. Visual Round (Dress-Up Stage) - You'll be given a theme—like "The Natural" or "The Formal"—and must dress up your Pokémon accordingly with accessories from your fashion case. The better you match the theme, the higher your score.
2. Dance Round - This is a rhythm minigame! You'll take turns dancing as the leader and follower. Hit the buttons in rhythm with the music—perfect timing earns big points.
3. Acting Round (Move Performance) - Here's where your Pokémon shows off its moves. Each move has a Contest type (Cool, Beauty, etc.) and a special effect. Try to use moves that match the contest's theme for bonus points, and time your choices based on your turn order to impress the audience.

# Barry Encounter!

## We're on the road again!

As you leave Hearthome heading east, you will have your second major encounter with Barry, your rival. His team is unique beacause it changes based on the starter you chose. He will always have the starter that is strong against your's and the rest of the team changes accordingly.
He will always have Staravia as his first pokémon and the rest of his team are a grass, water and fire type one of which is is starter.

| Barry's Pokémon | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Staravia | normal/flying | 25 | Wing Attack<br>Quick Attack<br>Endeavor<br>Double Team |
| Prinplup (If chimchar chosen) | water | 27 | Bubblebeam<br>Peck<br>Metal Claw<br>Growl |
| Monferno (If Turtwig chosen) | fire/fighting | 27 | Flame Wheel<br>Mach Punch<br>Fury Swipes<br>Leer |
| Grotle (If Piplup chosen) | grass | 27 | Razor Leaf<br>Tackle<br>Absorb<br>Withdraw |
| Roselia (If no Grotle) | grass/poison | 23 | Mega Drain<br>Poison Sting<br>Leech Seed<br>Stun Spore |
| Buizel (If no Prinplup) | water | 23 | Water Gun<br>Quick Attack<br>Pursuit<br>Growl |
| Ponyta (If no Monferno) | fire | 23 | Ember<br>Tackle<br>Tail Whip<br>Growl |

# Route 209

We're on the road again!

it's time to stretch those legs again and hit the road! Route 209 is one of Sinnoh's most memorable paths, packed with Trainers, water crossings, hidden items, and even a somber detour into the mysterious Lost Tower, not to mention the beautiful background music.
Route 209 is a grassy, scenic route filled with ponds, bridges, and berry trees. It's a bit longer than the routes you've faced so far, and it's crawling with eager Trainers who want a match with the newly crowned Hearthome Gym conqueror. You'll find both land and water encounters here, and plenty of useful items if you keep your eyes peeled.
You'll encounter a good variety here—Cyclists, Breeders, Joggers, and even a Fisherman or two. Breeders are particularly helpful, since they carry teams of low-level Pokémon that grant varied EXP—perfect for rounding out your weaker party members.

### Notable items

- Good Rod – Talk to the Fisherman near the first bridge.this one is essential for completionists!
- PP Up – Hidden near the water's edge.
- Nugget – Hidden on a rock to the north (use Dowsing Machine).
- Oval Stone – Found near the Lost Tower; used to evolve Happiny into Chansey.
- Calcium – Hidden near the final stretch before Solaceon.
- Great Ball & Hyper Potion – Lying around in plain sight for the observant Trainer.

| Route 208 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Bibarel | normal/water | 18-19 | 30% |
| Roselia | grass/poison | 19-20 | 25% |
| Zubat | poison/flying | 19 | 10% |
| Ralts | psychic | 17-19 | 10% |
| **Duskull** | ghost | 19 | 10% |
| **Staravia** | normal/flying | 18 | 10% |
| **Chansey** | normal | 17-19 | 5% |

# Spiritomb - The Forbidden Pokémon

We're on the road again!

Spiritomb is a special pokémon that can be found here on Route 209. It requires you to have the Odd Keystone Which you can get from Route 208 (Check out that section for more details). Getting it is quite complicated - but don't worry! We will go through this together!

## How to get Spiritomb

1. After getting the Odd Keystone, head to Route 209.
2. There's an old well-like structure called the Hallowed Tower. Place the Odd Keystone inside.
3. Now comes the hard part: you need to interact with 32 unique players in the Underground.

- This means you must talk to 32 different people while Underground.
- They don't have to be other real-world players! In Platinum, the game spawns NPCs you can interact with, and these count toward the total.
- Just keep digging and exploring Underground tunnels until you've spoken to enough.

4. Once you've done this, return to the Hallowed Tower on Route 209. A Level 25 Spiritomb will appear and challenge you.

## Battle tips

• Spiritomb is Ghost/Dark — meaning it has no weaknesses in Gen 4. Your best bet is to simply whittle it down.
• Bring a status inducer (Sleep Powder, Hypnosis, Thunder Wave) to make catching it easier.
• Spiritomb is rare, so save before the encounter — if you faint it, you'll have to repeat the entire 32-player interaction process.

# Lost Tower

We're on the road again!

A tall, eerie white building located roughly halfway through the route, the Lost Tower is Sinnoh's version of a Pokémon graveyard. It's both a sentimental and strategic stop—you'll find Ghost-type Pokémon and valuable held items here, as well as a few Trainers paying respects to their fallen partners.

## Trainers in the Lost Tower

Most Trainers here are Young Couples, Black Belts, and Psychic types, using Pokémon like Machop, Gastly, Zubat, and Clefairy. Bring something that can handle both Fighting and Ghost types efficiently—a strong Flying or Dark type like Staravia or Luxio will work wonders.

## Items in the Lost Tower

- Cleanse Tag – Given to you by an old lady on the top floor; reduces wild encounter rates.
- Spell Tag – Also given on the top floor; boosts Ghost-type move power.
- TM27 Return – A reward for reaching the summit! This move grows stronger with friendship, making it ideal for your starter or any Pokémon you've traveled far with.

| Lost Tower | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Gastly | ghost/poison | 18-21 | 45% |
| Zubat | flying/poison | 18-20 | 35% |
| Duskull | ghost | 18-20 | 20% |

# Solaceon Town & Ruins

We're on the road again!

After the long trek through Route 209, you finally arrive in Solaceon Town—a peaceful, rural settlement nestled between grassy hills and old stone ruins. This place might look sleepy, but for completionists, it's one of the most important stops in all of Sinnoh.

### Pokémon Day Care – The Breeder's Haven

The Day Care is located just west of town and run by two friendly caretakers. Here, you can leave up to two Pokémon to gain experience and, if compatible, produce Eggs. Here's why it's important:

- If you're aiming to complete your Pokédex, many Pokémon can only be obtained through breeding.
- If you leave two Pokémon of the same Egg Group, and one is male and the other female, you'll eventually get an egg containing the baby form of their species.
- Ditto (if you've traded one in or imported it via Pal Park later) can breed with almost anything, making it the ultimate egg-maker.

### Solaceon Ruins

To the east of town lies one of Sinnoh's oldest and most mysterious sites: the Solaceon Ruins. These winding chambers are home to the enigmatic Pokémon Unown, each shaped like a letter of the alphabet. Make sure to catch at least on while you're here.

### Layout and navigation

The ruins are a series of chambers branching off from a central staircase. The path can be confusing, but don't worry—we'll make sure you don't miss a thing. Correct Path to the Final Chamber. From the entrance:

→ Up right, Down left,  Up right,  Up left, Up left, Down left

Follow this order to reach the final room, where the most valuable treasures await!

The deepest chamber rewards explorers with:

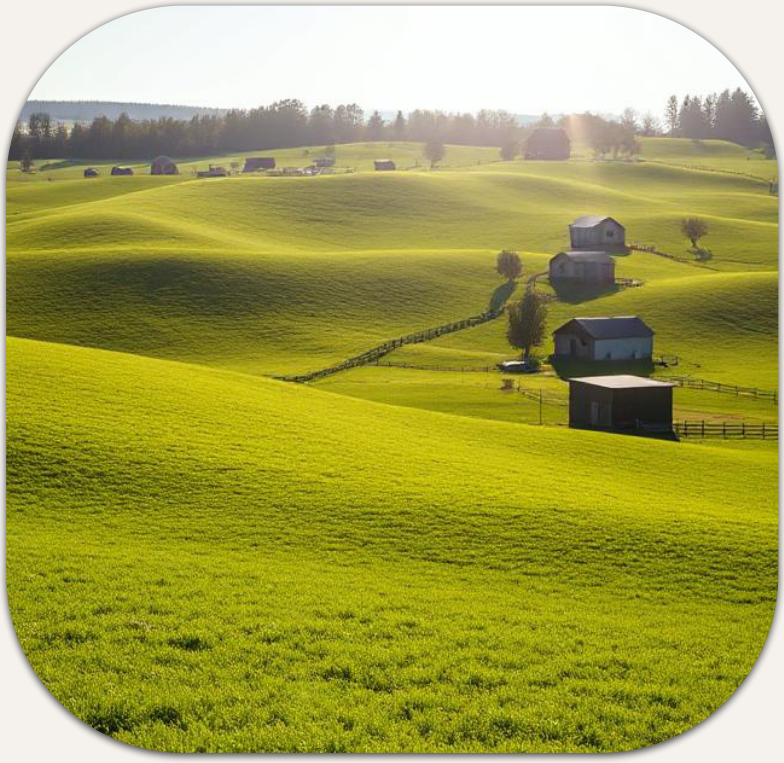
- HM05 Defog – A must-have for navigating foggy routes later (especially Route 210 North)
- Mind Plate – A Psychic-type boosting item and one of Arceus' Plates.
- Nugget – Sell for some cash!
- Odd Incense – Breeding item used to obtain Mime Jr. from Mr. Mime or Chansey → Happiny.

By going the wrong way in the corridors you can also find evolution stones. These are very important for evolving your team members and filling the Pokédex.

# Route 210 South

We're on the road again!

After a well-earned rest in Solaceon Town, it's time to head north toward Route 210. This sprawling, two-part route connects Solaceon to both Celestic Town and Veilstone City, but at this point in the story, only the southern section is accessible. The Northern path is blocked by Psyduck!. but don't worry—you'll return later once you've obtained a special item. The southern section of Route 210 is a mix of open grasslands, tall grass patches, and a few scattered trainers most of whom are farmers.



### MooMoo Milk Stop

On the way east toward Route 215, you'll pass a house/café with trainers inside. This is the MooMoo Milk vendor, and it's one of the most useful spots for long-term play. The items are very efficient and you should stock up on a lot of them. You can't have too many of these!

| Route 210 (South) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Ponyta | Fire | 19-21 | 25% |
| Geodude | rock/ground | 18 | 20% |
| Staravia | normal/flying | 19 | 20% |
| **Scyther** | bug/flying | 19-21 | 15% |
| Roselia | grass/poison | 20-21 | 15% |
| Chansey | normal | 19-21 | 5% |

# Route 215

We're on the road again!

### Route 215 – Rain, Rivals, and Rough Terrain

Leaving the peaceful hills of Route 210 behind, you step onto Route 215, a rugged, rain-soaked stretch of road leading directly to Veilstone City. The moment you arrive, the sky darkens and rain begins to pour—welcome to one of Sinnoh's most atmospheric routes! The slick terrain, scattered bridges, and abundance of Fighting-type trainers make this a testing ground for your team's endurance before the next Gym challenge.

### Route Layout

Route 215 is a narrow, twisting mountain road filled with puddles, bridges, and grassy areas between rocky outcroppings. The constant rainfall isn't just for atmosphere—it actively affects battles, powering up Water-type attacks while reducing the power of Fire-type moves. If you rely on Fire-types (like Monferno or Ponyta), you'll need to play a little smarter here.
You'll also notice the raised platforms and bridges, making this one of the more complex routes in Sinnoh's central region. Keep your eyes peeled for hidden items along the walls!
**Notable items** here include TM 34 Shock Wave, TM 66 Payback and Fist Plate.

| Route 210 (South) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Staravia | flying/normal | 19-21 | 30% |
| **Marill** | water | 20-22 | 25% |
| Scyther | bug/flying | 20-22 | 15% |
| Abra | psychic | 19 | 10% |
| **Kadabra** | psychic | 21-22 | 10% |
| **Lickitung** | normal | 20 | 10% |

# Veilstone City

## The City of Stone and Stars

Welcome to Veilstone City, the beating heart of northern Sinnoh! Known for its rocky terrain, meteorites, and massive department store, this is one of the most important stops on your journey. Not only is this city the home of the fourth Gym Leader, Maylene, but it's also where you'll first come face-to-face with Team Galactic's growing operations.
If Floaroma was your peaceful flower town and Hearthome your glittering stage, Veilstone is where things get serious—both for your Pokémon and for the region's storyline.

### City Layout and Key Locations

**1. Veilstone Department Store**
Let's start with the most exciting part—shopping!
This towering complex has five floors packed with everything a Trainer could want: Potions pokéballs, battle items, TMs and accessories! Make sure to stop by the TM floor; it's one of the few times you can actually buy such powerful moves.
**2. Game Corner** (sort of…)
In Pokémon Platinum, the Game Corner's slot machines were replaced (due to rating restrictions), but you can still explore the building. You'll meet people who talk about Coins and Prize Pokémon, a nostalgic callback to the old days. Sadly, there's no gambling here—but you can still buy coins and exchange them for poverful TMs.
**3. Galactic Veilstone Building**
You can't miss it—the big, intimidating structure with a satellite dish sticking out of it. This is Team Galactic's main base, but for now, you can't fully access it.
**4. Free Pokémon: Porygon**
In one of the houses near the Galactic HQ building, a man will gift you a **Porygon**. It's completely free, making it one of the rarest gift Pokémon in the game.

# Veilstone City Gym

## Maylene, the Fighting Prodigy

Welcome to Veilstone Gym, home of Maylene, Sinnoh's fierce Fighting-type expert! She's young, strong, and trains alongside her Pokémon every day to push her limits. This Gym will test both your battle strategy and your ability to outmaneuver some rather heavy obstacles.

### Gym Layout and Puzzle

Gone are the days of simple switches and levers—Veilstone Gym is more like a fitness course than an arena. The entire building is filled with massive punching bags suspended on rails, which you'll need to push around to knock down walls of tires blocking your path to Maylene.
Here's how it works: Step up to a punching bag and run toward it to push it along its rail.
When the bag swings, it will smash through the stack of tires in its way.
You'll need to clear multiple paths by moving the bags in different directions and creating a route to the back of the Gym, where Maylene is waiting.
It's not the hardest puzzle in Sinnoh, but it's a satisfying one—and quite fitting for a Fighting-type Gym!
Tip: If you get stuck, reset the Gym by exiting and re-entering. This will return all punching bags to their starting positions.
At the end of the gym, you will Find Maylene, The gym Leader. Maylene's team is fast and deceptively strong. Ready to defeat any unprepared trainer.

| Gym Leader Maylene's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Meditite | fighting/psychic | 28 | Drain Punch<br>Confusion<br>Rock Tomb<br>Fake Out |
| Machoke | fighting | 29 | Karate Chop<br>Rock Tomb<br>Strength<br>Focus Energy |
| Lucario | fighting/steel | 32 | Drain Punch<br>Force Palm<br>Metal Claw<br>Bone Rush |

# Strategies against Maylene

## Maylene, the Fighting Prodigy

### Starter

**Turtwig Line** (Grass/Ground):
If your Grotle has evolved into T orterra already, you'll have solid defense and a solid new move - Earthquake! This powerful move should be able to get through just about anything, especially the Lucario since it's a steel type. Even as a Grotle it can chip away with grass moves.
**Chimchar Line** (Fire/Fighting):
Monferno does decently well here, especially against lucario. You best bet is to use your other pokémon aginst Meditite and Machoke and finish the match with Monferno's super-effective Flame Wheel!
**Piplup Line** (Water/Steel):
Not ideal at first, but Prinplup can tank a few hits. Teach it Peck or BubbleBeam—though pairing it with a Psychic or Flying-type partner makes this fight much safer.

### Other strategies

Fighting types are weak to flying and psychic so if you have those in your team, use them. However, because Lucario is also a steel type, it will take neutral damage from those moves. Here are some strong pokémon in this battle:
• Staravia / Staraptor - Flying STAB wrecks Fighting-types. Intimidate also helps weaken physical damage.
• Kadabra / Alakazam - Outspeeds and blasts with Psychic STAB.
• Drifloon / Drifblim - Ghost typing is immune to Fighting moves. Watch out for Lucario's Metal Claw, though.

- Ground or fighting types against Lucario and ghost types against Meditite
- Status conditions - If you have something like Thunder Wave or Stun Spore, those can be very effective

### After the battle

Congratulations—you've earned the Cobble Badge! With this badge, you'll now be able to use Fly outside of battle (once you've obtained the HM). You'll also receive TM60 – Drain Punch, a great physical Fighting move that restores half the damage dealt as HP. It's perfect for tanky Pokémon like Machamp, Gallade, or Lucario.

# Chapter 5 - Route 214

## Trouble with Team Galactic!

After earning the Cobble Badge, you'll bump into Dawn/Lucas just outside the Veilstone Gym. They're upset because Team Galactic has stolen their Pokédex! Naturally, it's hero time.

### Battle against Team Galactic

You'll team up with Dawn/Lucas in a Double Battle against two Galactic Grunts. Expect Zubat, Croagunk, and Stunky in the Lv.25–27 range. Dawn/Lucas's Pokémon won't do much damage, so don't count on them to carry. But at the end of the day they are just simple Grunts, not too much of an issue.
After the battle your friend gets their Pokédex back and you get to make a quick visit into the galactic warehouse. You can only access the very beginning of this area because all the doors are locked but you do find HM 03 Fly - a powerful flying type move that you can use to fly to cities and towns you have visited before. Very convenient for backtracking!

### Route 214

Leaving Veilstone to the south, Route 214 stretches into a long path filled with trainers, tall grass, and even a small optional side area called the Ruin Maniac Cave where you can find **Hippopotas** - a new pokémon appearing with a 10% encounter rate.
Trainers are generally in the Lv.23–27 range. They pack a mix of Rock, Psychic, and Grass Pokémon. The Psychic trainers can be annoying if you don't have Dark coverage yet.

| Route 214 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Graveler** | rock/ground | 22-24 | 35% |
| **Houndour** | fire/dark | 23-24 | 25% |
| Geodude | rock/ground | 21 | 20% |
| **Rhyhorn** | rock/ground | 21-24 | 20% |

# Valor Lakefront

## Towards Pastoria City!

Our next destination takes us down to the sunny shores of Valor Lakefront—a serene but curious area that marks the halfway point between bustling cities and open wilderness.
This stretch connects Route 214 in the north to Route 213 in the south, with the Grand Lake Hotel and its many houses serving as the centerpiece. While it's a fairly short area, it's packed with interesting NPCs, unique items, and a few important story flags later in the game.

### Seven Stars Restaurant

Although there isn't much to do here now,  there's a restaurant called Seven Stars Restaurant. t's a good place to earn money and experience through Double Battles against wealthy patrons. As you progress through the game the trainers also get tougher, making this a great spot to gain experience even in the later parts of the game.

| Valor Lakefront | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Bibarel | normal/water | 25-27 | 30% |
| **Girafarig** | normal/psychic | 26-28 | 25% |
| Staravia | normal/flying | 26-28 | 25% |
| Houndour | fire/dark | 27 | 10% |
| **Kricketune** | bug | 27 | 10% |

# Route 213

## Towards Pastoria City!

Welcome to Route 213, one of the most scenic stretches in all of Sinnoh! After the structured streets of Veilstone and the calm luxury of Valor Lakefront, this beachside route feels like a breath of fresh sea air. The warm sands, seaside cottages, and glimmering water give it a holiday feel—but don't be fooled! There's still plenty of battling, exploring, and catching to be done here.

### Notable Trainers

Most Trainers here use Water-type or normal-type Pokémon that fit the seaside theme. The Tubers (the little kids playing in the surf) tend to use Shellos or Buizel, and a few Fishermen will challenge you to rod battles. Great experience for Electric or Grass-types, and a safe place to level before the next Gym.

### Route 214

There are quite a few goodies scattered around the route:

- TM40 Aerial Ace – On the eastern cliffs near the exit to Pastoria. Great move with guaranteed accuracy, perfect for coverage or countering Double Team spammers.
- Heart Scale – Hidden in the sand. Use your Dowsing Machine often—it's easy to miss! Heart Scales can be exchanged at the Move Reminder in Pastoria for forgotten moves.
- Shell Bell – A helpful held item found near one of the beach houses. Restores a small amount of HP every time you deal damage.
- Berries – There's a small berry patch near the northern end of the route.

| Route 213 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Shellos | water | 24-26 | 35% |
| Buizel | water | 23-25 | 25% |
| **Wingull** | water/flying | 24-26 | 20% |
| **Chatot** | normal/flying | 23-25 | 20% |

# Pastoria City

The Wetlands Jewel of Sinnoh

Welcome to Pastoria City, the heart of Sinnoh's southern marshlands! After trekking across the bright shores of Route 213, you'll step into a much different landscape—humid, lush, and buzzing with wild life. Pastoria might not be as large as Jubilife or Veilstone, but it has a rustic charm and a surprising amount of importance to both the story and the completionist's checklist.

## Overview

Pastoria is known primarily for two things: the Great Marsh (Sinnoh's Safari Zone) and the Water-type Gym run by the burly, energetic Crasher Wake. The entire town is built around the marshy wetlands, so you'll find ponds, docks, and wooden walkways everywhere you go. The music even gives off a relaxed, swampy vibe—a calm before the storm of your next big Gym challenge.

## Things to do here

Besides the obvious gym battle, there are more things to do here:

- Move Reminder's House - This is huge. Inside the small house north of the Poké Mart lives the Move Reminder, who can reteach any move a Pokémon could have learned at a lower level—in exchange for a Heart Scale. You should've found a few Heart Scales already (from Route 213 or the Underground).
- The Great Marsh Entrance Building - Sinnoh's version of the Safari Zone. Here you can catch rare pokemon that can't be found anywhere else. We will go through this area in detail on the next page.

# The Great Marsh

## The Wetlands Jewel of Sinnoh

Welcome to the Great Marsh, Sinnoh's own Safari Zone—and one of the most unique (and sometimes frustrating) areas in the entire game! Located at the north end of Pastoria City, this massive swampland is both a completionist's dream and a test of patience. Rare Pokémon, daily changes, and an unusual capture system make this one of the most important stops for anyone filling the Sinnoh Pokédex.

### How it works

When you enter the building north of the city, you'll find two floors:

- Top Floor: Contains binoculars (cost 100 Poké per use). These let you peek at what Pokémon are in the marsh that day. It's random which six areas will have special spawns, so if you're hunting for something specific (like Carnivine, Tropius, or Skorupi), this is a must.
- Ground Floor: The Safari entrance itself. Pay 500 Poké to enter, and you'll receive 30 Safari Balls and 200 steps before you're automatically returned to the gate.

Catching Pokémon here works differently than anywhere else in Sinnoh:

- You can't weaken Pokémon with your own team. Instead, you can:
- Throw Safari Balls
- Throw Bait (makes Pokémon less likely to flee, but harder to catch)
- Throw Mud (makes Pokémon easier to catch, but more likely to flee)

It's a balancing act between angering or pleasing your quarry. Some Pokémon will flee no matter what, so be prepared for a few heartbreaks—especially if you spot something rare.

| Great Marsh | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Base encounters | | | |
| **Wooper** | **Quagsire** | Hoothoot | **Yanma** |
| Bibarel | **Tangela** | | |
| Binocular encounters | | | |
| Roselia | Staravia | **Skorupi** | **Drapion** |
| **Croagunk** | **Toxicroak** | **Carnivine** | |

# Pastoria City Gym

## The Raging Waves of Crasher Wake!

Time to make a splash—literally! The Pastoria City Gym is home to Crasher Wake, the exuberant, mask-wearing Water-type Gym Leader who treats every battle like a pro wrestling match. His gym is full of water puzzles, strong aquatic Pokémon, and enough water pressure to drown a Machamp. Let's dive in!

### Gym Layout & Puzzle Guide

This gym's puzzle revolves around raising and lowering the water level using large yellow, green, and blue buttons scattered throughout the area. Each button changes how high or low the water rises, allowing you to access new walkways and trainers. Work your way from switch to switch, gradually flooding the arena until you can walk straight to Wake Expect a lineup full of Water Pokémon like Buizel, Wingull, Shellos, Gyarados, and Azumarill. These can hit hard if you're underleveled, but if you've got strong Electric or Grass moves, you'll breeze through.

| Gym Leader Wake's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Gyarados | water/flying | 33 | Waterfall<br>Brine<br>Bite<br>Twister |
| Quagsire | water/ground | 34 | Mud Shot<br>Rock Tomb<br>Water Pulse<br>Yawn |
| Floatzel | water | 37 | Brine<br>Ice Fang<br>Crunch<br>Aqua Jet |

# Strategies against Wake

## The Raging Waves of Crasher Wake!

### Starter

- **Turtwig/Grotle/Torterra**: You're in luck! Grass resists Water, and Quagsire is no problem at all. The main threat is Ice Fang from Floatzel—Torterra should use Leech Seed or Razor Leaf to heal and strike hard, but consider switching out if things look dangerous.
- **Chimchar/Monferno/Infernape**: Fire isn't ideal here, but Monferno's Fighting-type moves help against Floatzel's weaker Defense. Use Mach Punch or Close Combat for chip damage, and bring an Electric-type ally to handle Gyarados safely.
- **Piplup/Prinplup/Empoleon**: Mirror match! Your own Water-type won't do much damage, so rely on Peck/Pluck for Quagsire or Grass Knot if you've taught it. Empoleon's Steel typing later on will make you nearly immune to Floatzel's Crunch, but for now, you'll need backup—Electric or Grass coverage is key.

### Other strategies

- Luxray – The MVP for this gym. Luxray outspeeds Gyarados and can OHKO with Spark or Thunder Fang. Against Floatzel, Luxray's solid bulk helps it tank Ice Fang and strike back hard.
- Rotom – Has an advantage hanks to its Ghost/Electric typing. If you've caught Rotom, this is a fantastic time to use it—Thunderbolt obliterates Wake's whole team except for Quagsire.
- Roserade – Its high Special Attack means Grass Knot or Giga Drain will melt Quagsire instantly. Be wary of Ice Fang from Floatzel, though—use Sleep Powder or Stun Spore to slow it down first.
- Any other Grass or Electric type can also do well.

### After the battle

Congratulations, trainer! After sending Wake back to his wrestling ring, you receive the Fen Badge, letting you use Surf outside of battle. You also get TM55 (Brine) – a Water-type move that doubles in power if the opponent's HP is below half.

Wake also congratulates you with his usual theatrical flair—he's a good sport about it!

After exiting the gym, you'll notice a Team Galactic Grunt acting suspicious near the north gate. He mentions something about a "bomb" and "the lake." Uh oh.

But before you chase him down, head to the Poké Mart and stock up—you've earned it. And now that you have the Fen Badge, the region truly opens up—Surf will soon become one of your most important tools.

# Chapter 6 - More Galactic Trouble

Getting deeper into Galactic's plan!

## Galactic Chase

Fresh off your victory over Crasher Wake, a Team Galactic Grunt sprints out of the Pastoria Safari Zone gate. Barry shows up and bumbles around, but it's you who has to give chase. The Grunt flees east to Route 213. You will have to chase him down and challenge him to a battle. After the easy victory, Cynthia intercepts you and hands over the SecretPotion, which you'll need for the Psyduck roadblock on Route 210. That will be our next destination and since you just got Fly, this is a perfect moment to utilize it and fly straight to Solaceon Town, the closest town to Route 210.

## Route 210 North

With the Secret Potion in hand, you can now give it to the Psyducks blocking the road. Cynthia then appears and hands you the Old Charm, asking you to deliver it to her grandmother in Celestic Town.

Route 210 is a foggy route with plenty of strong trainers. If you have a pokémon in your party who can Defog, it is recommended to do that so you don't have worry about your vision or missing all of your moves in battle. Seriously, the fog gets really annoying!

You'll face Ninja Boys with Croagunk, Dustox, and Golbat, plus Bird Keepers with Noctowl or Swablu. Also there are some veterans and Ace trainers with more pokémon variety.

| Route 210 (North) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Swablu** | flying/normal | 27 | 30% |
| Meditite | fighting/psychic | 27-29 | 20% |
| Bibarel | normal/water | 28 | 20% |
| Machop | fighting | 28-29 | 15% |
| **Machoke** | fighting | 29-30 | 10% |
| Scyther | bug/flying | 29 | 5% |

# Celestic Town

Getting deeper into Galactic's plan!

Celestic is a small, historic village, home to ruins and lots of lore. After delivering the Old Charm, things heat up quickly. A Galactic Grunt is harassing the ruins. Beat him, and then Cyrus the leader of Galactic himself shows up, He reveals his grand, unsettling ambitions — reshaping the universe — and challenges you to battle.

### Battle against Cyrus

Cyrus's team consists of Sneasel (levl 34), Golbat (level 34) and Murkrow (level 36). His team isn't too bulky but is fast and can hit hard. Thankfully his pokémon aren't too hard to deal with yet but this isn't the last time you will battle him and he will come back much stronger. For now, he retreats and Cynthia's grandmother thanks you and explains the mural inside the ruins — a depiction of Dialga, Palkia, and Giratina. This scene is key to the story and moves the Galactic plot forward. She also gives you HM03 Surf, one of the best Water-type moves and a vital exploration tool. Surf unlocks many optional routes, hidden items, and new Pokémon.

### Things to do in Celestic Town

This place doesn't have much to do but you should at least visit the shop. Inside, there's a man who will give you one of four types of special glasses each day:

- Wise Glasses (boost Special Attacks)
- BlackGlasses (boost Dark moves)
- Choice Specs (massive Sp. Atk boost, but locks you into one move)

This is also a good time to west to Route 211. There are some optional trainer battles and items but we have already seen all the wild pokémon there. It's a good place for getting some training done.

# Surf Backtracking

## Taking a detour

With HM03 Surf in hand, a huge chunk of Sinnoh opens up. While none of this is required right now to progress the story, completionists should take advantage of this freedom. Surf lets you scoop up powerful TMs, rare Pokémon, hidden items, and even access previously locked-off areas We will be going through some of the most influential surfing spots and optional areas. Most areas share the same encounters being mostly **Tentacool, Tentacruel, Wingull and pelipper**.

### Places to visit

**Lake Verity** - You can surf for a powerful TM - Fire blast!

**Oreburgh Gate** - With Surf, you can now reach TM31 Brick Break — an excellent Fighting-type TM.

**Fuego Ironworks** (north of Floaroma Town) - Previously unreachable, you can Surf up the river to reach this factory-like optional dungeon.

• Wild Magnemite and Magmar (great team options).

- TM35 Flamethrower, one of the best TMs in the game.
- A slew of Fire Stones for evolutions.

**Valley Windwork**s:

- TM24 Thunderolt, another one of the best TMs in the game.
- Electrizer to evolve Electabuzz into Electivire

Sandgem Town - Surifing South will get you to Route 219, 220 and eventually 221. That's a lot of ground to cover!. Route 219 and 220 are basic water routes with the same encounters and it features a lot of trainers with water type pokémon. Route 221 however, is a little more interesting. We will go through that on the next page.

# Route 221 & 212

## Taking a detour

Route 221, a peaceful seaside route that connects Route 220 (just south of Sandgem Town) to the Pal Park—a place that will become important later in your completionist journey, but isn't unlocked just yet. This route doesn't have many trainers or landmarks, but it's filled with wild Pokémon, hidden treasures, and some neat surprises for those who take the time to explore. It's also a wonderful change of pace—a quiet coastal route after the chaos of Team Galactic.

| Route 221 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Sudowood** | rock | 29-31 | 25% |
| Girafarig | normal/psychic | 28-30 | 25% |
| Roselia | grass/poison | 28-30 | 25% |
| Floatzel | water | 29-31 | 25% |

### Route 212 and the Pokémon Mansion

Route 212 is another optional route south of Hearthome. Route 212 is long and split into two sections: the northern grounds near Hearthome (where the Pokémon Mansion is) and the southern swamp near Pastoria. It's littered with trainers and wild pokémon which we have already seen. The main attraction is the pokémon mansion.

Found at the north end of Route 212, the Mansion is home to Mr. Backlot and his prized Trophy Garden. You can find **Pichu** and **Pikachu** in the Trophy Garden - two pokémon we haven't seen yet.

Inside the Mansion's library is a Legendary Book. This book contains a Pokédex entry for Manaphy, the mythical pokémon. This is important: seeing Manaphy here counts toward your Sinnoh Pokédex. Make sure to interact with the book.

You can also battle a line of maids in the Mansion once per day.

- The challenge is to defeat them in a set number of turns.
- The reward isn't major (Berries), but for completionists, it's a neat daily repeatable battle and free trainer experience.

# Route 218

## Surfing to Canalave City

### The Gateway to Canalave City

Ah, Route 218—finally, a route that connects two halves of Sinnoh in a meaningful way! This seaside stretch links Jubilife City to Canalave City, and for the first time, you'll be using surf to progress the story. The ocean breeze, the soft crashing of waves, and the promise of new adventures ahead—this route marks a turning point in your journey.

### Overview

Route 218 is a short but vital path that was previously blocked by water earlier in the game. Now that you can Surf, you can cross the waves and reach the port city of Canalave—a hub of steel, ships, and one of Sinnoh's most important Gyms.
The route itself consists of a short water segment west of Jubilife and a small piece of land dotted with trainers, fishermen, and a few patches of tall grass.

### Trainers and items

Despite its small size, Route 218 offers a few interesting battles—perfect for warming up before the challenges in Canalave. The fishermen can have powerful pokémon like Gyarados and some of the sailors have pokémon such as Machoke
You can surf to the Northeastern corner of the route to find a rare candy. A nice level boost! there's also Razor Fang near the western shore, hidden on the beach. Needed to evolve Gligar into Gliscor—so absolutely don't miss this if you're going for full Pokédex completion!

| Route 218 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Floatzel | water | 29-31 | 30% |
| **Mr. Mime** | psychic | 29-31 | 25% |
| **Gastrodon** | water/ground | 28-30 | 25% |
| Chatot | normal/flying | 28-30 | 20% |

# Canalave City

## The Port of Iron and Discovery

Welcome to Canalave City, the proud port of western Sinnoh! The smell of saltwater, the clang of steel, and the steady hum of ships define this industrial seaside town. It's a mix of modern mechanics and old-world charm—a place where sailors trade stories and scientists make groundbreaking discoveries.
most important cities, both for the main story and for postgame exploration later on. You'll face one of the toughest Gym Leaders here, meet a familiar professor with big news, and even discover a mysterious island filled with rare Pokémon.

### Battle against Barry!

As soon as you step foot onto the drawbridge in the middle of the city, your rival Barry shows up for an immediate challenge—no warm-up, no warning, just pure chaos like always! Make sure to heal at the Pokémon Center before heading this way.
Just like last time, his team changes based on your starter. He will always have both Staraptor and Heracross. Then depending on whichever type his starter is not, he will have two out of Floatzel, Rapidash and Roserade. Finally his starter is always strong against your own and it will be fully evolved at level 39!.
Barry's team has come a long way since your last encounter. He leads with Staraptor, which likes to open with Intimidate, so lead with a Special Attacker if possible.

- Electric-types like Luxray handle Staraptor and Floatzel.
- Fire-types such as Rapidash or Infernape handle Roserade and Heracross.
- If you have a Flying-type (Staraptor, Togekiss), it makes Heracross a non-issue.

After the fight, Barry rushes off to Iron Island, hinting that it's the next area to explore—though the Gym is also now available!

# Iron Island

## The Heart of Steel

Time to hop aboard that ferry at the Canalave docks and set sail for Iron Island, a rugged and mysterious place off Sinnoh's western coast. It's an optional area, but you'd be crazy to skip it! Not only is it great for training before Byron's Gym, but you'll also meet a new ally who gives you a very special Pokémon egg. It is recommended to keep one slot in your party empty so you can get the egg at the end of the island but you can also come get it later.

### Exploration

To get there, talk to the sailor at the Canalave City dock, and he'll offer to ferry you over. It's a short trip, but once you arrive, you'll find yourself at a lonely pier leading into a massive cave system built into the island's heart. Shortly after entering the deeper levels, you'll meet Riley, a friendly Trainer dressed like a cool blue ranger with a Lucario by his side. He'll offer to team up with you, healing your Pokémon after every battle while you travel together through the lower floors. His Lucario is level 41, making it a powerful companion!

Deeper into Iron Island, you'll find a small group of Team Galactic grunts causing trouble, mining something for mysterious reasons. Riley joins you to stop them, and you'll battle in a Double Battle alongside him After defeating them, Riley offers you a Pokémon Egg which will hatch into a **Riolu**!

| Iron Island (deepest floor) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Graveler** | rock/ground | 31-34 | 50% |
| **Steelix** | steel/ground | 32-35 | 30% |
| **Golbat** | flying/poison | 31-33 | 20% |

# Canalave Gym

## The Iron Fortress

Welcome to Canalave City Gym, home of Byron, the master of Steel-type Pokémon and father of Roark—the very first Gym Leader you faced! You've come full circle, and this battle will test your strength, endurance, and ability to crack through the toughest defenses Sinnoh has to offer.The Canalave Gym is a massive warehouse-like structure filled with elevators, platforms, and steel walkways. The puzzle here involves navigating a network of moving lifts to reach the top floor, where Byron awaits. The puzzle mostly comes doen to trial and error.

### Trainers

These trainers specialize in Steel-types, so Ground- and Fire-type moves will make quick work of their teams. Most of them have lower special defense so try using special moves!

| Gym Leader Byron's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Magneton | steel/electric | 37 | Flash Cannon<br>Thunderbolt<br>Tri Attack<br>Metal Sound |
| Steelix | steel/ground | 38 | Flash Cannon<br>Ice Fang<br>Earthquake<br>Sandstorm |
| Bastiodon | steel/rock | 41 | Metal Burst<br>Stone Edge<br>Iron Defense<br>Taunt |

# Strategies against Byron

## The Iron Fortress

### Things to look out for

Steel-types are known for their sky-high Defense and multiple resistances, but they do have clear weaknesses: Fire, Fighting and Ground. Avoid: Flying-, Rock-, and Ice-types, since most of Byron's Pokémon carry Rock- or Steel-type moves that can deal heavy damage back.

### Starter

- **Torterra** - Earthquake is a godsend here. It'll take down Magneton and Steelix with ease. Bastiodon might take a hit or two, but your Ground STAB will break through even that iron wall. Just be careful of Steelix's Ice Fang if it appears—it can hurt!
- **Infernape** - This is your easiest Gym yet. Infernape resists Steel and hits back with powerful Flamethrower or Flare Blitz. Just watch out for Earthquake from Steelix or Bastiodon, as Infernape's defenses are still pretty fragile.
- **Empoleon** - Has the defensive bulk to survive here but lacks direct advantage. Steel vs. Steel is a stalemate, so you'll need coverage moves or backup from teammates. You can still use surf against Steelix and Bastiodon so it shouldn't be too bad.

### Other strategies

- **Rapidash**: Learns Flamethrower or Fire Blast, perfect for melting Steel.
- **Gastrodon**: Great type synergy and access to Earth Power.
- **Machamp**: Dynamic Punch or Cross Chop crushes Bastiodon easily.
- **Golem**: Earthquake and massive Defense make it reliable against Steelix.
- Any pokémon with those typings. Especially special attackers.

Overall Byron ends up being the easiest gym leader in the game. His team has a lot of common weaknesses and it doesn't help that all starters can sweep his team. But if you are struggling, try raising your starters level.

### After the battle

Congratulations once again later. You gained your sixth badge, the Mine Badge! You also received TM91 Flash Cannon – A powerful Steel-type special move. Great for Lucario or Empoleon. After exiting the gym, Barry tells you to come to the Canalave Library. Maybe something important is going on.

# Chapter 7 - More Galactic Trouble

## Lore and Legends

After defeating Byron, Barry will drag you to the Canalave Library, where you meet up with Professor Rowan and Dawn/Lucas. Professor Rowan explains the myth of the Lake Trio (Uxie, Mesprit, Azelf), legendary Pokémon tied to human spirit, knowledge, and willpower. He sends each of you to one of the three lakes. Your job is to go to Lake Valor. Just as this sinks in — BOOM! An explosion shakes Sinnoh. News spreads that Lake Valor has been bombed by Team Galactic. It's up to you to investigate.

### Lake Valor

Fly south to Valor Lakefront (near Route 213/Pastoria) and enter the newly opened crater. Team Galactic has drained the entire lake, leaving Magikarp flopping helplessly. Here you wil battle against some Team Galactic grunts as you make your way to the cave in the middle of the used-to-be-lake.

### Commander saturn

In the middle cave you will fight against Galactic Commader Saturn. He has a very similar team to the other Commanders but with his own ace, **Toxicroak**. He also has a Golbat and a Bronzor. One of the main reasons why the other two Commanders were so difficult is because they used pokémon that were already evolved at such a low level and also because at that point in the game, you don't really have coverage moves to hit them super-effectivley as easily as you can now. And where am I going with this? You probably have at least one psychic, ground or flying type move that you can use to easily take care of his Toxicroak. You team should be around level 40 where all of your pokémon are reaching full evolution stages except for some late bloomers.
After defeating him, you find out that Team Galactic has already captured Azelf. Their plan worked, but you did slow them down. Now it's time to go to lake Verity and see if Professor Rowan and Dawn/Lucas are okay.

# Lake Verity and Mt. Coronet

Saving the day! ...For now

The fastest way to get to Lake Verity is by flying all the way back to Twinleaf Town where your journey began. From here go to route 201 and immediately head West
Lake Verity has several Team Galactic Grunts (Lv.33–35), running the usual Stunky, Croagunk, Golbat, and Glameow. They're easy pickings, but wear them down quickly to reach the commander.

### Commander Mars Rematch

After the grunts, you'll fight Commander Mars again — the same one from Valley Windworks, but much stronger now. Her team consists of Golbat, Bronzor and Purugly. But the Purugly isn't as threatening anymore because you have come a long way since the last battle. Your starter should able handle it now whether it's because of Infernape's fighting moves or Empoleon's resistance to normal moves.

### After the battle

Another Galactic Commander down! Unfortunately, they managed to capture Mesprit as well before fleeing. Rowan thanks you, but the situation is grim:
• Azelf has been taken from Lake Valor.
• Mesprit has been taken from Lake Verity.
• Barry is at Lake Acuity — and in serious trouble against Jupiter. You must go help him.

### Towards Lake Acuity

Lake Aquity is located in the far north section of Sinnoh - conveniently where your next gym battle will also be. The trip there will be long but also rewarding with lots of new pokémon to catch and trainers to battle. To get there, first head to Eterna City and go East to Mt. Coronet. You will need strength to access the new area where we will be going. There aren't any new Pokemon on land but there is one very elusive pokémon lurking in the waters.

### The incredibly rare Feebas

Feebas is one of the hardest pokémon to find. Out of the hundreds of water tiles in this cave only 6 of them can have Feebas and this changes every day! There is no way to know which tile has Feebas so if you really want to catch it, the best way to do so, is to fish with any rod one time on each tile. Work your way up by going row-by-row to not lose track of which tiles you have tried.

# Route 216

## Through the Blizzard

Bundle up, Trainer! It's time to tackle one of Sinnoh's harshest environments — Route 216, the first leg of your journey through the region's snowy north. This route marks a major turning point in your adventure, taking you from the autumn woods of Route 211 into a frozen mountain pass filled with icy winds, heavy snow, and powerful Ice-type Pokémon. Route 216 connects Celestic Town and Snowpoint City, though you'll only be able to reach the latter after clearing this and the next route.

### Trainers to Battle

You'll face a mix of Hikers, Skiers, and Ace Trainers here. They tend to use Ice-types or Fighting-types, so adjust your team accordingly. Halfway through the route, you'll come across a cozy cabin — a godsend in this frozen landscape. Inside, a friendly hiker lets you rest and fully heal your team for free. This spot is ideal for recovering between battles without having to backtrack all the way south.

| Route 216 (Night) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Sneasel** | ice/dark | 33-35 | 35% |
| **Snover** | ice/grass | 32-35 | 30% |
| Zubat | flying/poison | 32 | 10% |
| Meditite | fighting/psychic | 33 | 10% |
| **Snorunt** | ice | 33 | 10% |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 35 | 5% |

# Route 217 & Acuity Lakefront

## Through the Blizzard

Route 217, where visibility is low, the snow is knee-deep, and every step feels like trudging through a blizzard. This isn't just another route; it's a survival challenge. The cold slows your movement to a crawl, trainers are tougher than ever, and it's easy to get lost in the whiteout conditions. But brave through it, and you'll find some of the most valuable items and Pokémon in the region. **Tip**: Keep your Dowsing Machine active. Visibility is terrible, and many items are completely hidden under the snow.

### The Lost Hiker and HM08 Rock Climb

Partway through the blizzard, you'll stumble upon a small cabin with a hiker inside. He's lost his HM08 Rock Climb, which you can find just outside in the snowdrifts behind his house. When you return it, he'll thank you and let you keep the HM for yourself. You'll need it soon — Rock Climb allows you to scale rough, rocky walls and reach hidden locations.

### Acuity Lakefront: The Edge of the Blizzard

After surviving the punishing snowstorms of Route 217, you'll finally arrive at the Acuity Lakefront — the gateway to Lake Acuity, one of Sinnoh's three sacred lakes. This snowy expanse sits nestled between the mountains and the icy waters, and it's a brief but important stop before you can enter Snowpoint City just to the north. At this stage of the story, you can't access the lake itself yet — In order to get in, you have to use Rock Climb, which you can't do until receiving the next badge.

| Route 217 & Acuity Lakefront (Night) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Swinub** | ice/ground | 32-34 | 35% |
| Snover | ice/grass | 32-35 | 30% |
| Snorunt | ice | 33 | 20% |
| Sneasel | ice/dark | 33-35 | 15% |

# Snowpoint City

## The Frozen Frontier

Welcome to Snowpoint City, the northernmost settlement in all of Sinnoh! After battling through the harsh blizzards of Routes 216 and 217, you've finally arrived at this isolated, snow-blanketed city where ice crunches underfoot and snowflakes dance endlessly in the air. This is a quiet, almost mystical place — home to hardy Trainers, an ancient temple, and one of the most formidable Gym Leaders you'll face: Candice, the master of Ice-types. ut before you challenge the Gym, there's plenty to see and do around town.

### Places to visit

**Trade House** - Located just east of the Pokémon Center, this cozy log cabin is home to a friendly NPC offering a trade deal: Your Medicham → Their Haunter (nicknamed "Gaspar")
At first glance, this seems like a fantastic opportunity — Haunter evolves into Gengar when traded, right? Not so fast! This mischievous Haunter is holding an Everstone, preventing it from evolving. It's a little in-joke from the developers, but it still helps fill out your Pokédex entry if you haven't caught a Haunter already.
**The Snowpoint Temple** (Currently Inaccessible) - At the northern edge of the city stands the Snowpoint Temple, a massive, ancient structure guarded by a woman who won't let you inside — yet.
She'll only allow entry after you've become the Champion and fulfilled certain conditions related to a legendary Pokémon. Inside lies a very special Pokémon connected to Sinnoh's ancient past... but that's for much later.
**The Gym** - The iconic Snowpoint Gym sits in the center of town, surrounded by thick snowdrifts. Its leader, Candice, specializes in Ice-type Pokémon — and she's not to be underestimated. Her Gym puzzle is one of the trickiest in the game, involving sliding across icy floors and smashing snowballs in the right order to reach her platform.
We'll go over the full layout and battle strategy in the next chapter!

# Snowpoint City Gym

## The Ice Queen's Domain

This is the seventh Gym in your journey, and by now your Pokémon should be sitting comfortably around Lv. 40–45. Get ready — the battles ahead may look chill, but they can turn icy in an instant. At first glance, the Snowpoint Gym looks like a massive skating rink filled with Trainers and giant snowballs blocking your path. Your goal? Reach Candice at the top by smashing every snowball in your way. It will take some time to break them all but just keep sliding from different directions until every one of them ihas been broken. Along the way you will battle against trainers with powerful Ice type pokémon. Use fire, steel and fighting types against them!

| Gym Leader Candice's team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Sneasel | ice/dark | 40 | Slash<br>Aerial Ace<br>Faint Attack<br>Ice Shard |
| Piloswine | ice/ground | 40 | Avalanche<br>Stone Edge<br>Earthquake<br>Hail |
| Abomasnow | ice/grass | 42 | Avalanche<br>Wood Hammer<br>Water Pulse<br>Focus Blast |
| Froslass | ice/ghost | 44 | Blizzard<br>Double Team<br>Shadow Ball<br>Psychic |

# Strategies against Candice

## The Diamond Dust Girl

### Starter

- **Torterra**: This is the toughest matchup. Torterra is 4× weak to Ice and should avoid battle entirely. If you want to contribute, Rock-type coverage can chip Sneasel or Froslass, but it's very risky. Bring partners like Rapidash, or Machamp to carry the fight.
- **Infernape**: The star of this Gym. Fire moves incinerate Snover, Abomasnow, and Froslass. Close Combat wipes Sneasel and Medicham. With its speed, Infernape can solo the Gym if leveled enough.
- **Empoleon**: Solid option, since Steeland water resist Ice. Can crush Sneasel and Froslass with Flash Cannon, and Blizzard does less damage thanks to high Sp. Def. Watch out for Piloswine's Earthquake!

### Other strategies

- Fire types: Rapidash, Magmortar, Flareon, Houndoom can all do tons of damage.
- Fighting types: Machamp,  Medicham, Gallade,  Lucario and others are also powerful. Just remember that fighting moves don't work against Froslass.
- Steel types: Magnezone, Steelix Lucario,  and others do super-effective damage, Watch out for Piloswine, though!
- Rock types: Rock types that are not also dround types can be good here too. That includes pokémon such as Rampardos and Probopass.

Empoleon and Infernape should have a good time here but Torterra can struggle. Depending on your starter choice, this gym can either be easy of very difficult.

### After the battle

Candice congratulates you warmly (pun intended) and encourages you to chase your own path to greatness. She gives you the Icicle Badge, allowing you to use Rock Climb outside of battle as well as TM72 Avalanche – A strong Ice-type attack that doubles in power if your Pokémon is hit first. She also hints that the nearby Lake Acuity has been seeing "strange visitors" — and if you've been following the story, you can probably guess who that means.

It's time to head out of Snowpoint City and make for Lake Acuity to see what Team Galactic has been up to. The stakes are higher than ever, and the snow won't be the only thing giving you chills...

# Chapter 8 - Cracking the Heart of Team Galactic

## The Frozen Standoff

### Lake Acuity

With the Icicle Badge in hand, we can now use Rock Climb to get to Lake Acuity nestled deep in the blizzards of northern Sinnoh. This isn't just another scenic stop — this is where one of the game's most emotional and dramatic moments takes place.
As you enter the frozen lakefront, you'll see Barry (your rival) standing there — but something's not right. He's downcast, fists clenched, and his usual energy replaced with frustration.
He's just fought Jupiter, one of Team Galactic's Commanders — and lost.
When you talk to him, he admits defeat and laments how he couldn't protect the lake's Legendary Pokémon, Uxie. Jupiter taunts him before leaving, smug and victorious, claiming that Galactic has now captured all three lake guardians.
This moment is important — it marks a turning point for your rival. For the first time, he realizes how serious Team Galactic's plans are and how much stronger he needs to become.
Our next destination will be the most dangerous so far: Team Galactic Headquarters in Veilstone City. But before that it would be a good idea to do some preparations and use our new HM Rock Climb and While we are at the lake, you can surf to the other side to find TM 14 Blizzard.

### Rock climb Backtracking

**Route 216**
• Rare Candy: Always useful for saving grinding time.
• TM13 Ice Beam: One of the best Ice-type moves in the game, accurate and powerful.
**Route 217**
• Reaper Cloth: Hidden on a cliff — evolves Dusclops into Dusknoir.
• PP Up: Great for boosting the usage of rare moves.
**Route 211 East** (Celestic Town side)
• TM29 Psychic: A must-have for almost any Special Attacker.
**Route 208** (near Hearthome)
• TM41 Torment: Not the strongest move for battles, but important for completion.
• Berry Patches: Access extra planting spots if you're growing berries.
**Route 210** (northern foggy section)
• Shiny stone in the Northeastern section of the area.

# Team Galactic Headquarters

Cracking the heart of Team Galactic

Your mission starts in Veilstone City. After defeating a grunt near the HQ, you'll receive the Galactic Key. This opens the warehouse door in the northwest corner of town, letting you sneak inside. From here, the base connects into the main HQ building

## Navigation and order

**1. Warehouse Entry**

- The opening section leads you through storage rooms.
- Pick up TM36 Sludge Bomb here — one of the best Poison-type TMs in Sinnoh.
- Keep exploring until you find the warp panels leading into the HQ proper.

**2. Warp Panel Maze**

- The HQ is loaded with warp pads that loop between side rooms and main halls.
- Many optional paths contain great loot like Max Revive, Full Restore, and Max Elixir.
- In one of these rooms, you'll find the Dubious Disc — completionist gold! This is required to evolve Porygon2 into Porygon-Z, a powerful Special Attacker. Don't miss it!

**3. Rest Area**

- Eventually you'll find a quiet room with beds where you can rest. This is your free healing spot — very useful, since the HQ is long.

**4. Cyrus's Office**

- At the end of the warp panel chain, you'll face Cyrus himself. Stock up and save before heading in.

**5. Saturn's Lab**

- After Cyrus, you'll have to battle Commander Saturn to rescue the remaining Lake Guardian
- After this the Gurdians are freed, but Team Galactic already got all the use out of them they needed

On the next page we will go through battle strategies for the two bosses.

# Cyrus & Saturn

## Cracking the heart of Team Galactic

| Cyrus - Second battle | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Sneasel | ice/dark | 44 | Slash<br>Ice Punch<br>Quick Attack<br>Screech |
| Crobat | flying/poison | 44 | Poison Fang<br>Air Cutter<br>Bite<br>Supersonic |
| Honchkrow | flying/dark | 46 | Drill Peck<br>Night Shade<br>Astonish<br>Faint Attack |

### Strategy

Start with something that can outspeed or tank Sneasel's Ice Punch (your starter should handle it easily except for Torterra). Crobat can be annoying with its high Speed, so a Rock- or Electric-type works wonders. Honchkrow's high Attack means you'll want something bulky to absorb hits, like Luxray or Golem.

After the battle, Cyrus coolly admits that he sees emotion as weakness — but he leaves you alive, claiming you'll soon witness his "perfect world."

### Saturn Rematch

Compared to Cyrus, Saturn is significantly easier to defeat. His team is the same as before, Golbat (level 42), Brozor (level 42) and Toxicroak (level 44).

Once you defeat him, Saturn grudgingly admits defeat but warns you that you're too late — Cyrus has already headed to Mt. Coronet, where he plans to enact his ultimate plan.He releases the lake trio, who flee to parts unknown — but their role in the story isn't over yet.

With Galactic HQ cleared, the next phase of the adventure begins. Cyrus's words echo ominously — he's headed to Mt. Coronet to fulfill his dream of creating a new universe.

This is where the story reaches its climax. It's time to face the end of the world — and stop it.

# Mt. Coronet Revisit

## The Summit of Destiny

This is it — the moment everything has been building toward. Team Galactic has made their final move, and Cyrus is about to reshape the world itself.

Your mission: Climb Mt. Coronet, stop Cyrus, and restore balance before it's too late.

This chapter will guide you through every step of the climb, the key items and Pokémon you can find, and the intense battles waiting at the top — including the double battle against Mars and Jupiter at Spear Pillar.

### Preparing for the climb

Before you head in, make sure you're well-equipped:

**HMs Required:** Rock Climb, Strength, Rock Smash, Surf

You'll need all four to reach the summit. If you don't already have an HM user that can cover these, Bibarel is the perfect choice — it can learn all of these.

Recommended Team Level: Around 45

You'll be facing multiple Galactic Commanders and a long climb with limited healing opportunities.

Make sure you have packed multiple healing items. It is recommended to keep at least 10-20 revives and hyper potions with you.

**Tip**: MooMoo Milks are cheap and heal 100 HP. You can buy these from Route 210 South.

### Route and Entrances

Enter Mt. Coronet from Route 207 (north of Oreburgh City). This is the only entrance that leads to the summit.

You'll pass through a section you've explored before, but this time, you'll be able to use Surf and Rock Climb to reach new areas.

Along the way you will be going through different parts of the mountain. Most of the areas are caves which have very similar encounters but there is one special area with diffrent wild pokémon. We will be going through that on the next page.

# More Mt. Coronet

## The Summit of Destiny

| Mt. Coronet - Snow Area | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Abomasnow** | grass/ice | 38-39 | 30% |
| **Medicham** | fighting/psychic | 38-40 | 20% |
| Snover | grass/ice | 36 | 20% |
| Machoke | fighting | 40 | 10% |
| Chingling | psychic | 37-39 | 10% |
| Nosepass | rock | 38 | 5% |
| **Absol** | dark | 38-40 | 5% |

### Climbing Toward Destiny

As you make your way upward, you'll start encountering more Galactic Grunts. The music changes, tension builds, and the cave's interior becomes more mystical — glowing crystals line the walls, and snow drifts fall from cracks above.

These grunts will use Pokémon you've fought before: Golbat, Croagunk, Stunky, Bronzor, and the like. You'll also occasionally face Team Galactic Commanders, but the real showdown comes at the very top. You'll see Looker one last time on your way up — he warns you that Cyrus has gone too far, and the distortion of space and time is beginning.

### Items to find

Mt. Coronet is packed with valuable treasures hidden behind Strength boulders and Rock Climb slopes. Keep your Dowsing Machine active — there are plenty of hidden items. Key Items and TMs:

TM80 Rock Slide – Near the summit, past a Strength puzzle.

Dawn Stone – For evolving certain Pokémon like Kirlia (into Gallade) and Snorunt (into Froslass).

Max Revive – Found near the snowy cliffs.

# Spear Pillar

## The Summit of Destiny

As you reach the peak, a cutscene begins.

Cyrus is standing before a massive energy field — created by the combined powers of Dialga and Palkia, summoned from their respective dimensions.

Beside him are Mars and Jupiter, who quickly move to block your path.

Before you can reach Cyrus, Barry (your rival) shows up — determined to help you one last time. You'll team up with him for a double battle against both Galactic Commanders.

### Commander battle

Both commaders are using Golbat and Bronzor. On top of that Mars has her signature Purugly and Jupiter has Skuntank. Barry will be helping you in this battle. He leads with Munchlax and will also use Staraptor, Rapidash, Floatzel, and Heracross depending on your starter.

This is a tough battle with lots of status moves, Toxic, and confusion spam.

Try to take out the Bronzors first — they use Reflect and Light Screen, which will make the fight drag on forever if left alone but together you should be able to beat these two.

### The Distortion

Cyrus, now consumed by his obsession, commands Dialga and Palkia to reshape the universe.

The sky cracks open, time and space distort, and a massive shadow appears — Giratina has emerged to stop him.

Cyrus disappears into the portal that opens above Spear Pillar, and the distortion consumes you as well.

You're pulled into another realm entirely… a world unlike anything you've ever seen.

It's time to step into the unknown and stop Cyrus once and for all.

# Distortion World

## The Broken Reality

Welcome to the Distortion World, an eerie, otherworldly realm that defies all logic.

Gravity twists, the sky is a swirling abyss, and reflections ripple beneath your feet like water.

This is Giratina's domain — a place that exists between dimensions — and it's your final challenge against Team Galactic's leader, Cyrus.

This chapter will guide you through navigating the Distortion World's strange layout, solving its gravity-bending puzzles, and ultimately confronting both Cyrus and Giratina at the end.

### Stepping Into the Void

You'll arrive here after the chaos at Spear Pillar, where Giratina dragged both you and Cyrus into this distorted dimension.

Cynthia soon appears as well, determined to help you restore balance to Sinnoh.

The area is unlike anything you've seen — floating platforms hover in midair, and paths flip vertically and upside-down as you walk. You'll need to pay attention to your surroundings; sometimes "up" and "down" aren't what they seem.

### Navigating the Distortion World

Movement here is three-dimensional in a way no other Pokémon area is.

Here are a few tips to keep yourself oriented:

- Watch for ledges that shimmer — stepping on them often shifts the gravity and moves you to another part of the map.
- Boulders play a key role — you'll see three of them scattered through the world, and you'll need to push each one into a pit that matches the lake trio (Uxie, Mesprit, and Azelf).

After You have pushed the boulders, a new path appears, taking you straight to Cyrus

# Cyrus - Final Battle

The world's future is in your hands!

| Cyrus - Final Battle | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Houndoom | dark/fire | 45 | Flamethrower<br>Dark Pulse<br>Will-o-wisp<br>Thunder Fang |
| Honchkrow | dark/flying | 47 | Drill Peck<br>Night Slash<br>Heat Wave<br>Psychic |
| Crobat | poison/flying | 46 | Cross Poison<br>Air Slash<br>Toxic<br>Confuse Ray |
| Gyarados | water/flying | 46 | Giga Impact<br>Waterfall<br>Ice Fang<br>Earthquake |
| Weavile | dark/ice | 48 | Night Slash<br>Ice Punch<br>Fake Out<br>X-scissor |

### Strategy

Cyrus couldn't finish his grand plans. He’s frustrated, defiant, and completely lost in his ambition. He will be going all out against you and this is the toughest battle so far.

- Electric- and Rock-type moves tear through Gyarados and Honchkrow.
- Fighting- or Fire-type moves handle Weavile easily.
- Ground-type moves crush Houndoom.
- Torterra: Excellent here. Earthquake and Rock Slide cover most of Cyrus’s team. Just beware of Ice Fang from Gyarados and Weavile’s Ice Punch.
- Infernape: The easiest time overall. Fire and Fighting moves hit nearly everything hard.
- Empoleon: Can safely handle Weavile and Crobat, but watch out for Houndoom's Thunder Fang and Gyarados’s Earthquake.

# Giratina: The Shadow of the World

The world's future is in your hands!

After the battle against Cyrus, he refuses to accept defeat and vows to remain in this distorted world forever, far away from the reality we live in.

At the very end of the Distortion World, you'll find Giratina, watching you silently from a floating platform.Cynthia joins you and urges you to confront it — this is the source of the disturbance between the worlds.

You'll approach Giratina, triggering a cinematic scene where it swoops down, ready for battle.

## Battle Against Giratina

Giratina is a Ghost and Dragon type Legendary pokémon wiith Massive stats - meaning that it is very strong. Currently it is in it's origin forme but it also has another forme - The Altered Forme. It is level 47 and the recommended course of action is to catch it. The simplest way to do this is to use the Master ball tat Cyrus gave you, but if you want to save it for later (which is recommended) try to catch it with something like an Ultra Ball or a Dusk Ball.

## Tips for catching Giratina

- Save your game before the battle!
- Paralyze or put it to sleep early.
- Avoid using Dragon-type moves — they risk knocking it out.
- If you accidentally knock it out, don't panic — after defeating the Elite Four, Giratina reappears in Turnback Cave at Lv. 70 in its Altered Forme.

## After the battle

Once Giratina is either captured or driven off, a brilliant light floods the world. You, Cynthia, and the legendary Pokémon return to reality — to the Spring Path which was previously blocked off.

# Aftermath

## The World Restored

Cynthia thanks you for everything and remarks that balance has been restored.

The portal to the Distortion World disappears forever, leaving only calm skies above Mt. Coronet.

As you exit the cave, you find yourself on Spring Path, a mysterious new route that didn't exist before — the gateway to Turnback Cave, Giratina's resting place.

### Sendoff Spring

Now that you've defeated Cyrus and restored balance to Sinnoh, a strange new path has appeared south of Veilstone City, leading to a mysterious cave that whispers your name in the wind. Welcome to Spring Path, the entrance to Turnback Cave, where Giratina's power lingers even after the Distortion World has faded.

On Route 214, South of Veilstone City, there is a new opening which leads to Sendoff Spring and Spring Path. This is where you are now. The path itself is quiet and shrouded in mist — an unsettling calm after all the chaos.

At the end of this short stretch of land lies a small pond, and beyond it, the entrance to Turnback Cave, hidden deep within the trees. However,  This is unaccessible for now but it is important to keep in mind if you didn't catch Giratina yet.

| Sendoff Spring | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 37-39 | 35% |
| Bibarel | water/normal | 37-38 | 30% |
| Staravia | normal/flying | 38-40 | 20% |
| Chingling | psychic | 37-39 | 10% |
| **Dusclops** | ghost | 40 | 5% |

# The Lake Trio

## Moving on to the next gym

### Visiting Professor Rowan in Sandgem Town

Once you've wrapped up the Distortion World and emerged back into Sinnoh, your next stop is Sandgem Town. Head into Rowan's lab to catch him up on the cataclysm you just helped prevent. Here you'll find Rowan, Dawn/Lucas, and Cynthia discussing Giratina's role in restoring balance to the world.

This visit is short and story-driven, but it officially clears the way for you to move toward the final gym in Sunyshore City. Before we do that, though, this is the perfect time for a legendary catching detour.

### The lake trio

The three Lake Guardians — Uxie, Mesprit, and Azelf — have returned to their respective lakes after being freed. All three must be recorded in your Pokédex for completion, and catching them adds powerful Psychic-types to your team.

### Preparations

Catching legendaries requires patience and the right tools:

- Dusk Balls work best since caves and night-time battles count as dark conditions. Stock 30–50 to be safe.
- Sleep (Hypnosis, Sleep Powder) and Paralysis (Thunder Wave) make the catch much easier
- False Swipe is the MVP, leaving the target at 1 HP without knocking it out.Alternatively, Super Fang (cuts HP by half) is amazing for bulky legendaries.

### Location

- **Uxie** – Knowledge Pokémon - Location: Acuity Cavern (Lake Acuity).
- **Mesprit** – Emotion Pokémon - Location: Verity Cavern (Lake Verity).
- **Azelf** – Willpower Pokémon - Location: Valor Cavern (Lake Valor).

All of them are psychic types and level 50. Mesprit is special because instead of being able to catch it straight away, it starts roaming around the region which means that it can be found in any area but it is rare. For now it's a good idea to keep moving on your adventure and catch it if you happen to find it. There is a good change it will flee, though, so catching it is difficult.

# Route 222

## Glittering Coastline

Route 222 runs along the coast east of Valor Lakefront and is the final “long trainer gauntlet” before the last gym. There are plenty of tough battles here — expect level 40+ teams from Ace Trainers, Fishermen, and Rich Boys.

There are a few houses along the beach with interesting things to do so make sure to check them out.

**Tip**: One of the three fishermen on the beach who has two Gyarados is a great way to farm experience. By cycling down the beach you can battle him over and over with the versus seeker. Gyarados is a strong pokémon which is why it gives a lot of experience

| Route 222 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Electabuzz** | electric | 39-41 | 30% |
| Floatzel | water | 40 | 20% |
| Magnemite | electric/steel | 39 | 10% |
| Wingull | water/flying | 38 | 10% |
| Luxio | electric | 38-40 | 10% |
| Chatot | normal/flying | 38 | 10% |
| **Magneton** | steel/electric | 41 | 5% |
| Pelipper | water/flying | 40 | 5% |

# Sunyshore City

## The Shining Port

Welcome to Sunyshore City! This is your final stop before the Pokémon League, and it feels different from every other city: solar panels, elevated glass walkways, and a beachfront vibe. Sunyshore City is located on the northeastern coast of Sinnoh, giving it that breezy seaside vibe. This sparkling gem of the Sinnoh region is basically the "shiny beach town" of your Pokémon adventure, and it's not just for looks—it has plenty to do if you're aiming for completionist glory. Let's dive in!

### Things to do

- Poké Mart & Poké Center – Restock before the big fight.
- Vista Lighthouse – Offers a great view of the city and Victory Road.
- Seal Shop (Market Stalls) – You can buy seals to decorate Poké Balls, if you're going for flair.
- Jasmine, the Johto Gym Leader – The visiting gym leader will give you HM 08 Waterfall on the Northern beach.

### Where's the Gym Leader?

When you first arrive, you'll discover that Volkner, the Electric-type Gym Leader, has lost his spark (pun fully intended). The Gym is locked. To get him back:

1. Go to the Vista Lighthouse on the northeast end of the city.
2. Ride the elevator to the top, where Volkner is staring dramatically out to sea.
3. After a short dialogue with him, he'll agree to battle you and return to the Gym.

Only then will the Gym be open for challengers.

# Sunyshore City Gym

## Volkner's Electric Challenge

The Sunyshore Gym is a three-room gear/rotating-platform puzzle. You press switches to rotate giant gears and create a path across suspended platforms; in each room you must flip the right sequence of switches, then follow the moving platforms to the next area. It's one of the more mechanical/logic-y gym puzzles in Sinnoh — you'll spend more time walking platforms and lining up paths than grinding battles. Don't rush: rotate a platform, look where it puts you, then plan the next switch so you don't slide off into a trainer or dead end

| Gym Leader Volkner's Team | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Jolteon | Electric | 46 | Thunder Wave<br>Charge Beam<br>Iron Tail<br>Quick Attack |
| Raichu | Electric | 46 | Charge Beam<br>Focus Blast<br>Signal Beam<br>Quick Attack |
| Luxray | Electric | 48 | Ice Fang<br>Thunder Fang<br>Crunch<br>Fire Fang |
| Electivire | Electric | 50 | Thunderpunch<br>Fire Punch<br>Quick Attack<br>Giga Impact |

# Strategies against Volkner

## Volkner's Electric Challenge

### Starter

- **Torterra**: Best matchup! Torterra's Earthquake hits everything super-effectively. Watch out for Luxray's Ice Fang and Electivire's Fire Punch
- **Infernape**: Even Matchup. Close Combat and Flare Blitz can do serious damage to all of Volkner's pokémon, but they can do the same to you. Infernape is fast which should allow you to have the edge against most of them as you are moving first.
- **Empoleon**: Poor matchup. Water is weak to electric and all of Volkner's pokémon naturally have storng electric moves. Only use it if you absolutely have to. Otherwise, leave this battle for the rest of your team.

### Other strategies

- Ground types - This is an absolute must! Ground types don't take damage from electric moves. You just have to watch out for Luxray's Ice Fangs.
- Earthquake in general - Even if you don't have a ground type, you probably have the Earthquake TM that was found in Wayward Cave. This can be taught to a wide variety of pokémon including those that are not ground types. This is a super powerful move!
- Grass and Dragon types - Both of these types resist electric so they might have a good time here. Once again, watch out for Fire and Ice coverage moves.

If your pokémon are at a lower level than his and you can't seem to win, Go train against the fisherman trainer on Route 222 (check page 80 for more details).

### After the battle

Congratulations, trainer! You have done an incredible feat! Not only did you save the world from Team Galactic but you also obtained the very last badge in Sinnoh - The Beacon Badge. With this, you are officially qualified to challenge the Pokémon League. You also received TM57 Charge Beam. An electric type move that has a change of increasing the user's special attack, letting it steamroll matches.

You can already see the Pokémon League in the horizon. It is only a short trip away from Sunyshore City. There awaits your finalchallenge. Do you have what it takes to become the Pokémon League Champion?

# Chapter 9 - Route 223

## The Surf to Victory

At last, the time has come! Eight Gym Badges glitter proudly in your case, and the Pokémon League awaits. But before you can face the Elite Four and the Champion, you'll need to navigate the vast waters of Route 223, the ocean route that connects Sunyshore City to Victory Road. Grab your Surf Pokémon, make sure you've earned HM07 Waterfall, and get ready for one of the most scenic—and challenging—routes in all of Sinnoh.

### Preparing for the journey

Before you set sail, make sure you've done the following:

- Have the Beacon Badge from Sunyshore City, which allows you to use Waterfall outside of battle.
- Bring Pokémon with Surf and Waterfall. You'll need both to reach the Pokémon League.
- Stock up on Repels and Full Restores—the trip is long and filled with trainers.
- Keep a strong Electric- or Grass-type Pokémon on hand. This route is almost entirely Water-type territory, and those types will tear through it.

| Route 223 - Surf | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Tentacruel | water/poison | 30-50 | 60% |
| Pelipper | water/flying | 30-50 | 30% |
| **Mantyke** | water/flying | 30-40 | 10% |

# Victory Road

## The Final Ascent

This is it—the last obstacle between you and the Pokémon League! Victory Road in Pokémon Platinum isn't just a cave; it's a trial. It's where every trainer's skill, patience, and preparation are put to the ultimate test.

You'll need all your strength, all your HMs, and a well-balanced team to conquer it. Let's make sure you're fully ready for the climb.

### Preparations

Victory Road is long, complex, and filled with powerful trainers and wild Pokémon. Before you step inside, make sure you have all these HMs: Surf, Waterfall, Strength, Rock Smash and Rock Climb. That's five HMs total! If your main team can't handle them all, Bibarel is your best friend—it can learn Surf, Waterfall, Rock Smash, and Strength all at once.

Also bring plenty of Max Revives and full Restores as well as repels.

Victory Road in Platinum is packed with veteran-level Trainers, including Ace Trainers, Black Belts, and Psychics.

Most of their Pokémon hover around Lv. 45–50, so don't get cocky—these battles can rival some Gym Leaders.

| Victory Road | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 40-42 | 30% |
| Onix | rock/ground | 40-41 | 20% |
| Rhyhorn | rock/ground | 41 | 20% |
| **Rhydon** | rock/ground | 41-43 | 15% |
| Golbat | flying/poison | 43 | 5% |
| Steelix | steel/ground | 42 | 5% |
| **Gabite** | dragon/ground | 41 | 5% |

# Pokémon League Entrance

## Your Final Steps

Once you've reached the exit of Victory Road, you'll emerge onto a beautiful cliffside plateau. The music swells, the sea stretches endlessly below—and ahead lies the grand entrance to the Pokémon League. Take a deep breath. You've earned this moment.

Go inside the Building and heal up your pokémon. As you approach the entrance to the deeper layers of the league Barry barges in and challenges you to a battle. This battle will determine which one of you is ready to challenge the league!

### Barry battle

Barry's team is high-40s to low-50s and fully evolved. Exact composition depends on which starter you chose — his starter will always be the one strong against yours.

He will start with Staraptor once again and he will also have Heracross and Snorlax - two very powerful pokémon! then depending on his starter he will have two of Floatzel, Rapidash and Roserade. Just like in the past, he chooses two of these pokémon based on what his starter is - he will not choose the same type as his starter. As his last pokémon he has a starter that is strong against yours

### Strategy

- His Staraptor always leads. It's fast and hits like a truck. Open with something that resists Flying or can take a Close Combat.
- Don't underestimate Snorlax: Bring Fighting coverage (Close Combat, Brick Break) or Toxic stall.
- His starter: Build your counter around type advantage:
  - vs Torterra → bring Fire or Ice coverage.
  - vs Infernape → a bulky Water or Flying type does wonders.
  - vs Empoleon → hit hard with Ground or Electric moves.

# Starting The League

## The time has come

After beating Barry, the ultimate test is just beginning. Before stepping further, Make sure you have plenty of healing items and that your team is prepared. The recommended level is at least 55 across the board. Once you think you are ready, you may step in but beware! there is no coming back once you enter. You either come out victorious or defeated.

### General Strategy

You have to battle the Elite Four before you get to challenge the Champion. The Elite Four consists of four of the most skilled type specialists on the region. Kind of like Gym Leaders but even stronger. The types that they have mastered are Bug, Ground, Fire and Psychic in that order. Make sure to always heal your pokémon between the battles. You will have to use your own potions because you don't have access to the Pokémon Center.

First, you will be battling against the Bug Master, Aaron.

| Elite Four Aaron | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Yanmega | bug/flying | 49 | Air Slash<br>Bug Buzz<br>U-turn<br>Double Team |
| Scizor | bug/steel | 49 | Iron Head<br>X-scissor<br>Night Slash<br>Quick Attack |
| Vespiquen | bug/flying | 50 | Attack Order<br>Defend Order<br>Heal Order<br>Power Gem |
| Heracross | bug/fighting | 51 | Megahorn<br>Close Combat<br>Night Slash<br>Stone Edge |
| Drapion | dark/poison | 53 | X-scissor<br>Cross Poison<br>Ice Fang<br>Aerial Ace |

# Elite Four Aaron

## The Bug Master

Aaron may be the Bug-type trainer, but don't underestimate him — his team is built for speed and tricky coverage.

Type Advantage: Bug-types are weak to Fire, Flying, and Rock attacks. Bringing strong Pokémon of these types will make your life much easier.

### Starter

• Torterra: Not great. Yanmega and Heracross threaten it, and Drapion has Ice Fang. Can help vs Drapion if you outspeed and Earthquake, but risky.

• Infernape: Fantastic. Flamethrower/Fire Blast handles Yanmega, Scizor, Heracross, Vespiquen; Close Combat hits Drapion hard. Arguably the easiest sweep.

• Empoleon: Decent. Ice Beam/Surf deal with Yanmega and Heracross. Needs help vs Drapion (watch Earthquake). Neutral vs Vespiquen.

### Other Strategies

• Lead: Yanmega can U-turn out and spam Double Team — counter with a fast Rock or Flying move to KO quickly. Stone Edge/Rock Slide are great here.

• Scizor is extremely weak to Fire — a single Flamethrower or Fire Blast ends it.

• Heracross is scary: Megahorn wrecks Psychic-types, Close Combat punishes Rock/Steel, and Stone Edge hits Flyers. Use a fast special attacker with Fire or Flying coverage.

• Vespiquen can wall if you let it Defend/Heal Order. Hit it hard with Electric or Rock moves before it sets up.

• Drapion is Aaron's ace. It has only one weakness: Ground. Earthquake or Earth Power are your best bet. Beware its coverage fangs — it can surprise Grass-, Ground-, and Flying-types.

# Elite Four Bertha

## Mistress of the Earth

After brushing aside Aaron's bugs, you step into the next chamber of the Sinnoh Pokémon League—a massive stone hall echoing with the rumble of shifting rock and flowing sand. Waiting at the far end is Bertha, the Elite Four's master of Ground-types. She's calm, composed, and deceptively dangerous. Don't be fooled by her grandmotherly demeanor—this woman's team can bury you before you know it.

Make sure your Pokémon aren't weak to Ground themselves—leave Electric-types on the bench for this one. Her levels are between 50 and 55. Rhyperior is her ace and also surprisingly bulky despite all it's weaknesses.

| Elite Four Bertha | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Whiscash | water/ground | 50 | Earth Power<br>Aqua Tail<br>Zen Headbutt<br>Sandstorm |
| Gliscor | ground/flying | 53 | Earthquake<br>Ice Fang<br>Fire Fang<br>Thunder Fang |
| Hippowdon | ground | 52 | Earthquake<br>Stone Edge<br>Crunch<br>Yawn |
| Golem | ground/rock | 52 | Earthquake<br>Fire Punch<br>Thunderpunch<br>Sandstorm |
| Rhyperior | rock/ground | 55 | Earthquake<br>Rock Wrecker<br>Megahorn<br>Avalanche |

# Elite Four Bertha

## Mistress of the Earth

Bertha's approach is simple but effective—she uses bulky, high-defense Pokémon that can take a hit and strike back hard with Earthquake. Most of them set up Sandstorm as well, which chips away at your team every turn unless you're Rock, Ground, or Steel-type.

Bertha loves Ground-types, but don't assume Grass will sweep her — her Pokémon pack coverage specifically for anti-Grass counters.

### Starter

• Torterra: Mixed. Torterra can crush Whiscash and Rhyperior with Grass STAB, but is weak to Gliscor's Ice Fang and Rhyperior's Avalanche. Still valuable if you predict right.

• Infernape: Needs support. Weak to Earthquake spam, but can use Grass Knot against Whiscash and Rhyperior. Not a safe main option here.

• Empoleon: Excellent. Immune to Sandstorm chip (Steel), can Ice Beam Gliscor, Surf sweeps the rest. Must watch for Whiscash's Earth Power and Rhyperior's Earthquake, but overall one of the best picks.

### Other Strategies

• Types to bring: Grass, Water, Ice. Grass is strong but beware coverage like Fire Fang (Gliscor) and Avalanche (Rhyperior).

• Lead: Whiscash is 4× weak to Grass. One Grass Knot or Leaf Storm destroys it.

• Gliscor is fast and dangerous — Ice Beam is the cleanest counter.

• Golem/Rhyperior hit like trucks, but both fold to Grass or Water. Watch for Rock coverage against Flyers and Ice users.

• Hippowdon is bulky and can Yawn stall. Keep an Ice/Grass/Water attacker healthy to break through.

# Elite Four Flint

## The Fire Within

As you step into the next chamber, the temperature rises immediately. The walls glow a deep orange, heat rippling through the air, and the floor itself seems to shimmer like molten metal. Standing at the far end is Flint, the fiery powerhouse of the Sinnoh Elite Four. His wild red hair says it all—this man lives for the burn.

Flint's personality is as hot as his battle style. He's upbeat, passionate, and loves seeing strong Trainers who can stand up to his flames. But don't let his friendly attitude fool you—his team is designed to overwhelm you with speed and hard-hitting attacks.

| Elite Four Flint | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Houndoom | fire/dark | 52 | Flamethrower<br>Sludge Bomb<br>Dark Pulse<br>Sunny Day |
| Flareon | fire | 55 | Overheat<br>Giga Impact<br>Quick Attack<br>Will-o-wisp |
| Rapidash | Fire | 53 | Flare Blitz<br>Solarbeam<br>Bounce<br>Sunny Day |
| Infernape | fire/fighting | 55 | Flare Blitz<br>Thunderpunch<br>Mach Punch<br>Earthquake |
| Magmortar | fire | 57 | Flamethrower<br>Thunderbolt<br>Solarbeam<br>Hyper Beam |

# Elite Four Flint

## The Fire Within

In Diamond & Pearl, Flint was a bit of a pushover. But in Platinum, his team is dangerous: fast sweepers, diverse coverage, and no easy counters.

Flint's team revolves around speed, coverage, and raw firepower. Most of his Pokémon have access to powerful coverage moves like Thunderbolt and SolarBeam, allowing them to counter the usual Fire-type weaknesses. You'll need to plan your switches carefully.

### Starter

• Torterra: Not recommended. All of Flint's team has Fire coverage, and Rapidash/Infernape/Magmortar can one-shot it. Torterra should stay out.

• Infernape: Neutral matchup. Speed tie with his Infernape can get messy. Close Combat is good against Houndoom/Flareon, but risky overall. Needs backup.

• Empoleon: Very good. Resists Fire, can Surf everything. Must be wary of Magmortar's Thunderbolt and SolarBeam. With good prediction, Empoleon can carry this fight.

### Other Strategies

• Types to bring: Water, Ground, Rock. Preferably fast Water-types or bulky Grounds.

• Houndoom: Best handled with Earthquake or Surf.

• Flareon: Overheat hits very hard, but it drops Sp. Atk afterward. Physical tanks like Gyarados can wall it.

• Infernape: Fast and versatile. Mach Punch punishes frail sweepers, ThunderPunch wrecks Gyarados. Outspeed with Alakazam or Crobat, or tank with bulky Waters like Milotic.

• Magmortar: His ace. With Thunderbolt and SolarBeam, it destroys most Water-types if Sunny Day is active. Hit it quickly with Earthquake or strong Rock moves.

• Rapidash: Watch for Bounce paralysis and SolarBeam under sun. Any solid Water or Rock move will drop it.

# Elite Four Lucian

## Master of the Mind

You step into the final chamber of the Sinnoh Elite Four, and instantly, the atmosphere shifts. The air feels calm but heavy—like walking into a library where even your thoughts echo too loudly. At the far end stands Lucian, the most composed member of the Elite Four, reading calmly as though he's been expecting you all along. He closes his book with a soft thud and smiles.

"Well done reaching this far. I hope you've prepared your mind… as well as your Pokémon."

Lucian is the Psychic-type specialist, and unlike Flint's fiery recklessness, he's deliberate and precise. His team is full of clever tactics—status moves, stat boosts, and attacks that prey on your team's weaknesses. If you came this far on brute strength alone, you might find yourself second-guessing every move. He is by far the toughest Elite Four member so get ready for an intense battle.

| Elite Four Lucian | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Mr. Mime | Psychic | 53 | Psychic<br>Thunderbolt<br>Reflect<br>Light Screen |
| Espeon | Psychic | 55 | Psychic<br>Shadow Ball<br>Quick Attack<br>Signal Beam |
| Bronzong | Psychic/Steel | 54 | Psychic<br>Gyro Ball<br>Earthquake<br>Calm Mind |
| Alakazam | Psychic | 56 | Psychic<br>Energy Ball<br>Focus Blast<br>Recover |
| Gallade | Psychic/Fighting | 59 | Drain Punch<br>Psycho Cut<br>Leaf Blade<br>Stone Edge |

# Elite Four Lucian

## Master of the Mind

This is a thinking man's fight. Lucian's Pokémon hit hard but rely heavily on status and setup. Keep items like Full Restores and Full Heals handy. his team has great type synergy and punishes careless switches. Lucian's team is built like a chess match: he sets up defenses, reads your moves, and then goes in for the checkmate. Let's break it down piece by piece.

### Starter

• Torterra: Rough time. Bronzong walls it, Gallade has Drain Punch/Stone Edge, and Alakazam has Energy Ball. Not recommended here.

• Infernape: Excellent. Flamethrower handles Bronzong, U-turn or Shadow Claw punishes Psychic-types, and Flare Blitz hits everything hard. Watch out for Espeon outspeeding.

• Empoleon: Decent. Can tank Psychic hits thanks to Steel typing, but must watch for Focus Blast from Alakazam and Drain Punch from Gallade. Ice Beam or Flash Cannon can help against Espeon/Gallade.

### Other Strategies

• Types to bring: Dark, Ghost, Bug. Bronzong complicates this because it resists Dark/Ghost, so bring Fire or Ground coverage for it.

• Mr. Mime: Sets dual screens. Try to OHKO before it walls the whole team. Physical Dark-types (Weavile) or U-turn can handle it.

• Espeon: Very frail, but fast. Pursuit users or priority moves are great here.

• Bronzong: Bulky with Calm Mind — don't let it set up. Fire Blast, Flamethrower, or Earthquake will deal with it.

• Alakazam: Insanely fast, high Sp. Atk. Fragile, so one physical hit will drop it. Priority (Bullet Punch, Mach Punch) is your best friend here.

• Gallade: His ace. Hits on both sides of the spectrum with Drain Punch and Psycho Cut, and has coverage for Flyers/Waters. Use strong Flying, Ghost, or fast special attackers to take it down.

# Champion Cynthia

## The Summit of Sinnoh

At last… the moment you've been building toward since stepping out of Twinleaf Town. Every trial, every rival battle, every badge—everything has led to this. You've climbed through the hardest Victory Road in Sinnoh, overcome the mighty Elite Four, and now, before you stands the final test: Champion Cynthia.

The grand hall is silent. The marble floor gleams beneath your feet, reflecting the light of your hard-earned badges. Then she steps forward—calm, elegant, and confident. Her golden hair sways slightly, her eyes sharp yet serene. You can feel it instantly—this isn't just another battle. This is the true pinnacle of Pokémon mastery in Sinnoh. Cynthia smiles. "I've been waiting for you. You've earned the right to face me.  But can you match the power of my team?" This isn't just a fight for glory—it's the culmination of your entire journey.

| Champion Cynthia | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Moves |
| Spiritomb | Ghost/Dark | 58 | Dark Pulse<br>Psychic<br>Silver Wind<br>Shadow Ball |
| Roserade | Grass/Poison | 58 | Energy Ball<br>Sludge Bomb<br>Toxic<br>Extrasensory |
| Togekiss | Flying/Normal | 60 | Air Slash<br>Aura Sphere<br>Water Pulse<br>Shock Wave |
| Lucario | Fighting/Steel | 60 | Aura Sphere<br>Extremespeed<br>Shadow Ball<br>Stone Edge |
| Milotic | Water | 58 | Surf<br>Ice Beam<br>Mirror Coat<br>Dragon Pulse |
| Garchomp | Ground/Dragon | 62 | Dragon Rush<br>Earthquake<br>Flamethrower<br>Giga Impact |

# Champion Cynthia

## The Summit of Sinnoh

All her Pokémon are around level 60, well-trained, and built to cover nearly every weakness. She uses balanced tactics, type synergy, and high stats across the board—making her one of the hardest Champions in the entire Pokémon series. Unlike in the Elite Four, you can't exploit a common weakness across the entire team. Her team is too diverse for something simple like that. You will have to earn this victory.

### Battle Strategy

Spiritomb: Spiritomb has no weaknesses in Generation IV—yes, you heard that right. Start with a bulky attacker or status user. Pokémon with strong neutral hits like Staraptor (Brave Bird), Luxray (Crunch), or Infernape (Flare Blitz) can wear it down. Setting up stat boosts here (like Swords Dance or Calm Mind) can help later in the battle.

Roserade: Fast and powerful, but very frail. Any Flying, Fire, or Psychic move will obliterate it. Pokémon like Staraptor, Rapidash, or Alakazam can dispatch it easily. Be careful of Sludge Bomb—it hits Grass types like Torterra hard.

Togekiss: This one's a menace with Air Slash and Serene Grace, which doubles its flinch chance. Counter it with fast Electric or Rock types—Luxray, Magnezone, or Weavile work well. Don't let it start flinching you to death!

Lucario: Lucario is dangerous because of its dual coverage moves. It can take out Fairy, Ice, and Rock counters easily with Earthquake or Dragon Pulse. Counter it with Ground or Fire types like Infernape, Garchomp, or even Gastrodon, which resists most of its moves.

Milotic: Cynthia's Milotic is bulky and can be a wall if you don't have a solid Electric or Grass attacker. Luxray's Thunder Fang, Roserade's Energy Ball, or Electabuzz's Thunderbolt will do wonders here. Beware of Mirror Coat—don't get caught with a reflected special attack!

Garchomp (Her Ace): This is it. Her ultimate weapon. Level 62, fast as lightning, and monstrously strong. It outspeeds most Pokémon and can devastate teams with Earthquake and Dragon Rush.

If you have Ice Beam or Ice Fang, now's the time to use it. Weavile, Mamoswine, or a fast Starmie can take it down, but you'll likely need to survive a hit first. A well-timed Intimidate from Staraptor or Gyarados can make the difference.

# Champion Cynthia

## The Summit of Sinnoh

### Starter Matchup

**Torterra** (Grass/Ground) — risky, situational

• Pros: Earthquake blasts Lucario and Spiritomb neutrally; Grass STAB destroys Whiscash/Roserade if they appear.

• Cons: fragile to Togekiss/Air Slash and especially Garchomp's coverage + Ice Fang. If you run Torterra, keep it as a situational switch-in who doesn't take the lead — use it only when you know an Electric/Ground trade is safe. Often you'll want a different core for the final legs.

**Infernape** (Fire/Fighting) — often the most flexible starter

• Pros: Flamethrower / Close Combat are superb vs Roserade, Spiritomb (neutral but high power), and Lucario (Close Combat). Can sweep through multiple of Cynthia's mons if trained and with good coverage.

• Cons: Fragile to bulky water (Milotic) and to fast priority or Earthquake if prediction is wrong. Still, Infernape is one of the easiest starters to carry the final battle with.

**Empoleon** (Water/Steel) — one of the safest "tank" choices

• Pros: Resists many of Cynthia's special hits (Ice, Psychic) and can wall Spiritomb's special coverage well; Surf/Ice Beam help vs Milotic and Garchomp (Ice Beam helps if Empoleon learns it). Great pivot and bulky special attacker.

• Cons: Vulnerable to Lucario's Focus Blast-like coverage and to Electric STABs (but Cynthia rarely runs raw Thunderbolt on every mon). Empoleon is a top-tier "safe" pick for the Champion fight.

### Extra pro tips (small things that win big)

• Don't let Mirror Coat or Giga Impact go unpaid — keep some Full Restores to heal through chaos.

• Watch for priority moves (ExtremeSpeed / Quick Attack) — keep an HP cushion on your frailer sweepers.

• If you have Gyarados: Dragon Dance + Waterfall + Ice Fang is a widely recommended solo answer; it can set up on Spiritomb and sweep if you time your heals.

• Save at least one Full Restore specifically for the Garchomp turn — if it crits and you survive, a Full Restore can buy you the sweep.

# Hall of Fame

## The Final Blow

Once Garchomp falls, Cynthia smiles—not out of disappointment, but pride. “Just as I expected… you truly are strong.”

The music fades, your Pokémon stand triumphant, and the screen shifts to white.

Professor Rowan arrives to congratulate you, and soon after, you’re led to the Hall of Fame—the chamber where Sinnoh’s greatest trainers are immortalized. Your team is recorded forever, proof of your determination and skill.

You are now the Champion of Sinnoh. Congratulations, Trainer. You’ve done it.

Every time you view your Hall of Fame entry, you’ll be reminded of this adventure — your team, your strategies, and the sheer determination that brought you to victory.

### What's next?

After becoming Champion, you’ll find yourself back home in Twinleaf Town. From here, you can finally start tying up loose ends and exploring all the optional content that makes Platinum such a completionist’s dream. For those of you who are satisfied with the ending, this may be the end of your journey but there is still so much more you can do.

### What's next?

There is still a lot we will be covering.
Some examples include:

- Legendary Hunts
- New Regions & Routes
- Trainer & Facility Challenges such as the Battle Frontier
- Filling the Pokédex
- Special Sidequests

I hope you will stick around because this adenture isn't over yet!

# Chapter 10 - Completionist's dream

## Postgame Galore

### A New Dawn in Sinnoh

When you load back into your save, you'll find yourself standing in your cozy room in Twinleaf Town, right where it all began. But this time, things are different. You're no longer just a hopeful trainer—you're the Champion of Sinnoh, and the entire region has opened up for you.

So what's next? It's time to expand your horizons beyond the Regional Pokédex.

### First Stop: Professor Rowan's Lab

Your first task in the postgame is to pay a visit to Professor Rowan in Sandgem Town. You've come a long way since the day you picked your first Pokémon from his lab, and now he has something very special for you.

When you arrive, you'll find Rowan—and your rival's assistant, Dawn or Lucas—waiting to congratulate you on your victory. After a bit of dialogue, Rowan will check your Pokédex and realize you've seen every Pokémon in the Sinnoh Regional Dex.

If you haven't yet, now's the time to finish that up—remember, you only need to see each Pokémon, not catch them. Every single one is obtainable or viewable in Platinum, so you can always refer to the Pokédex completion list at the end of this guide if you're missing any entries.

Once you've met this requirement, Rowan will contact his old colleague from Kanto, none other than Professor Oak himself! Oak will arrive in the lab, impressed by your achievements, and he'll reward you with the National Pokédex.

### Swarm Encounters

After unlocking the National Dex, Dawn/Lucas's younger sibling in Sandgem Town will tell you each day where a special "swarm" Pokémon has appeared. These are Pokémon that normally aren't in Sinnoh's wild encounters but are needed for the full National Dex. You can check in every day to see if there is anything new to catch.

- Examples include Dunsparce, Beldum, Natu, Skitty, and many more
- If you're hunting for Dex completion, swarms are essential. Some Pokémon can only be caught this way without trading.

# The Battle Zone

## Sinnoh's Tropical Postgame

With the National Dex in hand, the northeastern seas open to you! Congratulations, Champion! You've unlocked Sinnoh's hidden northeast region — an island chain known as the Battle Zone. This is the ultimate postgame playground in Pokémon Platinum, full of rare encounters, challenging trainers, and new facilities to test your skills.

The Battle Zone is split into three main hubs:

Fight Area, Survival Area, and Resort Area

### Sailing to the Fight Area

Head to Snowpoint City's harbor and set sail. You'll dock at the Fight Area, the gateway to the Battle Zone. Right away, you'll run into your rival Barry — but instead of battling him, you'll actually team up. Flint and Volkner, two of Sinnoh's Elite Four and Gym Leaders, block your path and challenge you both to a tag battle.

• Their teams pack serious firepower, with heavy hitters like Rapidash, Flareon, Jolteon, Electivire, and Magmortar.

• Thankfully, Barry covers your back, and together you'll put them in their place. Consider this a warm-up for the stronger trainers ahead — the level curve is rising sharply now.

### What's in the Fight Area?

• Pokémon Center & Mart: Your base camp for the northeast. The Mart stocks high-level supplies like Full Restores and Max Repels, so this is a good place to refresh your bag.

• Battle Frontier Gate: The grand facility looms nearby. Tempting as it is, hold off — we'll cover the Battle Frontier later, in its own section. But if you want to get a head start and check it out, you are welcome to do so.

• Routes Ahead: Beyond the Fight Area stretch Route 225 and other brand-new wild zones filled with rare encounters and tough trainers.

# Route 225

## Sinnoh's Tropical Postgame

Route 225 is the northern path leading from the Fight Area toward the Survival Area. This is your first real taste of the Battle Zone wilderness — rugged terrain, strong trainers, and plenty of wild Pokémon. Many of these pokémon have not been available before and only count towards the National Dex.

### Trainers

The trainers here pack level 45–55 teams, so you'll need to be well-prepared. Expect fully evolved Pokémon and powerful moves — this is no place for under-leveled stragglers. Double Battles and Ace Trainers are especially common, so bring a balanced squad.

### Items

• TM53 Energy Ball (hidden near the northern cliffs)

• Ultra Ball, Max Repel, Nugget

Use your Dowsing Machine liberally — there are several hidden items scattered around the rocky terrain.

| Route 225 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Machoke | Fighting | 48-50 | 25% |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 49 | 20% |
| **Banette** | ghost | 48-50 | 20% |
| **Raticate** | normal | 49-50 | 15% |
| **Fearow** | normal/flying | 48-49 | 10% |
| **Rattata** | normal | 47 | 5% |
| **Spearow** | normal/flying | 47 | 5% |

# The Survival Area

## Sinnoh's Tropical Postgame

The Survival Area lies just beyond Route 225, serving as the second major settlement in the Battle Zone. Unlike the Fight Area, which is all about the Battle Frontier, this town is more about training and preparation for the toughest challenges ahead. It features a move tutor and one of the best places to train in the entire game - The Battleground!

### Move Tutor

One of the Move Tutors lives here. He teaches rare and powerful moves in exchange for Shards you've dug up in the Underground. Examples include Outrage, Heat Wave, and Signal Beam — excellent for optimizing your team for postgame battles. To get to the house you have to go to the next route and use Rock Climb to get up a cliff. Then move towards west and you will find the house.

### Trainer Rematches – The Battleground

The real highlight of the Survival Area is the Battleground (the large house at the north end of town). This facility lets you rematch Gym Leaders and Elite Four members in tougher battles than before.

**How it Works:**

- Each day, four Trainers will be available inside.
- The pool includes all 8 Gym Leaders, Barry, and notable trainers you have met on your journey (such as Cheryl and Riley).
- Their teams are much stronger, with levels ranging from the high 50s into the 60s, and full competitive-style movesets.
- The roster rotates daily, so you'll face a different mix every time you check in.

This is the perfect place to battle high level opponents.

# Route 226

## The Ascent

Route 226 is a tall, mountainous climb connecting the Survival Area to the northern paths of the Battle Zone. It's a mixture of rocky terrain, water crossings, and some great opportunities to train.

### Notable Features

- Trade House (Middle of Route): Inside a house, you'll find a Trainer who wants to trade. In Platinum, this is a trade for a Magikarp in exchange for a Magikarp… but the fun twist is that the Magikarp you receive will come from a different language game if your cartridge supports it. This makes it useful for the Masuda Method when breeding for shinies!
- Tall Cliffs: You'll need Rock Climb multiple times to fully explore the area. Keep Bibarel or another HM buddy in your party.
- Trainers: A good number of Ace Trainers, Swimmers, and Black Belts are found here, all with mid-to-high 40s teams — perfect experience fodder for your growing squad

It's a good place to stock up on Pokémon evolutions you might still need for the National Dex.

| Route 226 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Machoke | fighting | 48-50 | 25% |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 49 | 20% |
| Banette | ghost | 48-50 | 20% |
| Raticate | normal | 49-50 | 15% |
| Wingull | flying/water | 47-49 | 15% |
| Rattata | normal | 47 | 5% |

# Route 228

## Sinnoh's Tropical Postgame

Route 228 is the sandy desert path that branches off east from the Survival Area. Expect a constant sandstorm that wears down all Pokémon who aren't Rock, Ground, or Steel-type.

This route features narrow bridges that can only be crossed while riding a bike. There are multiple ways to go through this route so choose your favorite or do them all!

### Important Items

- TM 37 – Sandstorm: Fittingly located in the desert. Handy for a weather-based team.
- Razor Fang: Found near the route's end. This is essential if you want to evolve Gligar into Gliscor at night. Important for dex complation.

| Route 228 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Dugtrio** | ground | 50-52 | 30% |
| Rhydon | rock/ground | 50-52 | 20% |
| **Cacturne** | grass/dark | 50 | 20% |
| **Hippowdon** | ground | 50-51 | 20% |
| **Diglett** | ground | 49 | 5% |
| **Cacnea** | grass/dark | 50 | 5% |

# Route 229

## The Hidden Grove

Route 229 sits tucked between Route 228's desert and the Resort Area. It's a lush, grassy route with tall grass patches, hidden paths, and quite a few Trainers who are eager to test their high-level Pokémon against you.

### Trainers

You'll find double battles, Ace Trainers, and Rangers here, with Pokémon generally in the mid-to-high 50s. This makes it another excellent training ground.

### Items

• Power Items: A huge draw of this route is that it's one of the few places where you can get the Power Items (Power Weight, Power Bracer, etc.) by talking to a man inside a house. These are vital for EV training — if you're serious about raising competitive Pokémon, don't skip them.

| Route 229 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Roselia | grass/poison | 48-50 | 45% |
| **Ledian** | bug/flying | 50 | 20% |
| **Volbeat** | bug | 49 | 10% |
| **Illumise** | bug | 49 | 10% |
| Pidgey | normal/flying | 47 | 5% |
| Beautifly | bug/flying | 48 | 5% |
| Dustox | bug/poison | 48 | 5% |

# Resort Area

## The Luxury Retreat

The Resort Area is the last settlement in the Battle Zone, and it's a stark contrast to the harsh wilderness around it. Think of this as your endgame getaway — peaceful, fancy, and surprisingly useful. It features many exclusive facilities for the luxurious life style and things to do that only true completionists would want to take on.

Kick back and relax on this beatiful, peaceful corner of Sinnoh!

### Notable features

- The Ribbon Syndicate: This massive building is only open if you have at least 10 ribbons on one Pokémon. Inside, you'll find:

o Ribbon Shop: Buy exclusive ribbons for your Pokémon.

o Grooming Service: Boost your Pokémon's happiness even further — perfect for friendship evolutions or maxing out affection.

- Luxury Villa: After becoming Champion, you're offered a villa here, and you can customize it with furniture. While mostly cosmetic, it's a fun way to spend your hard-earned cash.
- Fishing: The Resort waters have high-level Tentacruel, Pelipper, and the chance for Gyarados and other strong catches with the Super Rod.

### Why This Matters for Completionists

The Resort Area might not look like much at first glance, but:

- The Ribbon Syndicate can help with completing your Ribbon Mastery goals.
- It provides some of the best late-game training.
- It's a relaxing base to prepare before diving into even tougher challenges like Stark Mountain or the Battle Frontier.

# Route 227

## The Volcanic Path

Now that we've wrapped up the rest of the island, it's finally time to head north toward Stark Mountain, one of the toughest challenges in the game. To get there, we'll trek across Route 227, a rugged, lava-scorched path North from Route 226. If you would like to do some extra exploration, you can also visit Route 230, found West from the Resort Area. it's mostly just water and trainers but you can catch some pokémon there such as **Sealeo** and **Wailord**.

### Route 227

Route 227 is not your standard path — it's a maze of rocky slopes, falling ash, and treacherous cliffs. You'll need Rock Climb, Surf, and Strength handy just to fully explore it. If you've been leaning on Bibarel as your HM companion, this is the route where it really pays off.

Route 227 is packed with Veterans, Dragon Tamers, and Black Belts, all using teams in the high 40s to low 50s. Make sure to pick up TM 35 Flamethrower on that route.

| Route 227 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| Fearow | normal/flying | 51-53 | 20% |
| Rhydon | rock/ground | 54 | 20% |
| **Camerupt** | ground/fire | 53 | 20% |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 51-53 | 15% |
| **Weezing** | poison | 52 | 10% |
| Rhyhorn | rock/ground | 52 | 5% |
| **Skarmory** | steel/flying | 53 | 5% |
| **Numel** | ground/fire | 51 | 5% |

# Stark Mountain

## Team Galactic's return

Stark Mountain is the big volcanic dungeon at the north end of the Battle Zone. It's a multi-room lava cave that requires Strength and Rock Climb to fully explore, contains tough trainers and rare Fire/Steel Pokémon, and is the home of **Heatran** — but Heatran only becomes available after you defeat Team Galactic's forces in the mountain and complete the follow-up in the Survival Area. This is where you will meet Buck, a hot-headed Fire-type specialist who will accompany you through Stark Mountain

### Inside Stark Mountain

When you first enter, you will encounter Team Galactic in the mountain. Even without Cyrus, Team Galactic is still up to their usual tricks. Charon (now acting as Galactic's leader in Cyrus's absence) moves to seize the Magma Stone and Heatran. Your job is to stop them once again at the deepest chamber of the volcano.

| Stark Mountain Interior | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Magcargo** | rock/fire | 53-55 | 40% |
| Weezing | poison | 52-54 | 15% |
| Graveler | rock/ground | 52-54 | 15% |
| Rhydon | rock/ground | 55 | 10% |
| Golbat | poison/flying | 53 | 10% |
| **Koffing** | poison | 53 | 5% |
| **Slugma** | fire | 53 | 5% |

# Stark Mountain Interior

Team Galactic's return

### Important items & TMs in the mountain

Stark Mountain hides several valuable items if you check ledges and dead-ends with Rock Climb and Strength:

- TM50 — Overheat (found in the mountain).
- Flame Plate and other hidden valuables (Rare Candies, Max Revive, Ultra Balls, etc.) are tucked away in side pits and behind climbable walls. Use the Dowsing Machine to spot them.

### Trainers

- During your trek through Stark Mountan you won't actually fight any Galactic Grunts. Instead the cave is filled with strong trainers, most of which are double battles. Thanfully Buck is helping you and even healing your pokémon after each battle. be prepared for a wide variety of strong pokémon!

### Deepest chamber

In the deepest chamber of the mountain, Team Galactic is performing their plan. You must stop them.

You pair up with Buck to battle Commander Mars and Jupiter Once again. They are still using the same teams as before: Both of them have Bronzong and Golbat, Mars has a Purugly and Jupiter has a Skuntank. At this point in the game the teams are not nearly as threatening anymore and together with Buck, you should be able to defeat them easily.

After the battle Looker intercepts and arrests Charon and the rest of Team Galactic. Looks like their reign is finally over for good.

### Heatran

After Team Galactic is finished, fly back to the Survival Area. If you talk to Buck, Heatran appears in Stark Mountain, ready to be challenged and captured. Make your way all the way back to the innermost chamber of the mountain. And challenge heatran. The battle is difficult, but you should be able to catch this powerful legendary pokémon with enough patience.

# Route 224

## The Seabreak Path

After becoming the Champion, there is one more place that opened up. In the eastern part of Victory Road you can access a new room that was previously blocked.

That's right — this side chamber leads to an entirely new route that wasn't available during the main story. This area is a special treat for completionists since it offers a few exclusive encounters, and some challenging trainers at the most remote part of Sinnoh.

### How to get there

In order to get there, fly to the Pokémon League and go back to victory road. Close to the exit where you came from on the Eastern wall is another pathway that used to be blocked by a trainer. Now this trainer has moved and it unlocks Route 224. Here you can find items such as a Rare Candy and a Dragon Fang. Even before Route 224, the hidden section of Victory Road is special. You can fish for **Lapras** with the Super Rod!

| Route 224 | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Level | Encounter % |
| **Oddish/bellsprout** | grass/poison | 49 | 20% |
| Roselia | grass/poison | 50 | 20% |
| Floatzel | water | 50 | 20% |
| Pelipper | water/flying | 51 | 10% |
| **Gastrodon** | water/ground | 49 | 10% |
| **Gloom** | grass/poison | 51 | 5% |
| **Weebinbell** | grass/poison | 51 | 5% |
| Beautifly | bug/flying | 52 | 5% |
| Dustox | bug/poison | 52 | 5% |

# Special Encounter Methods

## Pokédex filling

You've done it, Trainer! If you've been following this guide so far, you have been to every accessible area in the game. That is quite the feat! However, if you are filling the National dex it might seem a little empty. If that's the case, this section is made for you! We will be covering different ways to find pokémon that have not been mentioned so far so you will soon be finding dozens of new species!

### Dongle method

This is a special feature in Pokémon Platinum (and Diamond/Pearl) that lets you encounter certain Pokémon normally unavailable in Sinnoh by inserting a Game Boy Advance Pokémon cartridge into the second slot of your Nintendo DS or DS Lite.

Sadly, this only works on the original DS and DS Lite — the DSi and newer consoles don't have a GBA slot, so the feature is completely inaccessible there. This way you can encounter many pokémon that originated in the Kanto and Hoenn regions.

### Pal Park

The Pal Park is Sinnoh's official "bridge" to the GBA Pokémon era. It allows you to transfer your old Pokémon from any Game Boy Advance Pokémon game (Ruby, Sapphire, Emerald, FireRed, LeafGreen) into your copy of Platinum. Like the Dongle Method, this only works on the original DS and DS Lite, since you need the GBA slot. How It Works:

1. Make sure you've unlocked the National Dex.
2. Save your game and insert a GBA cartridge into the DS's Slot-2.
3. On the main menu of Platinum, select "Migrate from [Game]".

- You can pick up to 6 Pokémon at a time from the PC boxes in your GBA save file.
- Be warned: once they're migrated, they are permanently removed from the GBA game.

4. Boot up your save file in Platinum and go to Pal Park (Route 221).

5. You'll participate in a special catching event:

- The 6 Pokémon you migrated will be hiding in tall grass, water, or caves.
- You're given a set of Park Balls (which always succeed, like Master Balls).
- Find and catch all 6 to complete the transfer!

# Special Encounter Methods

## Pokédex filling

### Trophy Garden

The Trophy Garden, behind the Pokémon Mansion on Route 212, is a great postgame location for filling out the National Dex. While common Pokémon like Pikachu, Pichu, and Roselia are always present, the real draw is the daily “rare” Pokémon Mr. Backlot adds after bragging about them.

Each day, one rare Pokémon is added to the garden’s encounter pool. Up to two rares are available at once — if a third is added, the oldest one cycles out.

### Super Rod

This might seem obvious, but you can find plenty of National Dex exclusive pokémon with the Super Rod. It is only obtained in the fight area by the pier from a fisherman. because it is obtained so late, there are a lot of places in mainland Sinnoh where you can go back to and fish for rare pokémon.

### The Poké Radar

After unlocking the National Dex, Professor Rowan will give you the Poké Radar when you visit him in Sandgem Town. This handy gadget lets you chain wild Pokémon encounters in tall grass — and it’s the key to finding rare Pokémon and shinies that otherwise don’t appear in Sinnoh.

How to Use the Poké Radar:

1. Charge it up by walking 50 steps.
2. Use it in a patch of tall grass — a few patches will shake.
3. Step into one of the shaking patches to encounter a wild Pokémon.
4. After the battle, the radar recharges, and more patches will shake.
5. By defeating or capturing the same species repeatedly, you can build a “chain”.

• The longer the chain, the higher your odds of finding rarer Pokémon (and shiny Pokémon if you’re extra lucky).

• If you step into the wrong patch, let the radar’s charge expire, or encounter a different Pokémon, the chain breaks.

# Cresselia

## Pokédex filling

After Becoming the Champion, many Legendary pokémon become available for capture. We have already covered the Lake Trio, Giratina and Heatran but there are still a lot more. As a general rule of thumb for all of these legendaries, keep a lot of Ultra balls with you, have a pokémon that can use Thunder Wave or Stun Spore for paralysis and preferably a way to deal fized damage to the opponent (False Swipe, Super Fang) but this part is optional. Also make sire to save before starting the battle. If you forget to save and you knock out the legendary, don't worry! You can battle it again if you reach the hall of fame after rematching the Pokémon League.

### The Lunar Pokémon: Cresselia

Step 1: Starting the Quest

• After becoming Champion, head to Canalave City.

• Enter the house near the sailor by the port (the same sailor who takes you to Iron Island). Inside, you'll find his son lying in bed, suffering from endless nightmares.

• The sailor begs for help, and this triggers the quest to find Cresselia.

Step 2: Fullmoon Island

• Talk to the sailor again, and he'll take you by boat to Fullmoon Island.

• Once you arrive, you'll find Cresselia waiting at the northern end of the island.

• When you interact with her, she flies off immediately, leaving behind a glowing feather.

Key Item Obtained: Lunar Wing — bring this back to Canalave City to cure the sailor's son of his nightmares. (This is the lore tie-in to Darkrai, who causes nightmares, while Cresselia heals them.)

Step 3: The Roaming Legendary

• After fleeing Fullmoon Island, Cresselia becomes a roaming Pokémon across Sinnoh.

• She's at Level 50 when you encounter her.

• Like all roamers, her location changes every time you move to a different route.

Catching roamers can be frustrating. Use the Tracking app on your Pokétch (Obtained from the Jubilfe Pokétch building) to keep track of it's location. You can do the same thing with Mesprit. It is recommended to use Mean Look immediately to stop it from fleeing.

# Regigigas

Pokédex filling

## Awakening Regigigas

• After becoming Champion, head to Snowpoint City.

• Speak with Candice, the Gym Leader, near the entrance of the Snowpoint Temple. She'll now allow you to enter.

• Inside is a multi-floor ruin with icy sliding puzzles — a nice callback to her Gym design.

• At the deepest level, you'll find the slumbering titan: Regigigas.

**Step 2: Requirements to Awaken Regigigas**

In Pokémon Platinum, Regigigas will only awaken if you have Regirock, Regice, and Registeel in your party. Without them, it remains just a statue. There is only one way to obtain them today. There used to be a timed event distribution but that is long gone.

The most reliable method is to transfer them from the Game Boy Advance titles:

• Pokémon Ruby, Sapphire, or Emerald → contain all three Regis.

• Pokémon FireRed and LeafGreen → also allow you to catch them after unlocking certain side quests.

For step-by-step instructions on transferring from GBA to Platinum, check this guide's Pal Park section, where we explained how to migrate Pokémon forward from Gen III (Page 111).

**Step 3: The Regigigas Battle**

• Once you bring all three Regis into Snowpoint Temple, interact with Regigigas to awaken it.

• Level 1 encounter. (Very low!)

• Type: Normal

• Ability: Slow Start (halves Attack and Speed for the first 5 turns of battle).

# Turnback Cave and Giratina

## Pokédex filling

As mentioned before, if you didn't catch Giratina in the Distorition World you can still catch it in Turnback Cave - an area with unique mechanics.

### How to Access

• After you've cleared the Distortion World and Giratina storyline, a new location opens: Spring Path, east of Route 214.

• At the end of Spring Path lies the foreboding Turnback Cave.

• This cave is a mysterious, randomly generated maze, and it's the only place in Platinum where you can catch Giratina in its Altered Forme if you didn't grab it in the Distortion World.

### Navigating the cave

Turnback Cave is not a straightforward dungeon. Instead, it's a test of persistence and luck:

• The cave has a series of pillared rooms.

• Your goal is to find the three pillars before entering more than 30 rooms.

• Every room you enter resets the layout, so the cave changes constantly.

Strategy for Finding the Pillars

1. Always move in one direction (e.g., always go north until you can't, then east). This helps minimize wasted rooms.
2. Keep a room counter in your head or on paper. You must find all three pillars in under 30 rooms.
3. If you fail, the cave resets, and you can try again.

### Rewards

• After the first pillar, you'll get an item like Rare Bone.

• After the second pillar, another item such as Odd Keystone.

• After the third pillar, you'll encounter Giratina (Altered Forme).

• After catching Giratina, if you go through Turnback Cave again, You will get a Reaper Cloth

# Dialga & Palkia

Pokédex filling

### Unlocking the Orbs

After defeating Cyrus in the Distortion World and completing the main story arc with Giratina, you'll be able to revisit Mt. Coronet. Deep inside, past the waterfall areas and the caverns leading up toward Spear Pillar, you can collect three legendary items:

- Adamant Orb – boosts Dialga
- Lustrous Orb – boosts Palkia
- Griseous Orb – changes Giratina into its Origin Forme when held.

These items are hidden within the same chamber, so make sure to explore thoroughly once you've unlocked Surf and Waterfall.

### Dialga & Palkia Encounters

1. Go to Spear Pillar with the Adamant Orb and Lustrous Orb in your bag.
2. Interact with the altar:

o The Adamant Orb summons Dialga (Lv. 70).

o The Lustrous Orb summons Palkia (Lv. 70).

3. You can catch both of them in Platinum, unlike Diamond and Pearl where they were version exclusives.

### Dialga & Palkia Encounters

• While Dialga and Palkia are great additions, don't miss the Griseous Orb.

• When given to Giratina, it will change from its Altered Forme (the one you caught in the Distortion World or Turnback Cave) into its Origin Forme — the same serpentine appearance it had during the story events.

• Unlike Dialga and Palkia's orbs, the Griseous Orb doesn't just boost moves — it also permanently changes Giratina's form when held.

# The Legendary Birds

Pokédex filling

The Legendary Birds refer to the legendary pokémon of Kanto: Articuno, Zapdos and Moltres. After receiving the National Dex, They are also available in Platinum.

### Unlocking the Birds

• After you've entered the Hall of Fame and obtained the National Pokédex, Professor Oak will show up in Eterna City at the house by the Pokémon Center.

• He'll tell you that the three Kanto birds — Zapdos, Articuno, and Moltres — are now roaming across Sinnoh.

• From this point, they appear on your Pokétch Marking Map app.

### Encounter Details

• All three are at Level 60.

• They roam randomly across Sinnoh, changing routes whenever you move between areas.

• Each has its signature typing:

- Zapdos – Electric/Flying
- Articuno – Ice/Flying
- Moltres – Fire/Flying

### Catching Strategy

Roaming Pokémon are some of the most annoying to catch, but here's how to make it manageable:

1. Get the Marking Map app on your Pokétch if you don't already have it. It shows their current route in real-time.
2. Repel Trick: Use Repels and keep a lead Pokémon at level 59. That way, the only Level 60 encounter will be the Legendary Bird.
3. Use Mean Look to make sure they don't flee. Crobat is the most common pokémon that learns it.

# Filling the Regional Pokédex

## Pokédex filling

By now, if you've been keeping up with encounters, trades, and events along the way, your Sinnoh Regional Pokédex should be looking pretty full. But odds are, you'll still be missing a handful of entries — especially those tricky evolution-only Pokémon. Don't worry, this is totally normal, and this is the stage of the game where we mop up the last stragglers.

### EXP Farming Methods

To evolve all those Pokémon hanging out in your PC boxes, you'll need a steady source of experience points. Here are the best ways to grind efficiently:

• The Battleground (Survival Area, postgame)

Every day, four Gym Leaders and other strong trainers gather here for rematches. These battles give excellent EXP and keep things interesting. It's the premier training ground once you've finished the League.

• Vs. Seeker Trainers

If you'd rather grind the old-fashioned way, Trainers like the Fisherman with Gyarados on Route 222 or the Socialites outside the Pokémon Mansion can be re-battled for great EXP (and in the Socialites' case, cash).

• Trainer Café (Valor Lakefront)

Another daily option — the trainers here give smaller battles but still chip away at your leveling. Handy for mid-level evolutions.

### The Day Care Trick

If battling feels too slow, there's a neat little exploit with the Day Care:

- Drop off a Pokémon that needs leveling.
- Head over to Fuego Ironworks with its spinning floor panels.
- Secure your DS/D-Pad in place so your character keeps walking infinitely in circles.
- The constant steps translate into EXP in the Day Care — hands-free grinding!

It's not fast, but it works overnight, and it's fun to check in and see who's suddenly evolved while you weren't looking.

# Elite Four Rematch

## Becoming the Champion... Again!

Now that you've conquered every corner of Sinnoh, it's time to re-challenge the Pokémon League. But fair warning — the rematch versions of the Elite Four are much tougher. They now wield higher-level Pokémon.

### Preparations

- Recommended Level: Aim for at least Level 70–75 across your entire team. You can squeak by lower, but this is the sweet spot where fights are challenging but manageable.
- Healing Items: Stock up on Full Restores, Max Potions, and Revives. The enemies hit hard and status moves are common.
- Held Items: Leftovers, Choice items, Focus Sash, and Berries (like Sitrus, Lum, or Yache) can turn the tide.
- EXP Farming: If you need extra levels, revisit the previous chapter's EXP tips — Battleground, Vs Seeker, Lucky Egg, etc.

### Aaron – Bug Specialist

For beating the Elite Four again, you can refer to the first Pokémon League section of the guide since everything is the same except for the levels. We will still briefly go through them here.

- Fire-types are your MVPs here, especially against Scizor, Heracross, and Vespiquen.
- Rock- or Flying-types can handle Yanmega, but beware of Psychic coverage.
- Drapion, his ace, isn't weak to Psychic despite being part Poison — remember, it's Poison/Dark. Ground-types work best here.

**Starter Matchups:**

- Torterra: Struggles with Yanmega and Vespiquen but does well vs Drapion and Heracross with Earthquake. Needs backup.
- Infernape: Absolute star player. Fire moves shred most of Aaron's team. Watch out for Drapion's Earthquake.
- Empoleon: Handles Yanmega with Ice Beam and resists Bug Buzz. Needs coverage (like Earthquake or Ground support) to help with Drapion.

# Elite Four Rematch

Becoming the Champion... Again!

### Bertha – Ground Specialist

• Grass-types are incredible here — Torterra, Roserade, or even Tangrowth shine.

• Water-types also do well, but beware of Bertha's coverage.

• Ice-type coverage helps vs Gliscor.

• Status moves like Sleep or Toxic are useful against her bulky Hippowdon.

**Starter Matchups:**

• Torterra: MVP here. Grass STAB demolishes Whiscash, Rhyperior, and Hippowdon. Needs to watch for Gliscor's Ice Fang.

• Infernape: Not the best matchup overall, but with Grass Knot it can handle the heavy hitters. Needs careful play.

• Empoleon: Excellent choice. Surfs through her entire team with only Gliscor to be cautious about.

### Flint – Fire Specialist

• Flint's team hits very hard and has coverage for Water and Ground counters (Thunderbolt, SolarBeam, ThunderPunch). Don't underestimate him.

• Bulky Water-types (Milotic, Empoleon, Gastrodon) are still your safest picks.

• Rock-types like Rhyperior can smash through most of his team but must watch for SolarBeam.

• Priority moves help finish off his frail but fast sweepers like Houndoom and Infernape.

**Starter Matchups:**

• Torterra: Very bad matchup. Weak to Fire and Ice Punch coverage. Needs heavy backup here.

• Infernape: Can outspeed and handle Flareon/Houndoom but risks dangerous mirror matches. Needs Water- or Rock-type teammates.

• Empoleon: Great against everything except Infernape's ThunderPunch. Surf (or Hydro Pump) cleans house.

# Elite Four Rematch

Becoming the Champion... Again!

### Lucian – Psychic Specialist

• Dark-types shine here — Spiritomb, Weavile, Drapion, Honchkrow all eat through Psychic spam.

• Bug-types like Heracross and Scizor are also fantastic, though they need to be wary of coverage moves.

• Bronzong is a wall. Fire-types are best here.

• Gallade is his ace and hits everything. Intimidate support (Gyarados, Staraptor) can help mitigate its damage.

Starter Matchups:

• Torterra: Tough fight. Weak to Espeon's Grass Knot and Gallade's Close Combat. Needs Dark-type backup.

• Infernape: Good vs Bronzong and Gallade, but fragile against Psychic spam. Careful switching required.

• Empoleon: Solid wall to Espeon and Mr. Mime. Needs backup for Bronzong and Gallade.

### Champion Cynthia – Rematch

Strategy breakdown:

• Spiritomb:

No weaknesses in Gen 4 (before Fairy existed). Bulky and annoying. Use strong neutral moves or status to wear it down. Fighting it patiently is the key.

• Togekiss:

Very dangerous with Air Slash flinch spam + Aura Sphere for Rock/Steel counters. Ice- and Electric-types work well.

• Roserade:

Glass cannon but fast. Fire-, Flying-, and Psychic-types handle it. Watch for Shadow Ball coverage.

# Elite Four Rematch

## Becoming the Champion... Again!

• Milotic:

Bulky and tricky with Mirror Coat to punish special attackers. Grass- or Electric-types are best, but physical damage is the safest bet.

• Lucario:

Hits everything with its diverse movepool. Fire- or Ground-type moves are your cleanest answers.

• Garchomp (Ace):

The real boss. Level 78 with massive Attack and Speed, plus Stone Edge and Fire Fang for coverage. Ice-types can beat it but must outspeed or survive a hit. Bulky Dragons (Dragonite, Salamence) or Intimidate users like Gyarados can help.

### Starter matchup

• Torterra:

Struggles here. Garchomp, Togekiss, and Roserade are all threats. Can Earthquake Lucario and wall Milotic decently, but needs strong teammates.

• Infernape:

Excellent coverage against Roserade and Lucario, but fragile against Spiritomb and Togekiss. Can chip Garchomp if fast enough. Needs support.

• Empoleon:

Solid matchup overall. Handles Togekiss with Ice Beam, resists Roserade, and can pressure Garchomp. Watch out for Lucario's Aura Sphere.

### Starter matchup

• Come prepared with healing items — Full Restores and Revives will almost certainly be needed.

• Don't be afraid to use status (Thunder Wave, Toxic, Will-O-Wisp) to make her team manageable.

• Save your Ice Beam/Dragon counters for Garchomp — nothing else is as dangerous.

# Journey's End

## The Unbeatable Champion

And with that… you've beaten Cynthia again.

### Congratulations!

Once more, your team is entered into the Hall of Fame. But this time, the victory feels even sweeter — you've proven you can stand tall against Sinnoh's ultimate challenge at its hardest. This is the pinnacle of Platinum's single-player journey, and you've earned every bit of bragging rights.

### Closing Chapter – The End... or Just the Beginning?

Congratulations, Trainer!

You've trekked across snowy peaks, sweltering marshes, haunted forests, and cosmic dimensions. You've fought Galactic Commanders, stopped a plot to reshape the universe, and stared down the fiercest Champion in Pokémon history — twice. Your name now rests proudly in the Hall of Fame, proof that you've mastered Sinnoh's grand adventure.

But if you've been following this guide, you know by now: Pokémon Platinum isn't just about rolling the credits. This region is bursting with side quests, secrets, and completionist challenges waiting to be tackled.

### What You've Accomplished!

- Filled (or nearly filled) the Regional Pokédex.
- Defeated every Gym and Elite Four rematch.
- Explored every route, cave, and optional location.
- Caught or encountered nearly every Legendary Sinnoh has to offer.
- Mopped up items, fossils, and rare TMs hidden across the land.

You've done what many players never attempt — seen everything Sinnoh has to give.

# Journey's End



## What's Left for the True Completionist

If you're the kind of Trainer who only stops when there's absolutely nothing left, here are the final frontiers:

• **National Dex Completion**:

With Pal Park, swarms, the Trophy Garden, the Poké Radar, and event Pokémon, your next mission could be to complete the entire 493. This is the crown jewel for collectors.

• **Daily and Rotating Trainers**:

The Battleground in the Survival Area lets you test your mettle against Gym Leaders every day. It's also fantastic for EXP grinding.

• **Battle Tower Streaks**:

Hit up the Battle Tower in the Fight Area to test your team-building against endless waves of strong opponents.

• **The Battle Frontier**:

The ultimate challenge in Platinum — five unique facilities, each testing different battling skills. This is where competitive strategy, prediction, and patience become essential. From the fast-paced Battle Factory to the tricky Battle Arcade, mastering the Frontier is the final badge of honor for the most dedicated Trainers.

## Farewell, Champion

And so, we close the pages of this guide. Whether you've played casually, checked every nook and cranny, or gone full-on completionist, Pokémon Platinum has given you one of the richest adventures in the entire series.

But remember — a true Trainer's journey never really ends. There are always new Pokémon to raise, new strategies to try, and new memories to make.

So step outside the League doors one more time, look out over the Sinnoh region you've conquered, and know this: you've earned it all.

# Bonus: Battle Frontier

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

## Only for true competitors!

When you first step into the Battle Frontier, it feels like entering a whole new world — a sprawling hub filled with Trainers, shops, and of course, the five infamous facilities. Unlike the Pokémon League, there's no "end" here — your goal is to rack up Battle Points (BP), climb streaks, and challenge the Frontier Brains.

This is the playground for completionists and competitive battlers alike. Let's walk through what makes this place tick.

## Frontier Attractions

**BP Shops** - Instead of money, the Battle Frontier uses Battle Points (BP) as currency. You'll earn these by winning battles in the facilities, and the more consecutive wins you get, the more BP rolls in. Shops offer some of the best rewards in the game, including:

• Power Items (for EV training)

• Choice items (Choice Band, Choice Scarf, Choice Specs)

• Focus Sash, Life Orb, Expert Belt, and other top-tier competitive items

• TMs that are otherwise rare or unobtainable

For any Trainer planning to battle competitively — in the Frontier or against friends — these items are absolutely essential.

**IV Judge** - Inside the Frontier is a man who can judge your Pokémon's potential, giving hints about its IVs (the hidden stats that determine a Pokémon's long-term strength). If you've ever wondered whether that shiny you caught has good competitive potential, he's your guy.

**Move Tutors** - The Frontier also features move tutors that take BP in exchange for teaching your Pokémon powerful moves they couldn't learn otherwise. These include staples like Ice Punch, ThunderPunch, and Heat Wave, making BP farming worthwhile even if you don't care about streaks.

# Frontier Facilities

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

**Battle Tower**

- The most “traditional” facility.
- Face a series of opponents in standard 3-on-3 single battles (or 4-on-4 doubles if you prefer).
- No healing items mid-battle, and opponents’ teams get progressively harder.

**Battle Factory**

- The ultimate test of adaptability.
- You don’t use your own Pokémon — instead, you rent Pokémon from a random pool.
- After each battle, you can swap one of your Pokémon for one of the opponent’s.
- Rewards creativity, prediction, and knowledge of matchups more than raw team-building.

**Battle Arcade**

- Think of it as a Pokémon slot machine.
- Before each battle, a roulette spins and applies a random effect — it could boost your team, hinder the enemy, or vice versa.
- Winning requires rolling with the punches and adjusting your playstyle to the field’s quirks.

**Battle Castle**

- A resource management challenge.
- At the start, your Pokémon don’t hold items, and healing isn’t automatic between battles.
- Instead, you earn Castle Points (CP) and must spend them to heal, restore PP, or even buy items for your team.
- Winning here means carefully balancing battles and resource use.

**Battle Hall**

- The most unique facility.
- You pick one Pokémon, and face 10 battles against every type.
- You can challenge types in any order, but your Pokémon must take on all 17 types eventually.
- Requires incredible planning — your single Pokémon must be versatile enough to handle everything from Ghosts to Dragons.

At the of each facility you wil have to battle against a Frontier Brain and winning earns you a gold symbol as trophy.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

The Battle Frontier is where Pokémon Platinum truly tests you. You can't brute force your way through here; you'll need to carefully raise a team, pay attention to IVs and EVs, and think like a competitive battler. And the rewards — powerful items, rare TMs, and the pride of conquering the strongest trainers in the game.

There are lots of pokémon that can deal with the frontier but as a sample team we will be using a team consisting of Salamence, Togekiss and Tyranitar. Here are the notable aspects:

**Salamence** holding a Focus Sash - Moves: Dragon Dance, Outrage, Earthquake, Fire Fang

**Togekiss** holding Leftovers - Moves: Air Slash, Thunder Wave, Aura Sphere, Roost

**Tyranitar** holding a Life Orb - Moves: Stone Edge, Crunch, Earthquake, Aerial Ace

This team has a balance of offense and defense and should be able to defeat all Frontier Brains

## Catching and Breeding

In order to get the best possible stats for our pokémon, it is important to breed for them instead of just catching them in the wild. This might get a bit complicated but just rememer: Your pokémon don't have to be perfect to win. You can simply win by outplaying your opponent. Having optimal stats just makes it easier.

**IVs** (Individual Values) — Your Pokémon's DNA

• What they are: Think of IVs as the "genetic potential" of a Pokémon. Each stat (HP, Attack, Defense, Sp. Atk, Sp. Def, Speed) gets a number from 0 to 31.

• Why they matter: At level 100, each IV is worth 1 stat point. A Pokémon with a 31 Attack IV has 31 more Attack points than one with a 0 Attack IV. That's like having a free item boost!

• Example: Our Adamant Salamence — if it has 31 Attack IV, it will hit way harder with Outrage than one with a middling Attack IV like 15. For Speed, a 31 IV is essential to keep up with the Frontier's faster threats.

• How to check: In Platinum, the Battle Tower IV Judge tells you if your Pokémon has great IVs. He won't give exact numbers, but he'll say things like "can't be better" (IV = 31). Use this to pick breeding parents.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### EVs (Effort Values) — Your Pokémon's Training

What they are: EVs are like "training points" gained by defeating Pokémon. Each Pokémon you battle gives a specific EV — e.g., Zubat gives 1 Speed EV, Geodude gives 1 Defense EV.

• Limits:

- A Pokémon can gain a total of 510 EVs.
- Only 252 EVs can go into a single stat.
- Every 4 EVs = +1 stat point at level 100.

• Why they matter: EVs are the difference between a Tyranitar that smacks things around casually and one that obliterates with every hit.

• Example builds:

- Salamence: 252 Attack / 252 Speed / 6 HP — turns it into a fast, hard-hitting dragon.
- Togekiss (support): 252 HP / 252 Sp. Atk — bulky enough to survive while firing off Air Slashes.
- Tyranitar: 252 Attack / 252 Speed — making it a sandstorm juggernaut.

• Controlling EVs:

- Use Power Items (like Power Bracer, Power Lens) to boost EV gain in specific stats.
- Use Macho Brace to double EV gain.
- Vitamins (Protein, Carbos, etc.) give quick EV boosts (10 per use, up to 100 in a stat).
- If you make a mistake, Berries like Pomeg or Kelpsy remove EVs.

### Natures — Personality with a Punch

What they are: Natures modify your stats, boosting one by 10% and lowering another by 10%.

• Why they matter: Getting the right Nature is basically a free 10% stat boost in the right place. Wrong Nature? It's like handicapping yourself permanently.

• How to get them: Use the Everstone trick in breeding — give an Everstone to a parent with the right Nature to increase the odds of passing it down.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

## Putting it all together

### Catching locations

- Bagon (→ Salamence) — post-game; north end of Route 210 (PokéRadar patch). You'll need the Poké Radar / post-Elite Four access to reliably find it.
- Larvitar (→ Tyranitar) — post-game swarm; in Platinum Larvitar shows up as a swarm on Route 206 (you need the National Dex / swarm mechanic active).
- Togepi (→ Togekiss) — a gift egg from Cynthia in Eterna City once you've cleared the relevant Team Galactic events there (you'll receive a baby Egg you can hatch).

### Step-by-step breeding workflow

1. Catch high-IV parents first. Use wild hunts or trades to get parents with good stats — that gives you the "seed" IVs to work with.
2. Decide which parent will pass the Nature. Put an Everstone on the parent with the nature you want (in Gen IV this gives a strong chance; female/Ditto cases matter).
3. Pass egg moves: make the male parent know Dragon Dance (for Bagon) and ensure it's in the Dragon egg group (Gyarados is one example). Breed until a Bagon hatches with Dragon Dance.
4. Check IVs on each hatch (see the next section about the IV Judge). Keep the best hatch(es) and use them as parents for the next generation — repeat, gradually consolidating perfect IVs across stats. Because only 3 IVs inherit each generation in Platinum, you'll typically breed iteratively: get 2–3 perfect IVs, use that offspring as a parent with another good parent, and keep chipping away.
5. Ability note (Togekiss / Serene Grace): abilities are random at egg generation in Gen IV. If you need Serene Grace on the Togepi line, you'll likely have to hatch multiple eggs until one comes out with Serene Grace, then evolve it — or use a migrated/traded Pokémon that already has Serene Grace. Abilities do not reliably "pass" like natures do in Gen IV.

Short verdict: perfect IVs + ideal nature + desired egg move + desired ability = slow grind in Platinum. It's very doable, but expect a lot of eggs — that's normal.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

**How to check IVs in-game: the Battle Tower "IV Judge"**

Checking IVs in Platinum is essential — you don't want to chase a broken parent. The in-game IV Judge (often called the Stat Judge / IV checker) lives in the Battle Tower (inside the Battle Frontier). Here's the step-by-step:

1. Go to the Battle Tower (Battle Frontier). Inside the Battle Tower lobby, the IV Judge stands near the PC (upper-right corner of the lobby). Talk to him and choose the Pokémon you want appraised.

2. He gives two pieces of information:

o Overall potential (the sum of all IVs) — he gives a phrase like "decent all around", "above average overall", "relatively superior", or "outstanding" which correspond to IV total ranges.

o The stat with the highest IV (or one of them if there's a tie) and a phrase that indicates the IV range for that stat. The phrases map to approximate IV ranges:

"It's rather decent in that regard" → IV ~ 0–15

"It's very good in that regard" → IV ~ 16–25

"It's fantastic in that regard" → IV ~ 26–30

"It can't be better in that regard" → IV = 31 (perfect IV). gamefaqs.gamespot.com+1

3. Use repeated checks to narrow down: if the judge names different stats as the "highest" on subsequent checks, he's revealing other perfect/high IVs (he can be asked repeatedly). This is how you confirm a hatch has 2 or 3 perfect IVs — keep talking to him and log what he says.

4. Practical workflow when breeding: hatch an egg → talk to the IV Judge → if the hatch has desirable perfect IV(s), keep it and use it as the next breeding parent; if not, continue hatching. Over generations you can "stack" perfect IVs into one child.

**IV & nature targets for this team** (what to aim for):

(You don't need 6×-perfect IVs to dominate the Frontier, but these are ideal targets.):

• Salamence (ADAMANT sweeper): prioritize 31 Attack and 31 Speed

• Tyranitar (ADAMANT heavy hitter): prioritize 31 Attack, then 31 HP

• Togekiss (support / modest special sets): Modest or Bold nature depending on whether you want more SpA or bulk; aim for 31 HP and 31 SpA for a bulky support/para-flinch set

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### EV Training in Platinum — Step-by-Step Guide

Before we start, here's what you'll need in your bag:

- Macho Brace (double EVs gained) — found in Pastoria City.
- EXP Share — lets a Pokémon gain EVs without fighting directly. Great for fragile babies like Togepi.

Target Spreads for the Team:

- Salamence → 252 Attack / 252 Speed / 6 HP
- Togekiss → 252 HP / 252 Sp. Atk / 6 Sp. Def
- Tyranitar → 252 Attack / 252 Speed / 6 HP

Where to train each stat:

Attack EVs (252 for Salamence + Tyranitar)

- Best Spot: Route 214 — fight Goldeen (1 EV) and Gyarados (2 EVs, with Super Rod).
- Alternative: Route 209 — wild Bibarel (2 EVs) show up often.

Speed EVs (252 for Salamence + Tyranitar)

- Best Spot: Route 201/202 — tons of Starly (1 EV)

HP EVs (252 for Togekiss)

- Best Spot: Route 209/210 — Bidoof (1 EV) and Bibarel (2 EVs) appear constantly

Sp. Atk EVs (252 for Togekiss)

- Best Spot: Old Chateau (Gastly = 1 EV)

Sp. Def EVs (Tiny filler for Togekiss)

- Best Spot: Route 223 — Tentacool (1 EV) and Tentacruel (2 EVs) while surfing

**How to Track EV Progress**

Sadly, Platinum doesn't give a clear EV counter. But here's what you can do:

- Feed vitamins first — easy guaranteed EVs.
- Count battles carefully (e.g., 126 Bibarel with Macho Brace = 252 EVs).
- Use the stat-reducing berries if you mess up and want a fresh start.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### Level Training to 50+

To participate in most Frontier facilities, your Pokémon need to be at least level 50. That means some serious grinding is in order. Don't worry — there are efficient ways to do this.

### The Battleground — Daily Elite Training

The Battleground in the Survival Area is hands down the best place to level your Pokémon. Here, you can rematch Gym Leaders and rivals daily, and their teams give great EXP.

- Give your trainee the EXP Share and let a stronger Pokémon handle the fights.
- If you want to speed things up, you can manipulate the DS clock: set the system time to 23:59, wait for the day to roll over, and boom — new challengers appear. This trick keeps the daily rematches flowing.

### Specific Level Goals

- Salamence → Level 50 minimum (Bagon evolves at 30 into Shelgon, then 50 into Salamence).
- Togekiss → Level 50 minimum (Togepi → Togetic with friendship, then use a Shiny Stone for Togekiss).
- Tyranitar → Level 55 is mandatory (Larvitar evolves at 30 into Pupitar, then 55 into Tyranitar).

### Moves and held items

Remember to give each pokémon their moves and items. This is is the last step of this arduous grind.

# Battle Frontier Preparations

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

## Pre-Frontier Checklist

Before stepping into the Battle Frontier, double-check your Pokémon's summary screens. Everything must be correct, or you'll feel it later when things get tough.

**Salamence** (Lv. 50+)

- Item: Focus Sash
- Ability: Intimidate
- Nature: Adamant
- EVs: 252 Atk / 252 Speed / 6 HP
- Moves:
  - Outrage
  - Dragon Dance
  - Earthquake
  - Fire Fang

**Tyranitar** (Lv. 55+)

- Item: Life Orb
- Ability: Sand Stream
- Nature: Adamant
- EVs: 252 Atk / 252 Speed / 6 HP
- Moves:
  - Stone Edge
  - Crunch
  - Earthquake
  - Aerial Ace

**Togekiss** (Lv. 50+)

- Item: Leftovers
- Ability: Serene Grace
- Nature: Modest
- EVs: 252 HP / 252 Sp. Atk / 6 Sp. Def
- Moves:
  - Air Slash
  - Aura Sphere
  - Thunder Wave
  - Roost

## Final words before the Frontier

If all three Pokémon have:

- Their correct held items,
- Their ideal nature,
- The right ability,
- EVs maxed and properly distributed,
- Their movesets locked in,
- And have reached level 50+ (55 for Tyranitar)

…then congratulations, Trainer! You now hold a frontier-ready team, strong enough to take on the toughest challenges Sinnoh has to offer.

# Battle Tower

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

The Tower looks innocent enough — win streaks of 7 battles against increasingly difficult Trainers. But don't let the plain layout fool you: the AI here pulls out nasty tricks, and at the top of each streak waits Tower Tycoon Palmer, ready to ruin your day.

The good news? Our team is built exactly for this challenge.

### Core strategy

We lead with Salamence, our powerhouse sweeper. Here's the flow of battle:

1. Set up with Dragon Dance.

o Start every match with at least one Dragon Dance (if possible)

o If the opponent doesn't threaten serious damage (like status or strong Ice/Dragon moves), you can push for two or more boosts.

2. Choose the safest KO option.

o Outrage is Salamence's nuke, capable of one-shotting just about anything after a boost. But it locks you in and causes confusion later, so use it wisely.

o Earthquake is reliable coverage against Rock-, Steel-, and Electric-types.

o Fire Fang roasts Steel-types that resist Dragon (think Bronzong, Skarmory).

3. Backup plans.

o If Salamence gets statused, forced out, or the matchup looks ugly (e.g., Ice Shard users), switch immediately.

o Tyranitar brings raw power, Sand Stream chip damage, and strong coverage. He punishes Ghosts and Psychics with Crunch and clears Flying- and Fire-types with Stone Edge.

o Togekiss is our utility tank. With Thunder Wave and Air Slash, it can paralyze and flinch-lock even strong foes while healing itself with Roost. It also patches matchups Salamence and Tyranitar struggle with, like bulky Grounds or pesky Fighting-types.

This three-headed approach makes sure no single bad matchup ends your streak.

# Tower Tycoon Palmer

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

| Tower Tycoon Palmer | | |
|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Moves |
| Regigigas | normal | Crush Grip<br>Earthquake<br>Stone Edge<br>Drain Punch |
| Cresselia | psychic | Psychic<br>Ice Beam<br>Signal Beam<br>Moonlight |
| Heatran | steel/fire | Magma Storm<br>Flash Cannon<br>Earth Power<br>Explosion |

### Strategy

At 49 wins you battle against Palmer, the Tower Tycoon. His team consists of three powerful legendary pokémon.

**Gameplan**:

- Heatran folds to Salamence's Earthquake. If you suspect Explosion, Tyranitar can sponge it.
- Regigigas is dangerous because of Thunder Wave + Confuse Ray. Don't let it cripple Salamence. Lead with Togekiss to paralyze first, then Air Slash flinch until it falls.
- Cresselia is the big wall. Outrage chunks it hard, but if Salamence is gone, Tyranitar's Crunch is your best answer. Life Orb guarantees 2HKOs while Sandstorm chips it down further.

With the Tower conquered, your streaks can go as far as your focus allows. But remember — one unlucky crit or Ice Beam freeze can end it all. That's the Frontier lifestyle.

# Battle Factory

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

You don't use your own Pokémon here. Instead, you're given a rental team from a pool of random choices.

At the start of a streak, you choose 3 out of 6 Pokémon offered to you.

After each battle, you can choose to swap one of your current Pokémon for one of your opponent's.

The Factory is split into Level 50 and Open Level (Lv. 100) modes, just like the Tower.

### Key mechanics

1. Round Progression:

- Like the Tower, you battle in streaks of 7 Trainers.
- Win streaks unlock higher "sets" of Pokémon with stronger movesets and items. Early sets might have Pokémon with awkward movepools, while later ones are competitively viable.

2. Opponent Preview:

- Before each round, you're given a brief hint about your opponent's Pokémon types. Pay attention to this — it's your only scouting tool.

3. Swapping Is Critical:

- At the start, your 6 rental choices might not be great. But by swapping out your weakest picks for stronger opponents' Pokémon, your team snowballs in power.
- The Factory rewards flexibility, not attachment. Don't get sentimental — always look for upgrades.

When presented with your first 6 options: Aim for a well-rounded team. Ideally:

- 1 Physical Attacker
- 1 Special Attacker
- 1 Defensive Pivot or Utility Pokémon

This facility will require your absolute best team building skills.

# Factory Head Thorton

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### Strategy

Look for strong coverage. Avoid overlap (e.g., don't take 3 Water-types). Try to cover as many weaknesses as possible.

Prioritize reliability. Moves with 100% accuracy are gold here. Remember, the Factory is full of Double Team/Minimize users, so missing can cost a streak.

Example:

If you see something like:

- Gengar (Special Attacker, Speed)
- Gyarados (Physical Attacker, setup with Dragon Dance)
- Registeel (Defensive tank)

That's a great starting trio — balanced offense and defense with solid synergy.

### The Frontier Brain

You will battle Thorton at 21 wins and 49 wins. Unlike other Factory opponents, his Pokémon are chosen based on your team. He deliberately picks counters to your lineup, meaning you'll often face type or stat disadvantages.

General Gameplan Against Him:

- Diversify coverage early. If all 3 of your Pokémon share weaknesses (say, all weak to Ice), you're in trouble.
- Don't fear swapping aggressively. If you can grab a legendary or a bulky wall from an earlier opponent, do it.
- Play around hax. He'll gladly use evasion, status, and confusion moves to throw you off. Stay calm and chip him down.

Unlike the Tower, where Salamence can bulldoze through opponents with Dragon Dance, the Factory tests your knowledge, adaptability and decision-making. Swapping after battles is the difference between streaking and stalling out.

But the payoff is huge — clearing the Factory proves you can succeed with any Pokémon, not just your favorites.

# Battle Hall

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

You enter with only one Pokémon (in our case, Salamence). You must face 10 Pokémon from each of the 17 types, for a total of 170 battles! You can choose which type to challenge next from the selection menu. Opponents scale up in level and difficulty as you progress, with the later matches being much tougher.

It's long, it's repetitive, and it's absolutely exhausting — but it's also one of the most straightforward challenges: pick the right type order, hit hard, and don't faint.

### Our Pokémon: Salamence

Item: Focus Sash (absolutely vital — it saves you from sudden Ice Shards or unexpected OHKOs)

Moves:

- Outrage (main nuke)
- Earthquake (coverage & safe option)
- Fire Fang (for Steel & Bug)
- Dragon Dance (niche setup only)

Why Salamence works:

- Speed + insane power = quick battles.
- Coverage lets it handle a huge range of types.
- Focus Sash covers its main weakness: surprise Ice-type priority or revenge kills.

# Battle Hall

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### Type Order Strategy

The key to the Hall is picking the right order of types. You always want to eliminate threats early before they can end your streak.

1. Ice first — almost every Ice-type carries Ice Shard, which is a priority move. Clearing these early ensures you don't get sniped later.

2. After Ice, target these "problem types":

o Bug, Steel, Rock, Ground, Water, Flying. These contain some of the most dangerous

### Dangerous Opponents

Here are the Pokémon that can ruin your run if you're not prepared:

- Yanmega (Bug): Thanks to Speed Boost, it can outspeed and KO you after a turn. Use Dragon Dance first, then Outrage to secure the KO.
- Aerodactyl (Flying): Naturally outspeeds Salamence. Safest plan is to Dragon Dance once, then Outrage.
- Rhyperior (Rock): Extremely bulky, it can survive two Earthquakes and retaliate hard. Use Earthquake anyway, but know this fight has an element of luck. Clear it early.
- Scizor (Steel): Carries Focus Sash + Counter + Bullet Punch. This is brutal. Fire Fang is the only answer — and even then, it might take some luck.
- Sharpedo (Water): Use Earthquake to avoid Rough Skin recoil from Outrage.
- Venusaur (Grass): Has Focus Sash. Use Earthquake instead of Outrage to avoid confusion damage and chip.
- Gardevoir (Psychic): Runs Sticky Barb + Protect. Outrage risks confusion + contact damage, so use Earthquake instead.
- General Ice-types: Almost all have Ice Shard, which bypasses Sash. Another reason why we knock them out first.

# Hall Matron Argenta

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### General Tips

- Pace yourself. With 170 battles, this is a marathon. Take breaks if you need to — losing focus is a real danger here.
- Focus Sash is life. Never swap it off. Salamence lives and dies by it in the Hall.
- Plan ahead. Always choose the next type with dangerous matchups in mind. Clearing "problem types" first reduces the chances of an unlucky KO later.
- Don't get greedy with Dragon Dance. Only use it when strictly necessary (Yanmega, Aerodactyl). Otherwise, just go for the KO.

### The Frontier Brain — Hall Matron Argenta

You'll face her at 50 wins and then again at 170 wins. She uses a random Pokémon from the rental pool (yes, it could even be a Legendary). There's no type preview for her — you go in blind.

- Treat her like any other fight: Outrage when safe, Earthquake for chip, and Fire Fang for Steel/Bug.
- Thanks to Focus Sash, you usually get at least one extra chance even against surprise counters.

The Hall is exhausting, but Salamence is built to handle it. Once you clear this, you'll feel like you truly conquered one of the hardest grinds in Platinum.

# Battle Castle

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

The Battle Castle isn't about mindless battling — it's about resource management. Every victory earns you Castle Points (CP), and those CP are your lifeline. They're used for:

- Healing HP
- Buying held items
- Scouting the opponent's team
- And most importantly… raising your Pokémon's levels

Unlike other facilities, your Pokémon's HP doesn't automatically restore between battles. Status conditions are healed for free, but if your Salamence limps out of a fight with 20 HP left, you'll either need to spend CP or gamble the next round.

### Smart CP Management

The single biggest trap new players fall into is spending CP too early on healing or scouting. Here's the pro tip:

**Save as many points as possible until the later rounds.**

Why? Because in the Castle, CP can be used to raise your Pokémon's levels beyond 50. This can give you a massive edge against the Frontier Brain and the high-level trainers you'll face in streaks 2 and 3.

- Early rounds: Heal only when absolutely necessary. Salamence should be sweeping most opponents anyway, so you shouldn't take much damage.
- Mid rounds: Scout selectively. If you're worried about an Ice-type ruining Salamence's day, spending CP to see the enemy team is worth it.
- Final rounds: Unleash your savings. Use all that CP to bump Salamence, Togekiss, and Tyranitar up a few levels. A higher level means stronger attacks, bulkier defenses, and out-speeding foes that otherwise could wreck you.

# Castle Valet Darach

Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

### Our Team's Approach

- Salamence leads most battles. One Dragon Dance is often all you need, but don't overdo it if the enemy looks threatening. Save Outrage for when you know it can sweep; use Earthquake or Fire Fang to play safe.
- Togekiss keeps us alive in tough matches. Air Slash flinches + Serene Grace can cheese past bulky threats, especially in higher streaks when every bit of HP matters.
- Tyranitar is your cleaner. Be careful with Life Orb recoil — in the Castle, that chip damage stacks up fast. Save Tyranitar for emergencies or for finishing the toughest foes.

The goal: minimize HP loss so you don't have to burn CP early.

### The Frontier Brain — Castle Valet Darach

Darach appears at 21 wins (Silver Print) and again at 49 wins (Gold Print). His team is strong, balanced, and designed to punish careless play. Let's break it down.

His team consists of Entei, Empoleon and Gallade. His moveset can change however so you never know what you are up against.

### The Frontier Brain — Castle Valet Darach

- Entei outspeeds a lot with its Scarf, but Salamence can handle it with Earthquake. If you're boosted, even better.
- Empoleon is bulky and dangerous once set up, but Togekiss can stall it out or Salamence can smash it with Earthquake before it gets going.
- Garchomp is the real threat — Yache Berry blunts Ice moves, so you'll need raw power. Salamence with Outrage is your best bet, or Tyranitar if it's already weakened.

This is where saving CP pays off — if your team is level 53–55 while his stays at 50, the advantage is enormous.

With a bit of discipline, the Castle becomes one of the most reliable places to rack up wins. And few things feel as good as walking into Darach's fight with a team that's several levels higher than his.

# Battle Arcade

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

The Arcade is basically Pokémon Platinum's casino, except instead of slot machines you're fighting Trainers on a roulette board. Before every match, the wheel spins and whatever it lands on can affect the battle. Possible effects include:

- Status conditions (burn, paralysis, poison, sleep — for you or the enemy)
- Weather changes (sun, rain, hail, sandstorm)
- Items (berries, healing, or nothing at all)
- HP boosts or drops (usually small, but sometimes crucial)
- Even "no effect"

The twist? You can stop the wheel manually — with good timing, you can heavily influence

### General Strategy

Unlike the Castle where it's about resource management, here the key is adapting to randomness.

- Favor neutral or positive rolls. Don't gamble on status effects unless you feel lucky. If you can, land on things like HP recovery or giving your opponent a useless item.
- Watch the weather. Tyranitar brings Sand Stream, which can mess with certain effects (like hail/sun). Sometimes this actually helps, sometimes it disrupts. Keep it in mind.
- Abuse status when given. If the roulette paralyzes the opponent's whole team? Salamence can set up Dragon Dances with ease.

Our team works great here because:

- Salamence can sweep quickly before randomness punishes you.
- Togekiss thrives if the enemy is slowed or statused.
- Tyranitar's raw power and Sandstorm chip make it a reliable cleaner.

# Arcade Star Dahlia

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

| Arcade Star Dahlia | | |
|---|---|---|
| Pokémon | Type | Moves |
| Zapdos | flying/electric | Thunderbolt<br>Air Cutter<br>Heat Wave<br>Signal Beam |
| Blaziken | fire/fighting | Flare Blitz<br>Superpower<br>ThunderPunch<br>Night Slash |
| Togekiss | normal/flying | Hyper Beam<br>Air Slash<br>Aura Sphere<br>Psychic |

Dahlia shows up after 21 consecutive wins (Silver Print), and again after 49 consecutive wins (Gold Print). She's flamboyant, unpredictable, and her roulette manipulations can be brutal — but her teams are beatable with good preparation.

- Zapdos is very bulky here. Tyranitar is your best answer with Stone Edge — but beware Heat Wave. A level advantage (if you've trained more) helps a ton.
- Gallade threatens Salamence with Stone Edge, so play carefully. Togekiss can Air Slash it into submission.
- Ludicolo is bulky and stally again — Salamence can power through with Outrage if healthy, or Togekiss can chip with Air Slash.

Key Tips for Success:

- Practice the roulette timing. Even just being able to land on neutral effects consistently is huge.
- Save big sweeps for when luck favors you. If paralysis or sleep hits the opponent's whole team, Salamence is basically unstoppable.
- Be ready for stalls. Dahlia's Ludicolo is infamous for dragging out fights. Don't let it frustrate you — just focus on clean damage.

# Battle Frontier Conclusion

## Where Champions Are Forged: Conquer the Frontier!

You've done it—the toughest trainers in Sinnoh have been brought to their knees! The Battle Frontier stands as the ultimate test of endurance, strategy, and adaptability. If you've conquered its facilities and earned all the Symbols, congratulations—you're among the elite of the elite. This is no small feat; very few trainers ever see all those glimmering Symbols in their case.

After all the grueling battles, unpredictable conditions, and clever opponents, you can now stand proud knowing you've overcome what many consider the greatest challenge in Pokémon Platinum.

### Cashing in your rewards

With your hard-earned Battle Points (BP), you can now buy anything you want from the Frontier's shops. These shops carry some of the most valuable items in the game:

- Held items like Choice Band, Focus Sash, and Life Orb—cornerstones of competitive battling.
- TMs for powerful moves like Ice Beam, Thunderbolt, and Flamethrower.
- EV training items like Power Bracer and Power Lens for perfecting your Pokémon's stats.
- This is your chance to finally round out your team for any remaining challenges—be it competitive play, the Tower rematches, or just showing off.

# The Journey's End

## Epilogue

And so, our grand adventure through Sinnoh comes to a close. From the quiet grass of Route 201 to the echoing halls of the Battle Frontier, you've faced every trial the region could offer—and conquered them all.

You've caught, trained, and battled your way to becoming a true Pokémon Master. The Pokédex is complete, the Gym Leaders stand bested, the Legendaries have been found, and the world itself has been explored in full.

But in the heart of every completionist, there's always that familiar spark—the curiosity to explore again, to perfect just one more team, to revisit old friends. Because even when the journey ends, the spirit of adventure never truly fades.

Congratulations, Trainer. You've done what few ever will—you've completed Pokémon Platinum.

Sinnoh will always be waiting for you.